

Smoothing

Acknowledgements: Olga Sorkine-Hornung and Mario Botsch

CSC 472/572 - Computer Modeling - Teseo Schneider

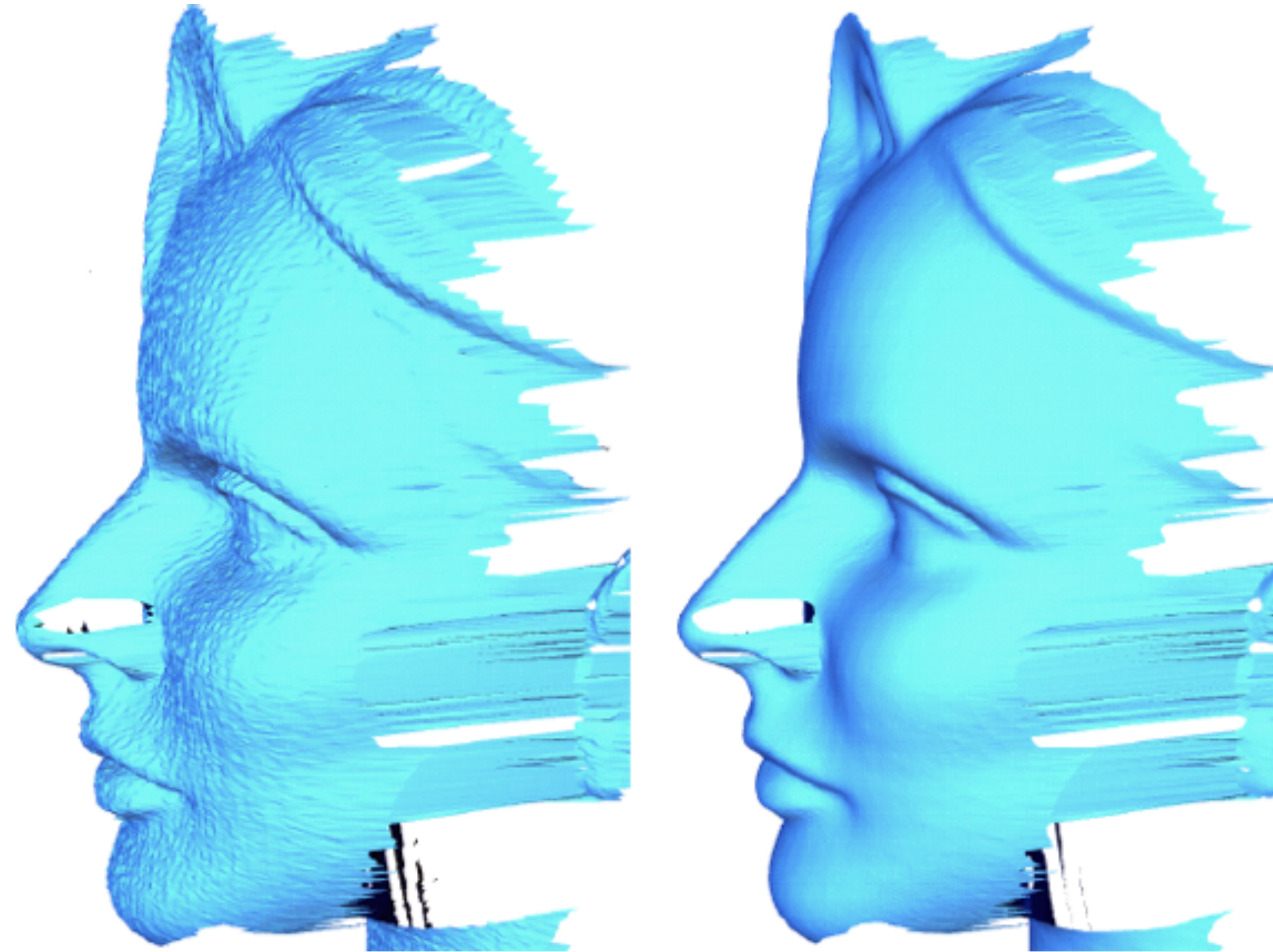


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Computer Science

Motivation

- Scanned surfaces can be noisy



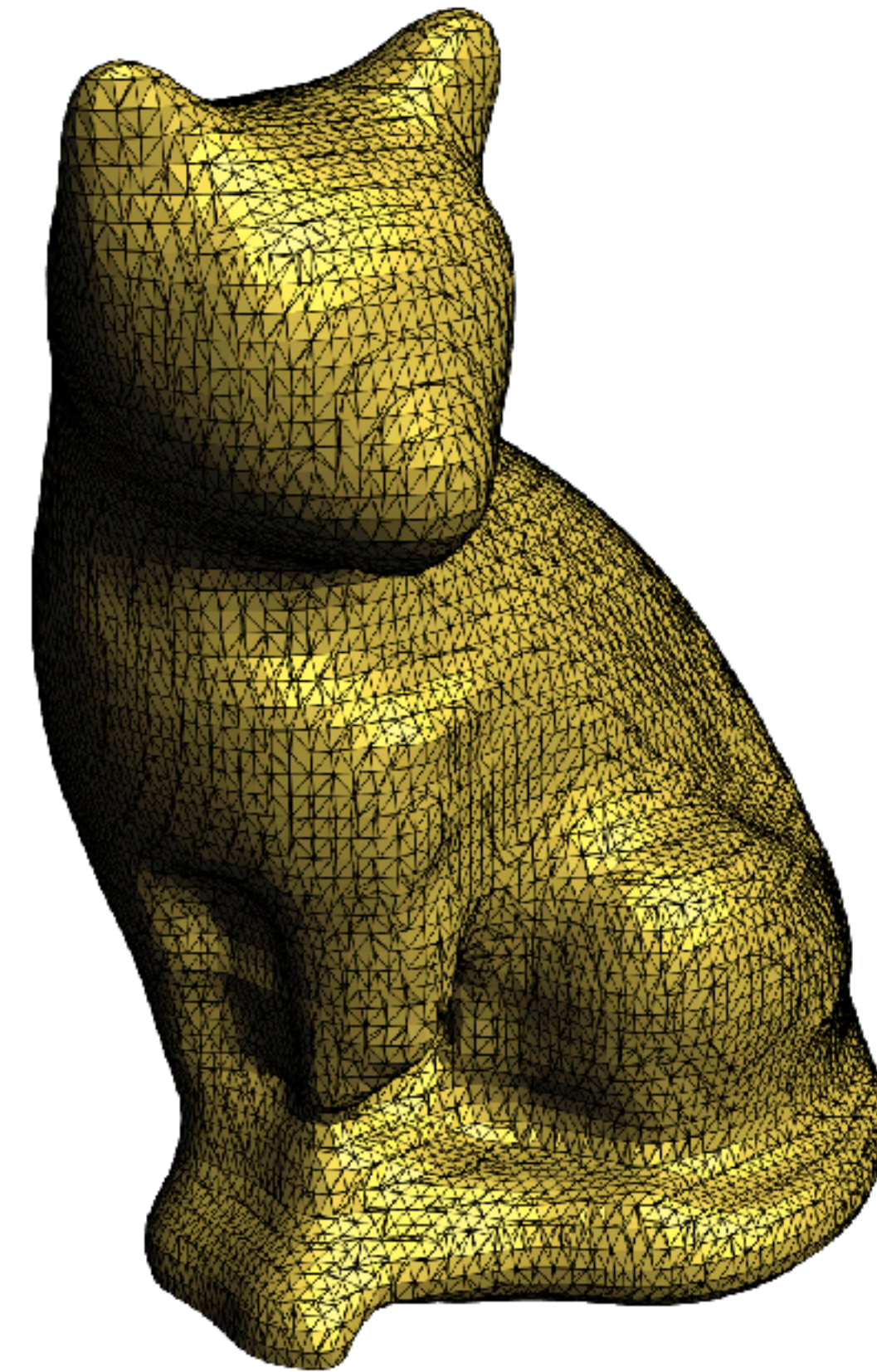
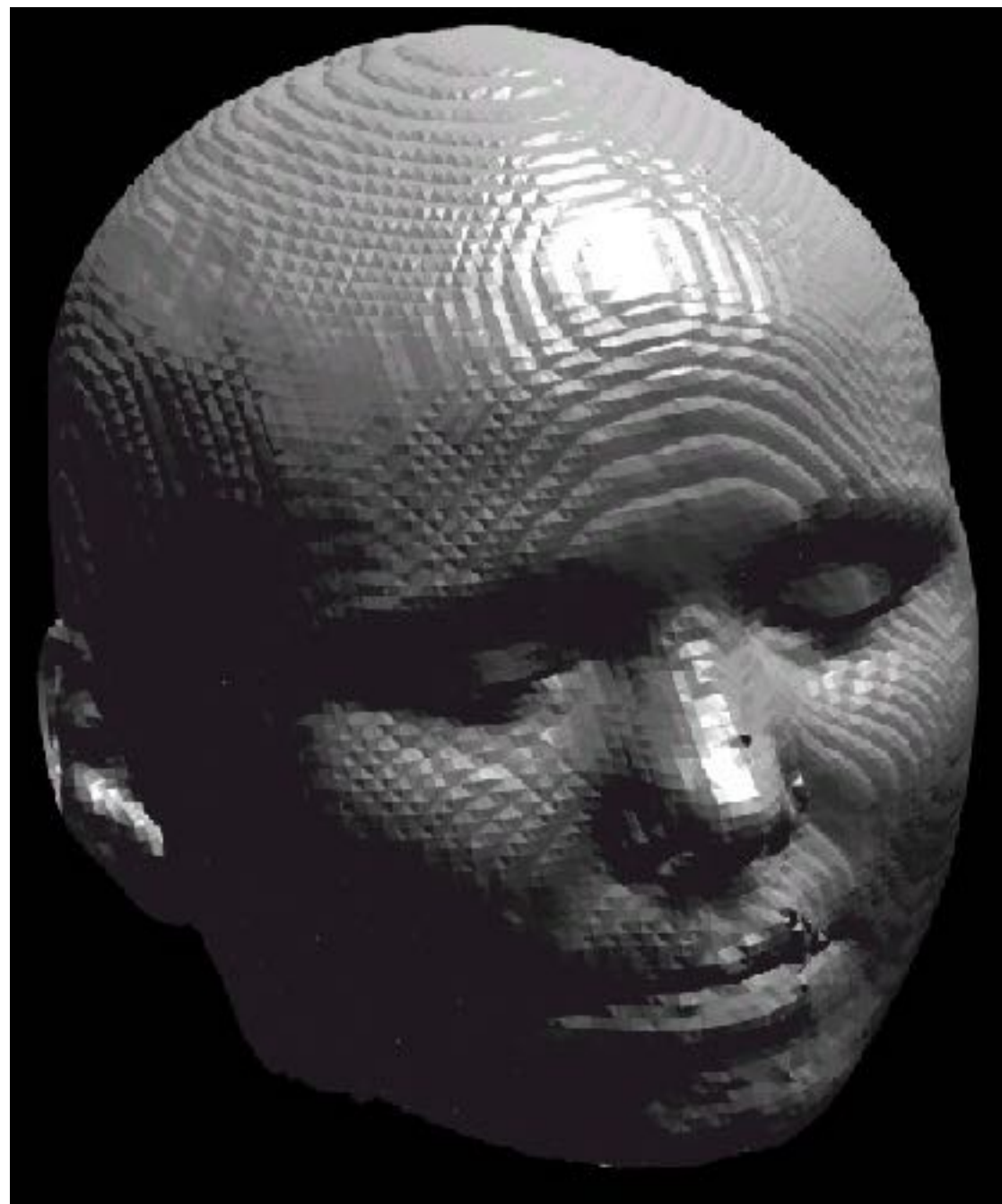
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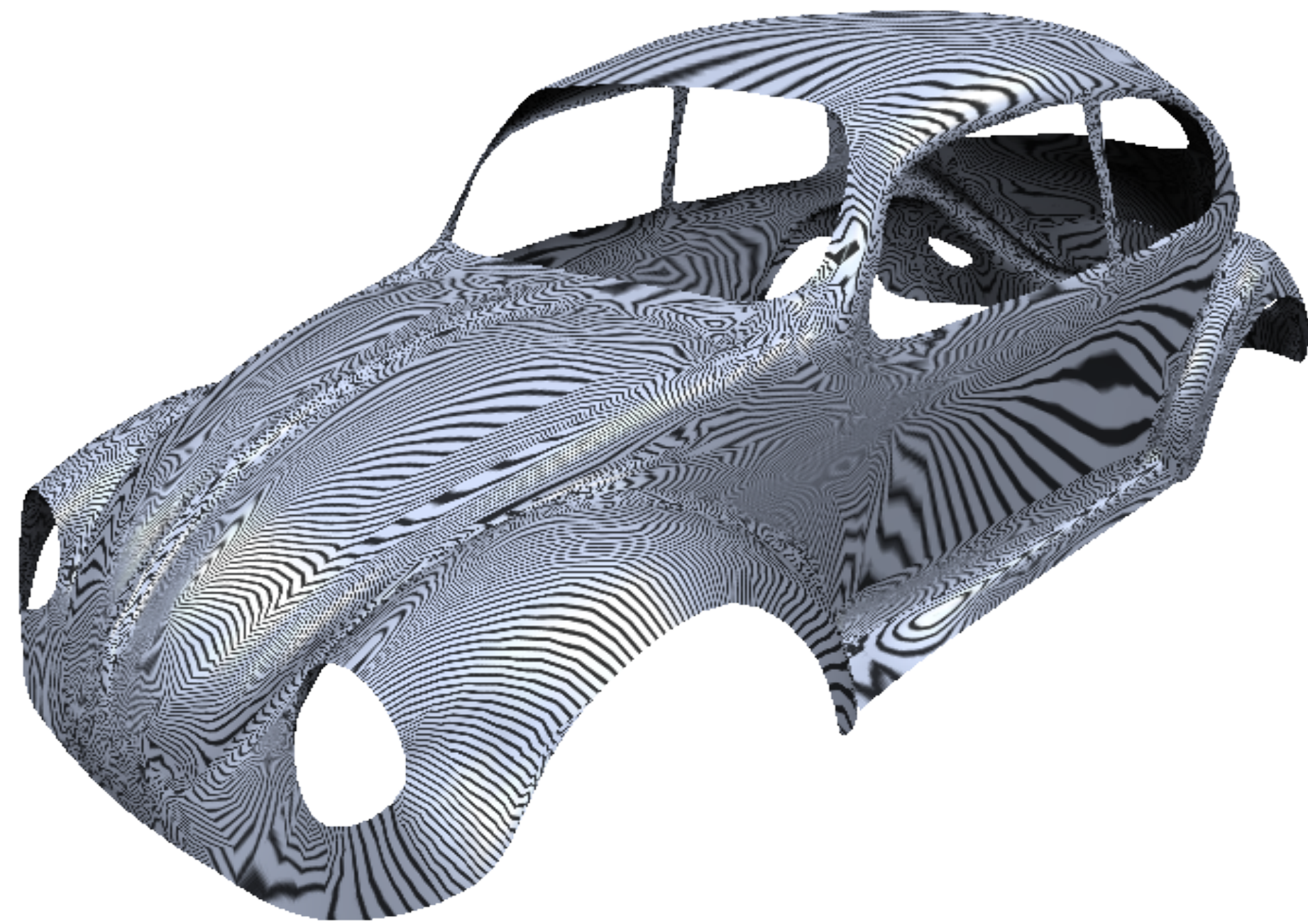


Motivation

- Marching Tetrahedra/Cubes meshes can be problematic



Visual Assessment of Surface Smoothness



Reflection Lines as an Inspection Tool

- [Shape optimization using reflection lines](#)

E. Tosun, Y. I. Gingold, J. Reisman, D. Zorin

Symposium on Geometry Processing 2007

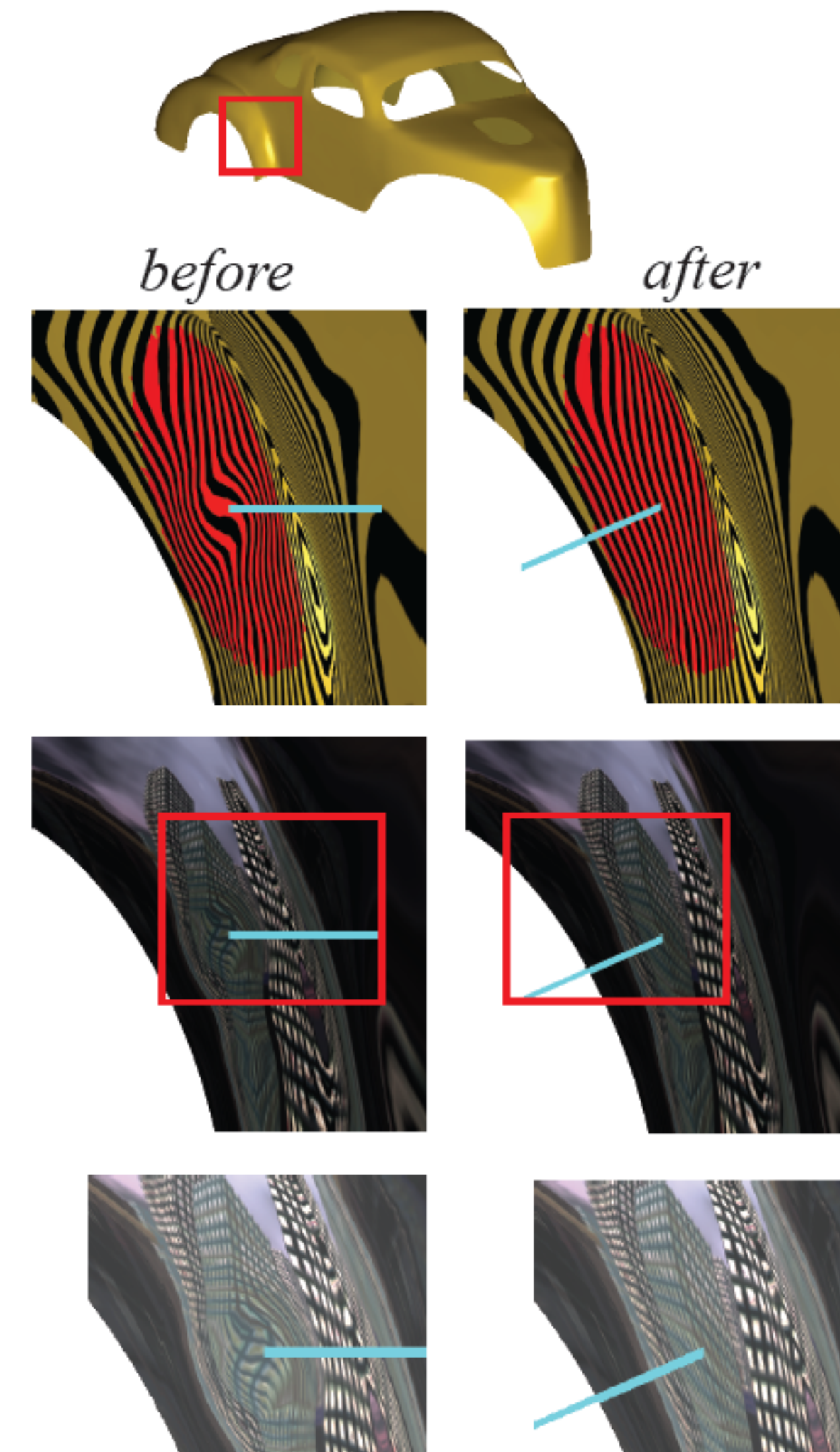


Reflection Lines as an Inspection Tool

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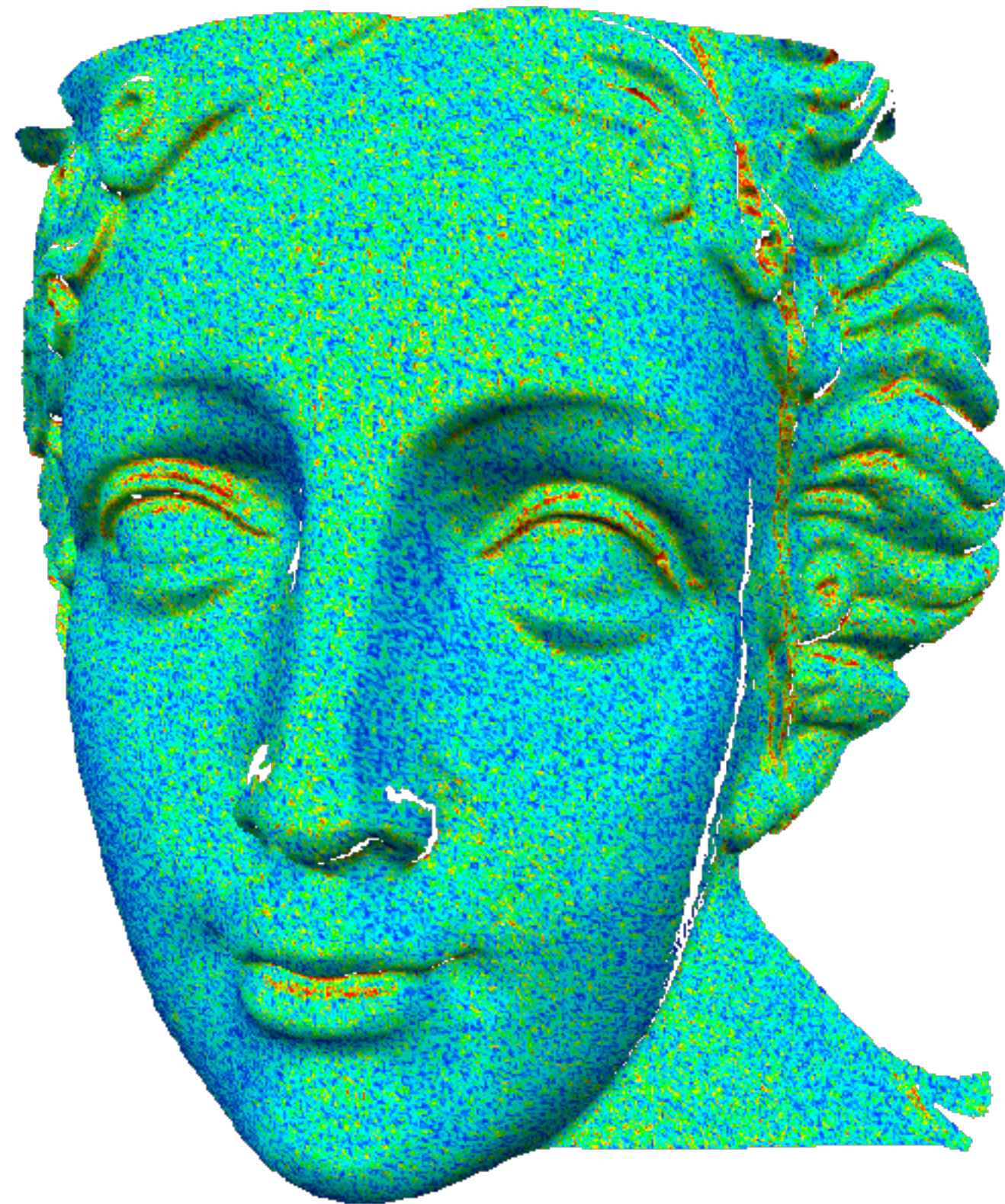


How to measure smoothness?

Curvature and Smoothness

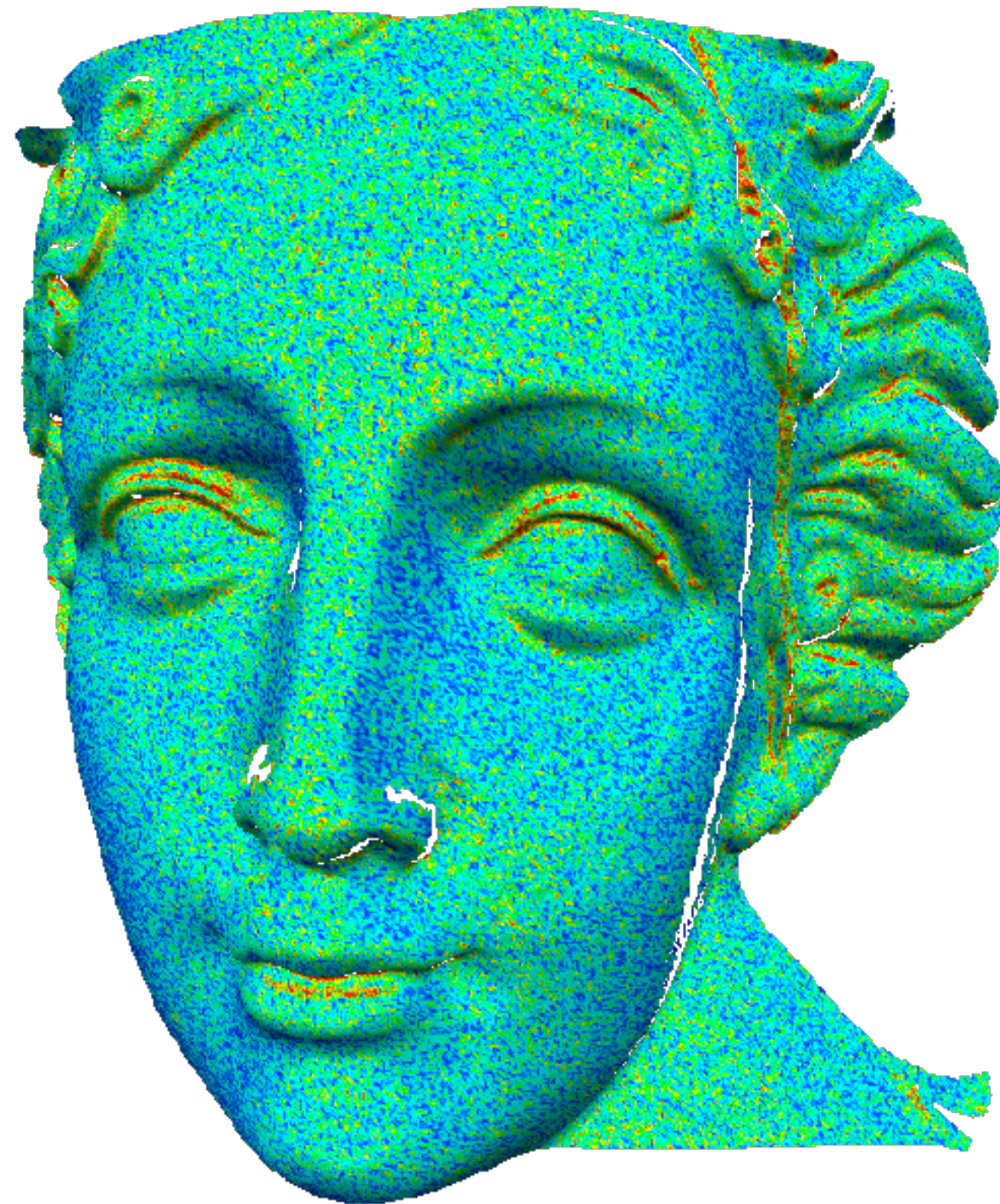


Curvature and Smoothness

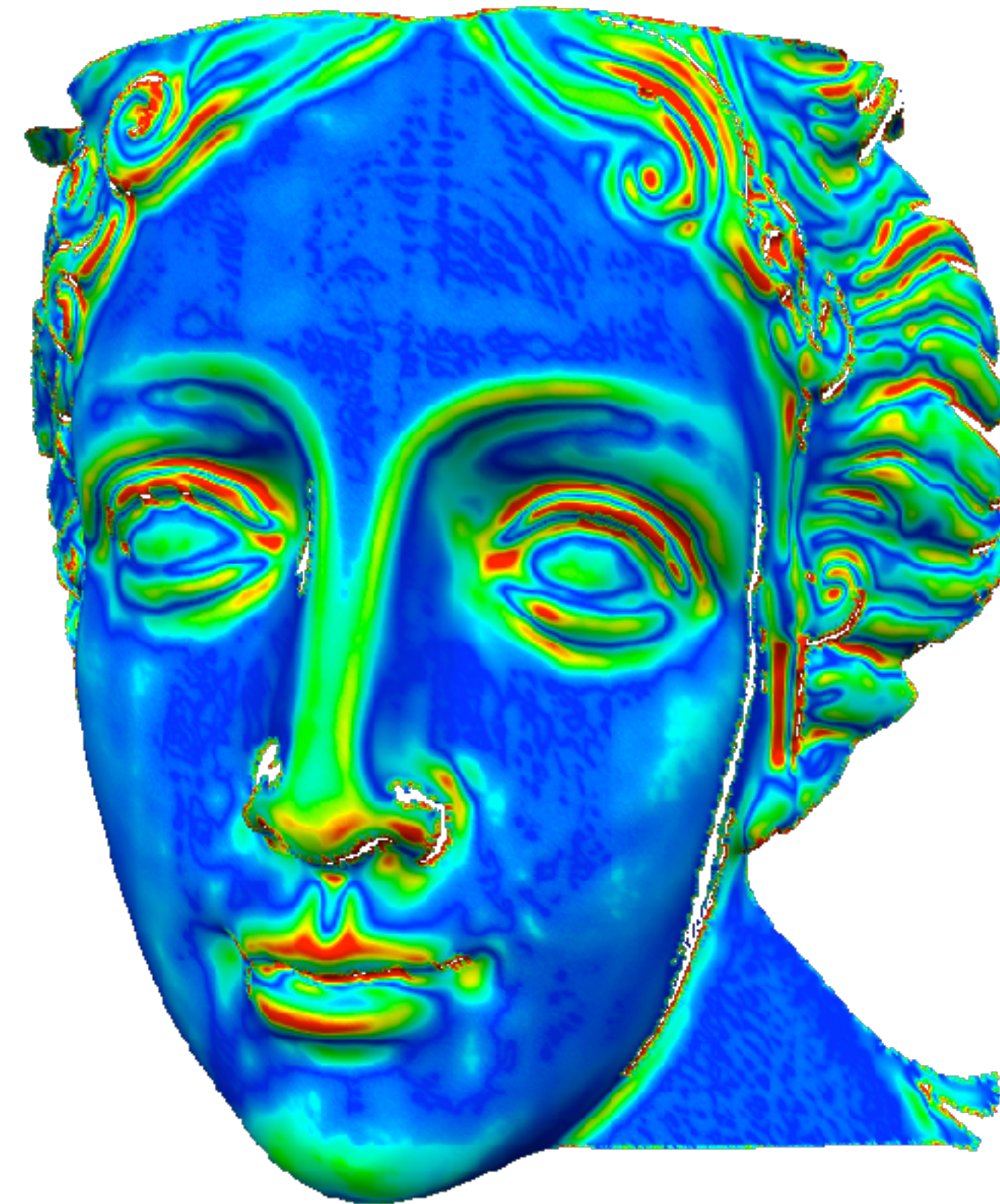


mean curvature plot

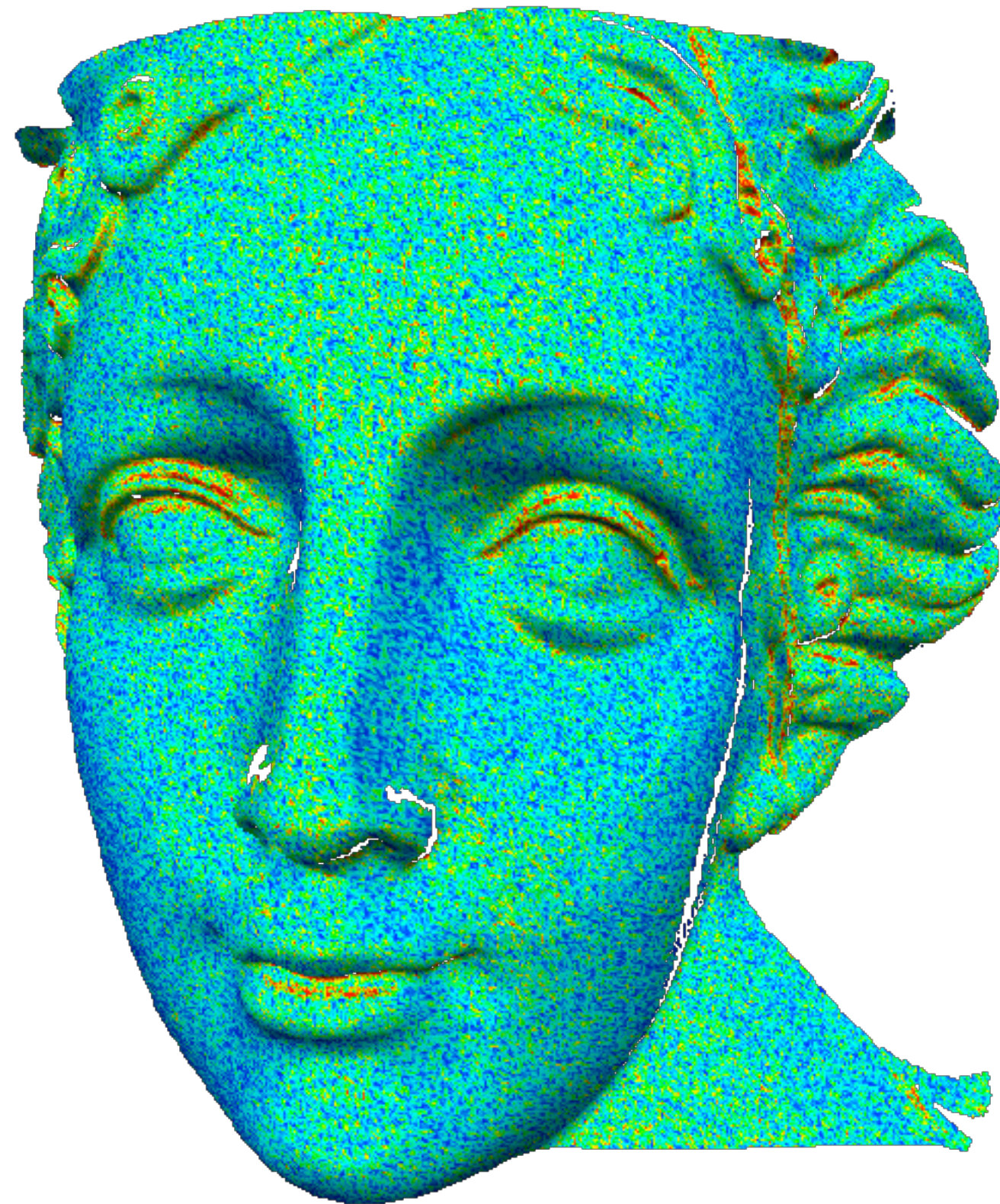
Curvature and Smoothness



mean curvature plot



Curvature and Smoothness

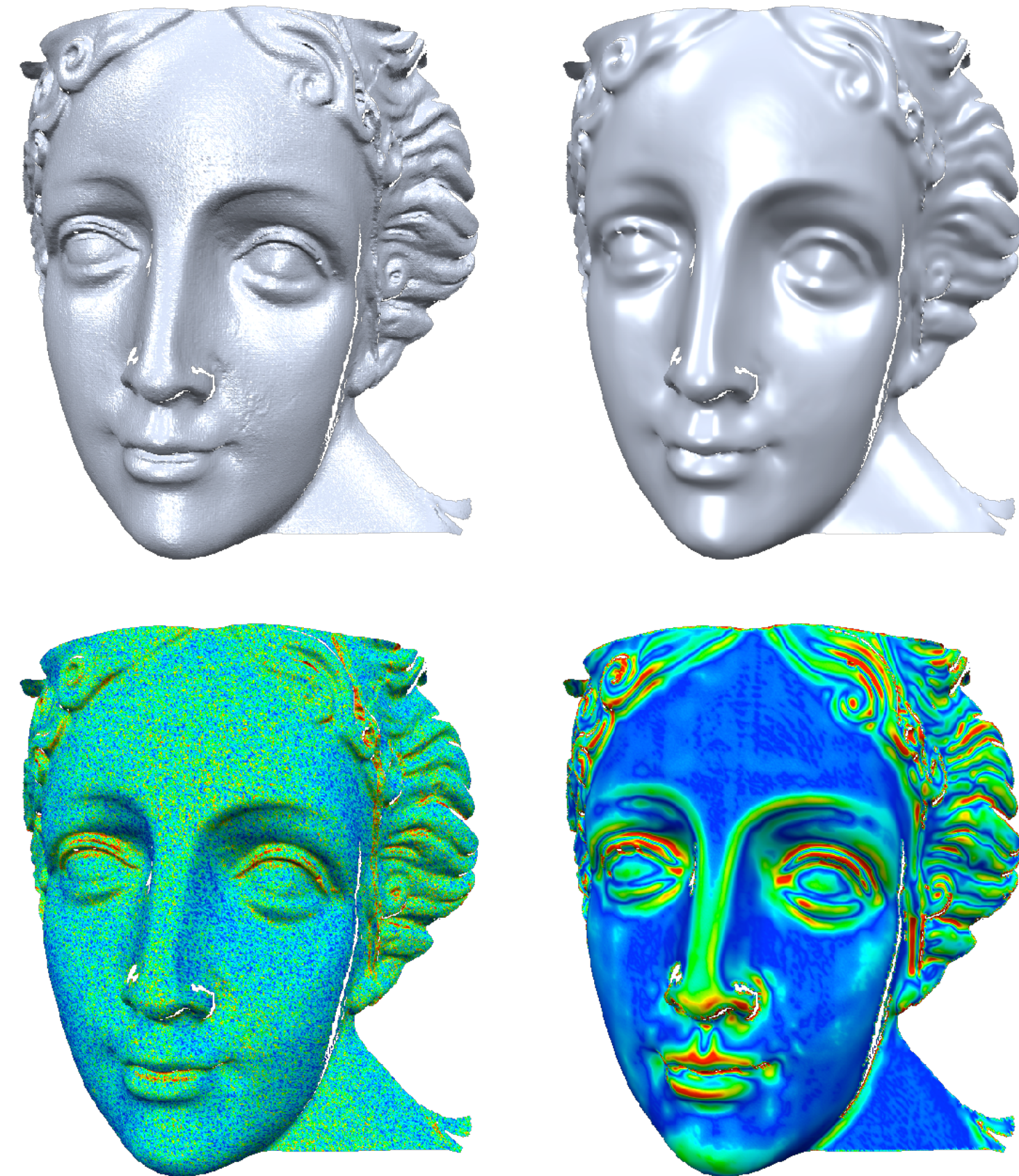


mean curvature plot



Curvature and Smoothness

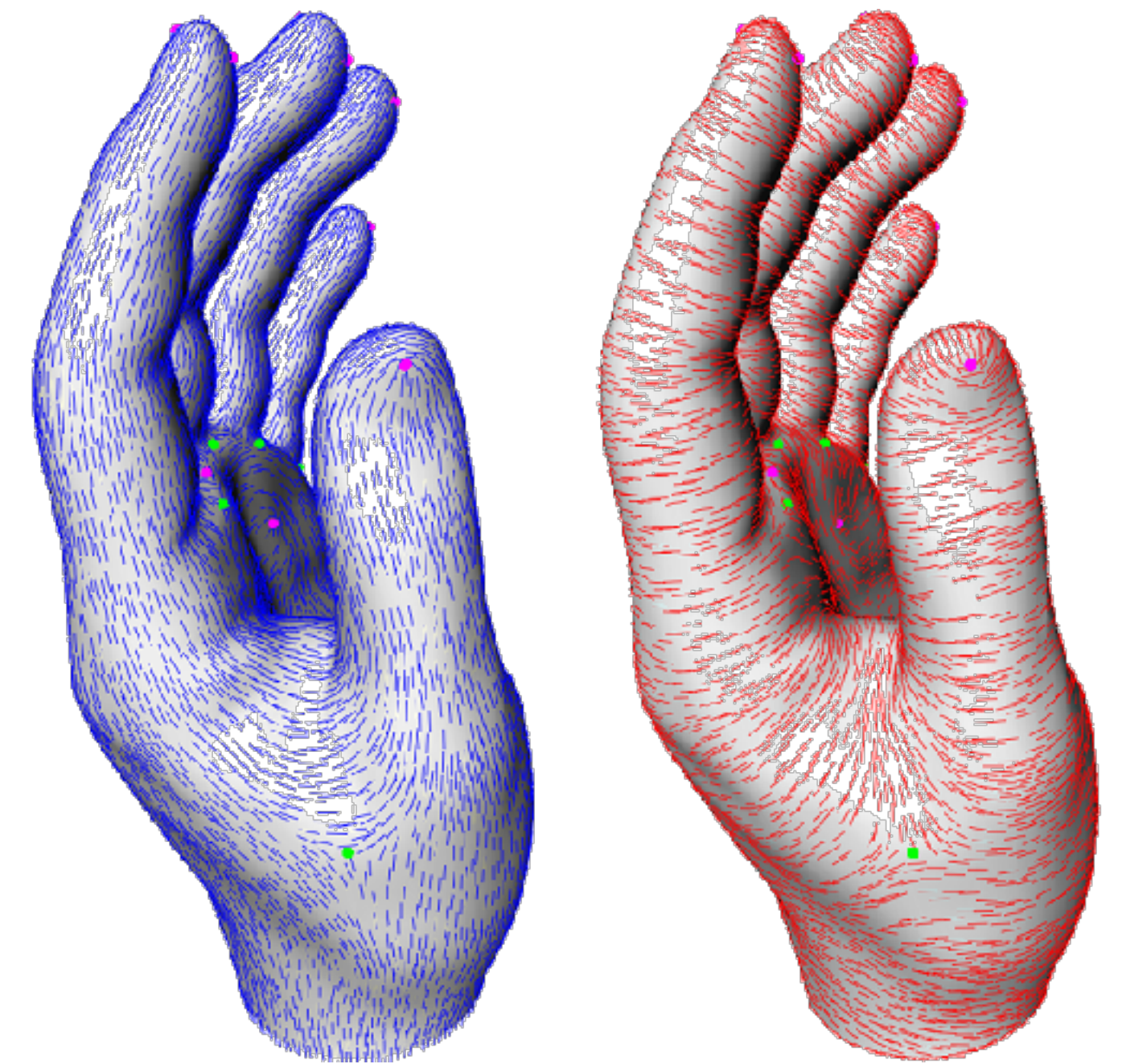
- Smoothing = reducing curvature?
- Smoothing = make curvature vary less?



Which curvature?

- Principal curvatures
 - Nonlinear and “discontinuous” operator in the definition (min, max)

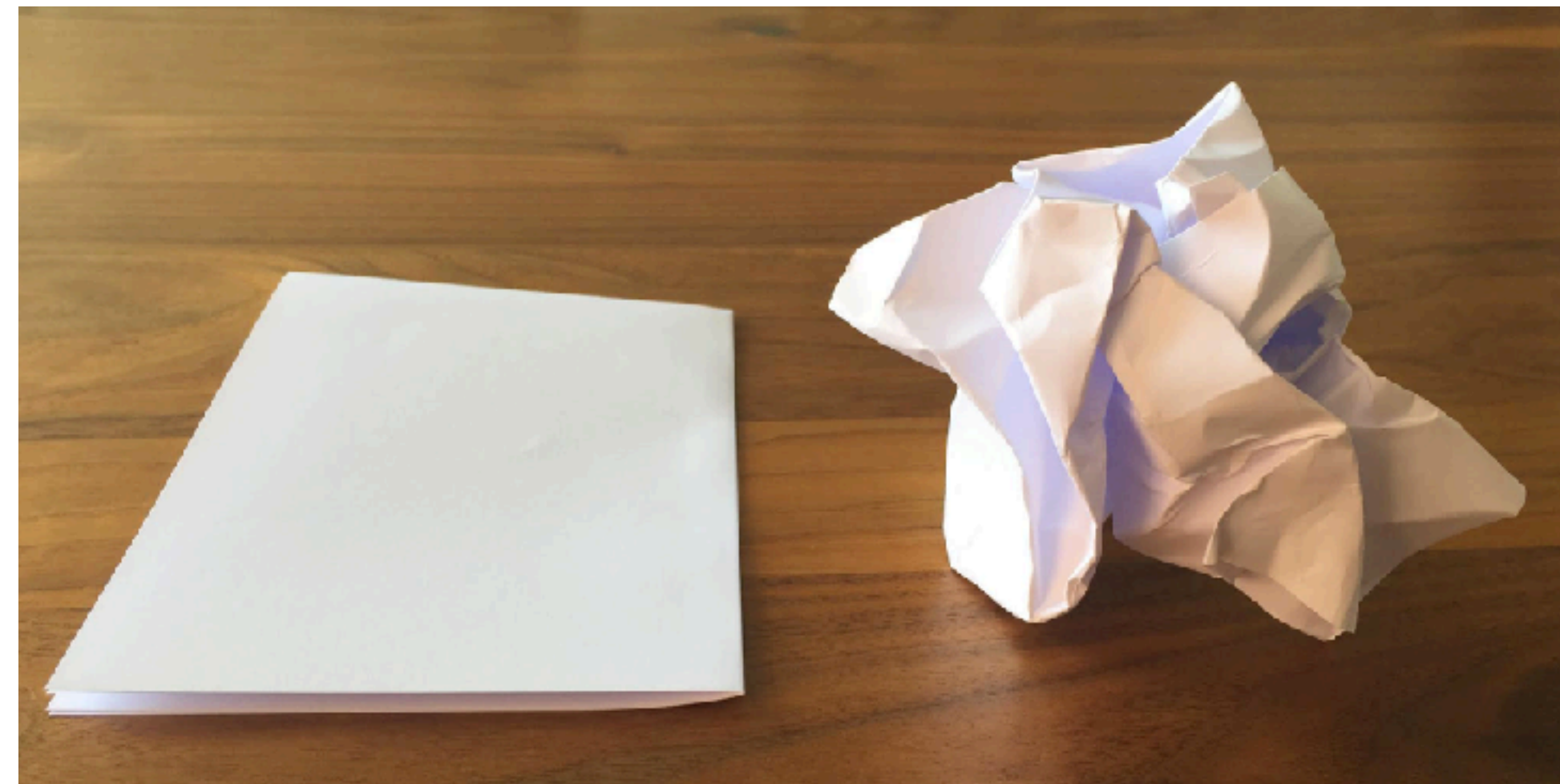
$\kappa_{\min}, \kappa_{\max}$



principal directions

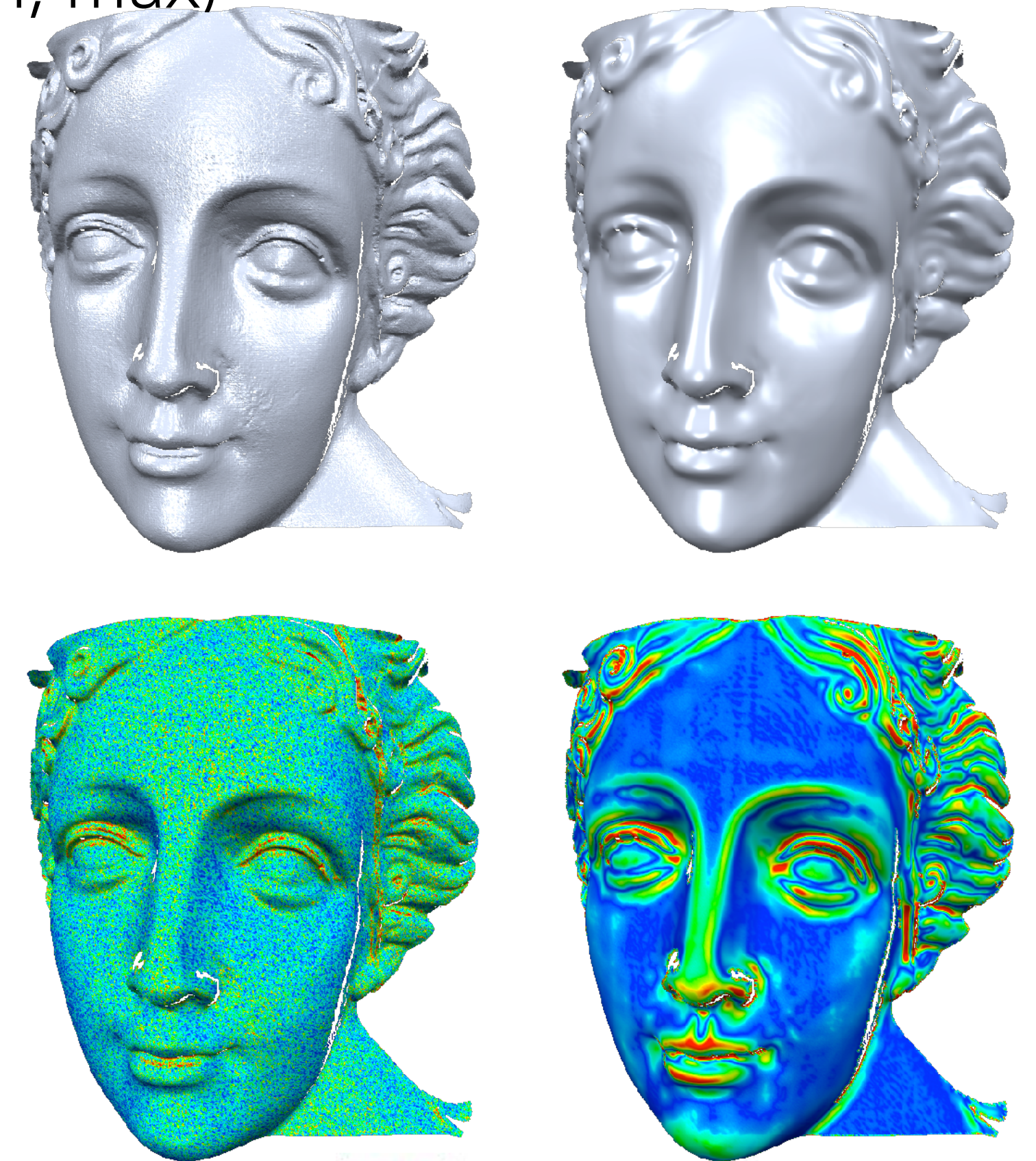
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- Principal curvatures
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- Gauss curvature K
 - Intrinsic-only, insensitive to embedding in



Which curvature?

- Principal curvatures
 - Nonlinear and “discontinuous” operator in the definition (min, max)
- Gauss curvature K
 - Intrinsic-only, insensitive to embedding in
- Mean curvature H
 - Relatively simple to extract on meshes via Laplace-Beltrami:



$$\Delta_{\mathcal{M}} \mathbf{p} = -2H \mathbf{n}$$

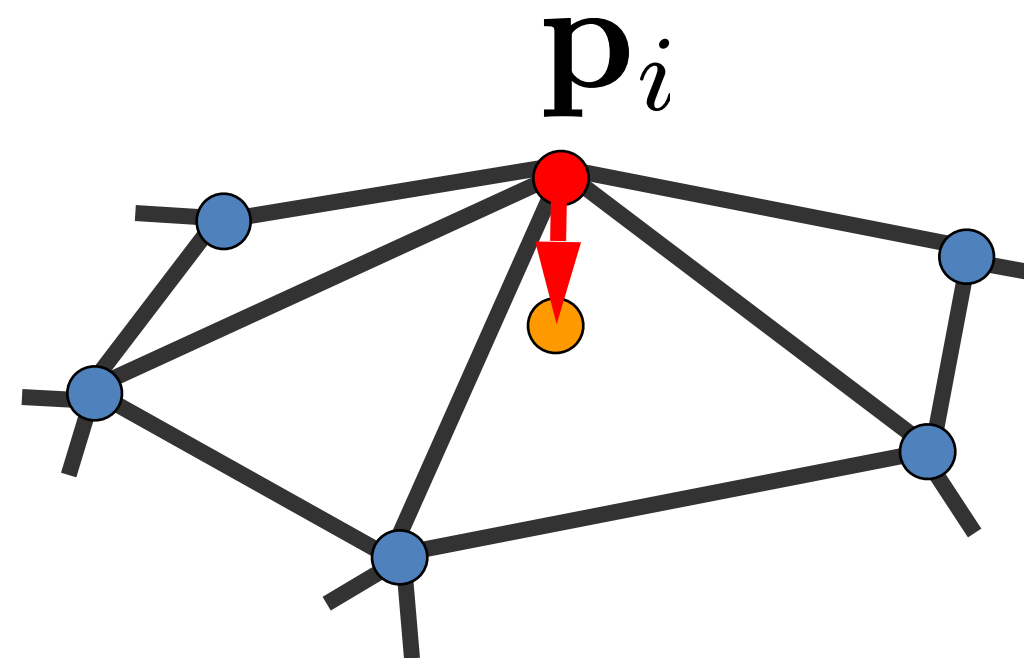
goal: $H = 0$ or $H = \text{const}$

Laplace as a Linear Operator

Recap: Laplace-Beltrami

$$\Delta_{\mathcal{M}} \mathbf{p} = -2H \mathbf{n}$$

- High-pass filter: extracts local surface detail
 - Detail = *smooth*(surface) – surface
 - Assumption: smoothing = averaging

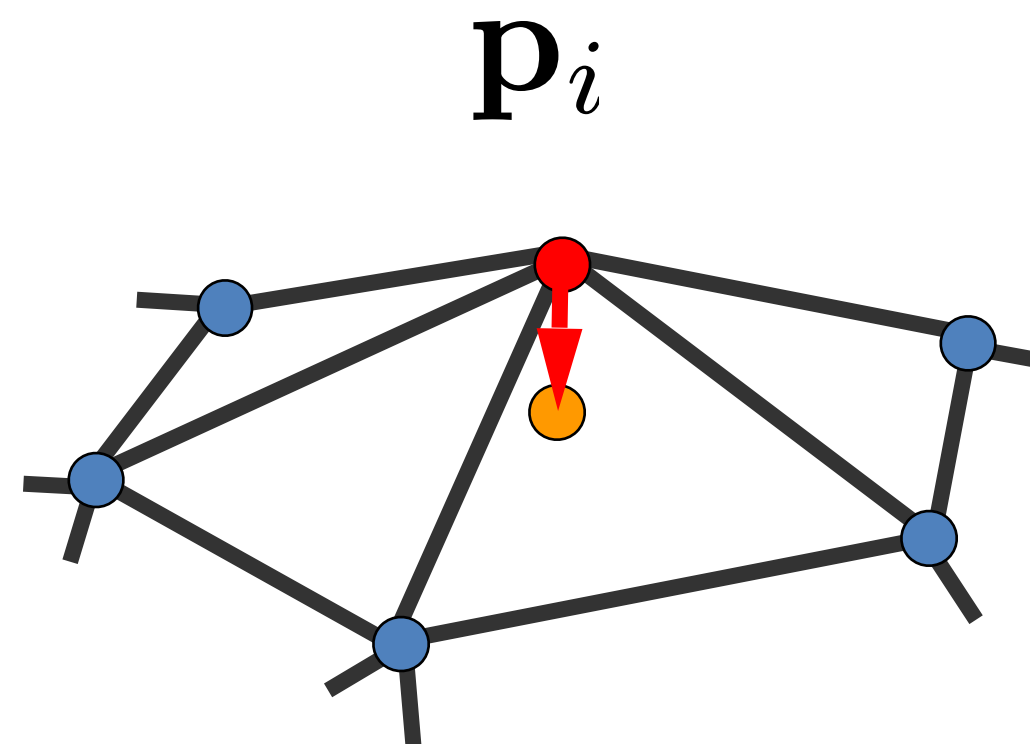


$$\Delta_{\mathcal{M}}(\mathbf{p}_i) = \delta_i = \frac{1}{W_i} \sum_{j \in \mathcal{N}(i)} w_{ij} (\mathbf{p}_j - \mathbf{p}_i)$$

Recap: Laplace-Beltrami

$$\Delta_{\mathcal{M}} \mathbf{p} = -2H \mathbf{n}$$

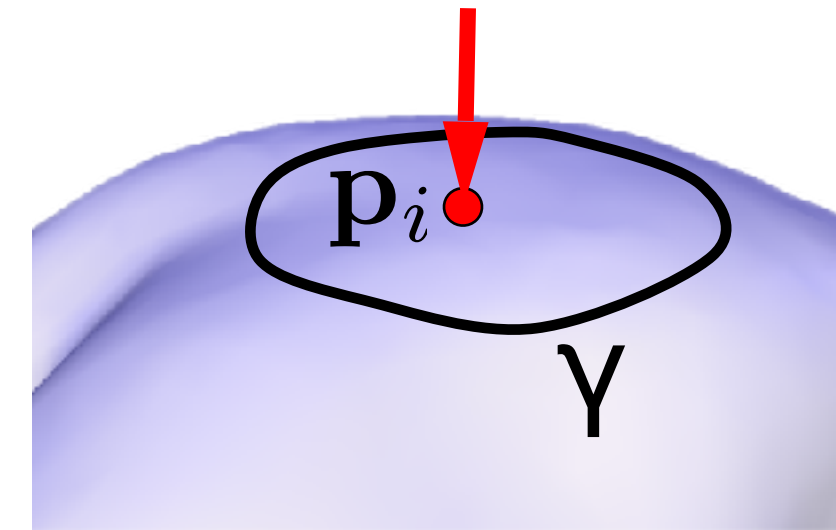
- The direction of δ_i approximates the normal
- The size approximates the mean curvature



$$\delta_i = \frac{1}{W_i} \sum_{j \in \mathcal{N}(i)} w_{ij} (\mathbf{p}_j - \mathbf{p}_i)$$

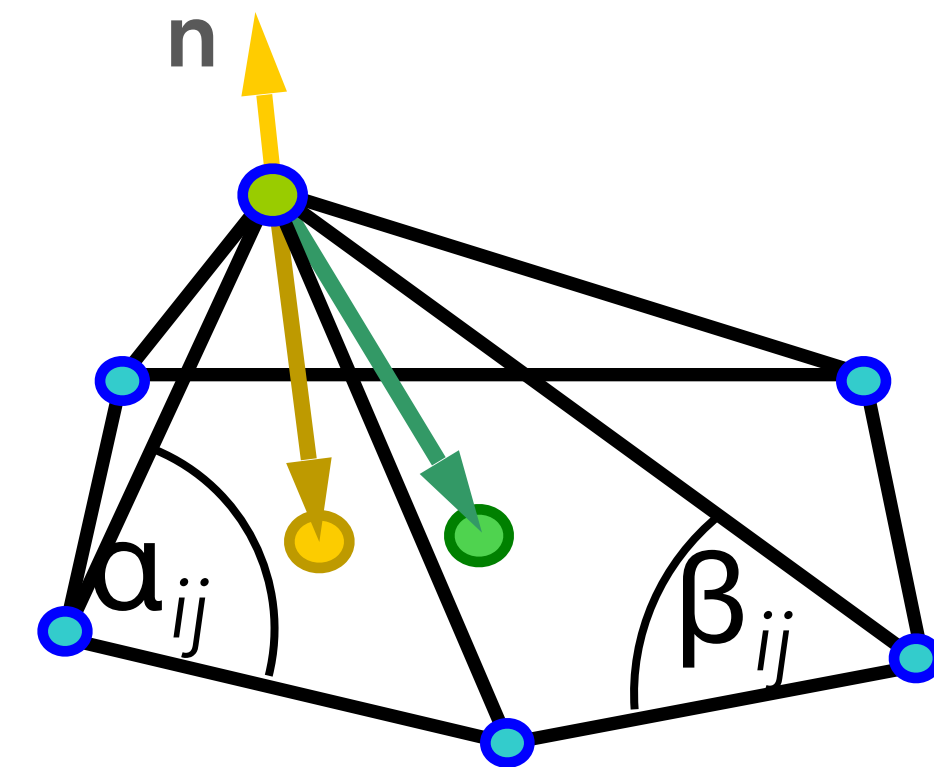
L-B: Weighting Schemes

- Ignore geometry $\delta_i = \frac{1}{W_i} \sum_{j \in \mathcal{N}(i)} w_{ij} (\mathbf{p}_j - \mathbf{p}_i)$
- Integrate over the Voronoi region of the vertex



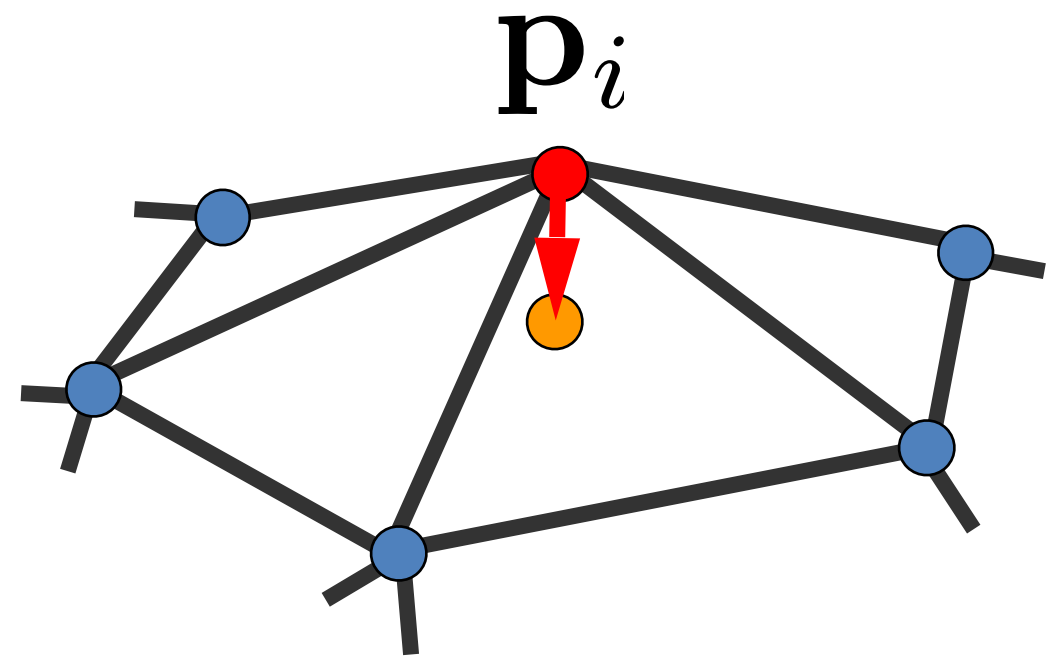
$$\delta_{\text{uniform}} : W_i = 1, w_{ij} = 1/|N(i)|$$

$$\delta_{\text{cotan}} : w_{ij} = 0.5(\cot \alpha_{ij} + \cot \beta_{ij})$$



Laplacian Matrix

- The transition between xyz and δ is linear:



$$\delta_i = \frac{1}{W_i} \sum_{j \in \mathcal{N}(i)} w_{ij} (\mathbf{p}_j - \mathbf{p}_i)$$

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{L} \mathbf{x} &= \delta_{\mathbf{x}} \\ \mathbf{L} \mathbf{y} &= \delta_{\mathbf{y}} \\ \mathbf{L} \mathbf{z} &= \delta_{\mathbf{z}} \end{aligned}$$

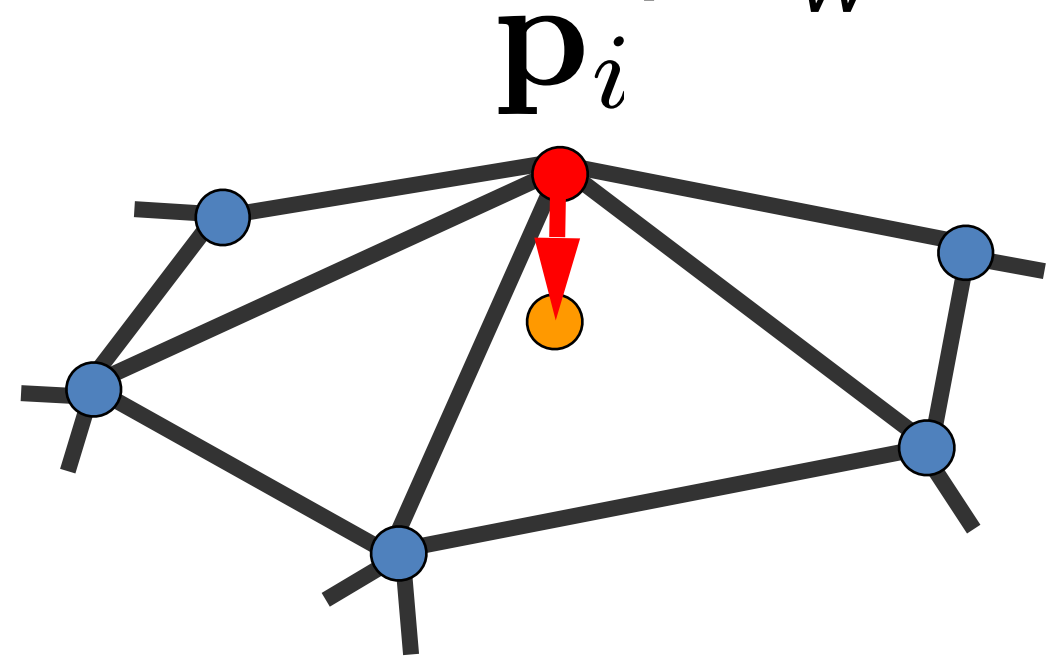
$$\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{y}, \mathbf{z} \in \mathbb{R}^n$$

$$\mathbf{L} \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$$

$$\delta_{\mathbf{x}}, \delta_{\mathbf{y}}, \delta_{\mathbf{z}} \in \mathbb{R}^n$$

Laplacian Matrix

- Breaking down the Laplace matrix:
- $\mathbf{M}$ = mass matrix; $\mathbf{L}_w$ = stiffness matrix



$$\mathbf{L} = \mathbf{M}^{-1} \mathbf{L}_w$$

$$\delta_i = \frac{1}{W_i} \sum_{j \in \mathcal{N}(i)} w_{ij} (\mathbf{p}_j - \mathbf{p}_i)$$

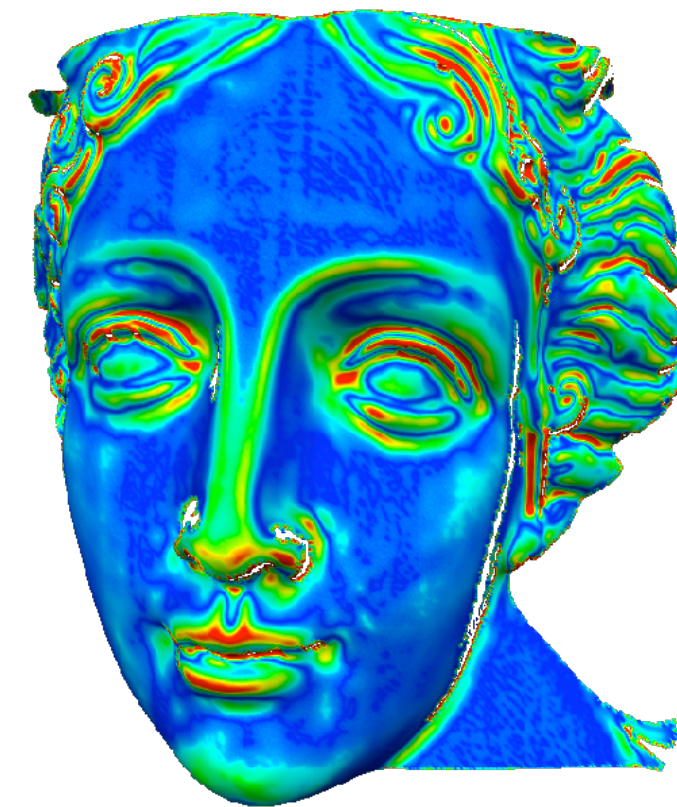


How to do the smoothing?

$$\Delta_{\mathcal{M}} \mathbf{p} = -2H\mathbf{n}$$

goal: $H = 0$ or $H = \text{const}$

- Smooth H , obtain $\tilde{H}$
- Find a surface that has $\tilde{H}$ as mean curvature
 - H doesn't define the surface
 - $\mathbf{n}$ nonlinear in $\mathbf{p}$

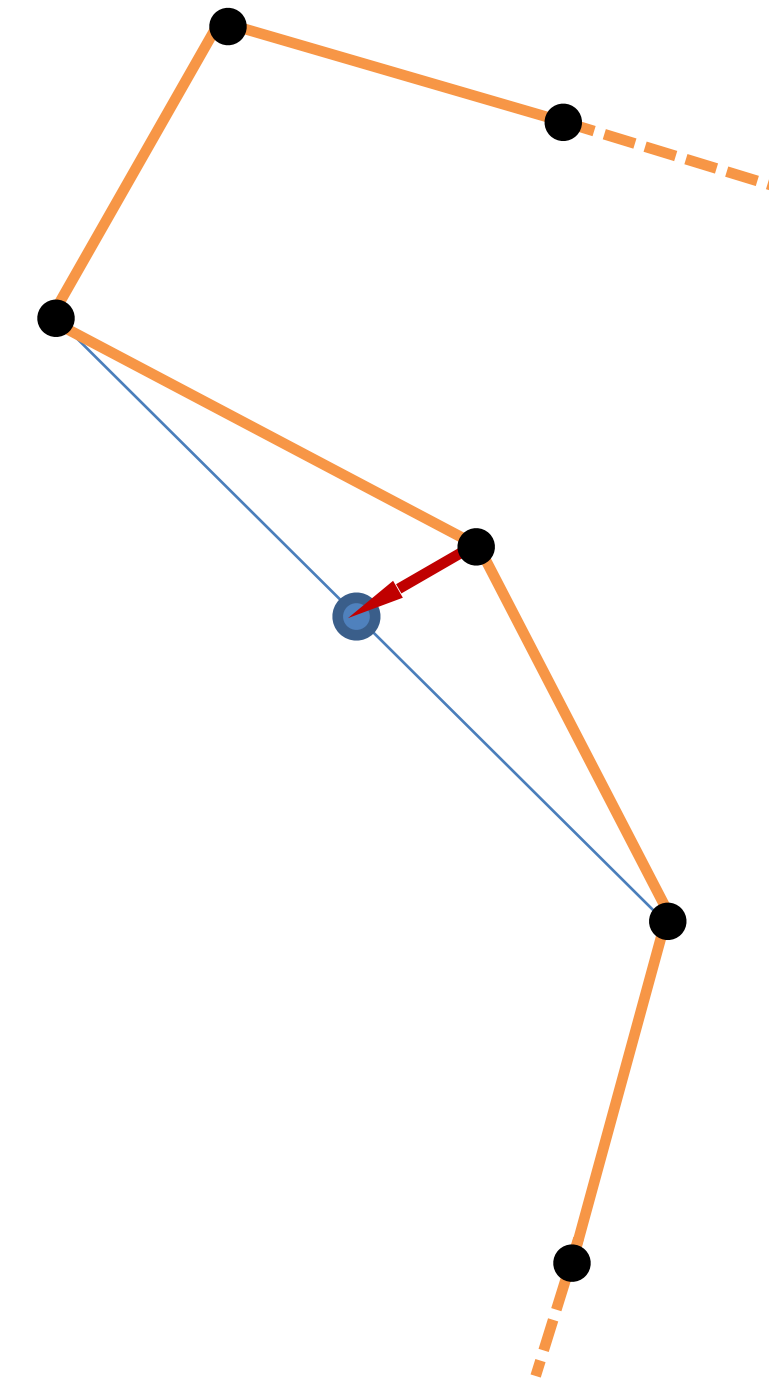


Method 1: Smoothing by Flowing

Example – smoothing curves

- Laplace in 1D = second derivative:

$$L(\mathbf{p}_i) = \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{p}_{i-1} - \mathbf{p}_i) + \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{p}_{i+1} - \mathbf{p}_i)$$



Example – smoothing curves

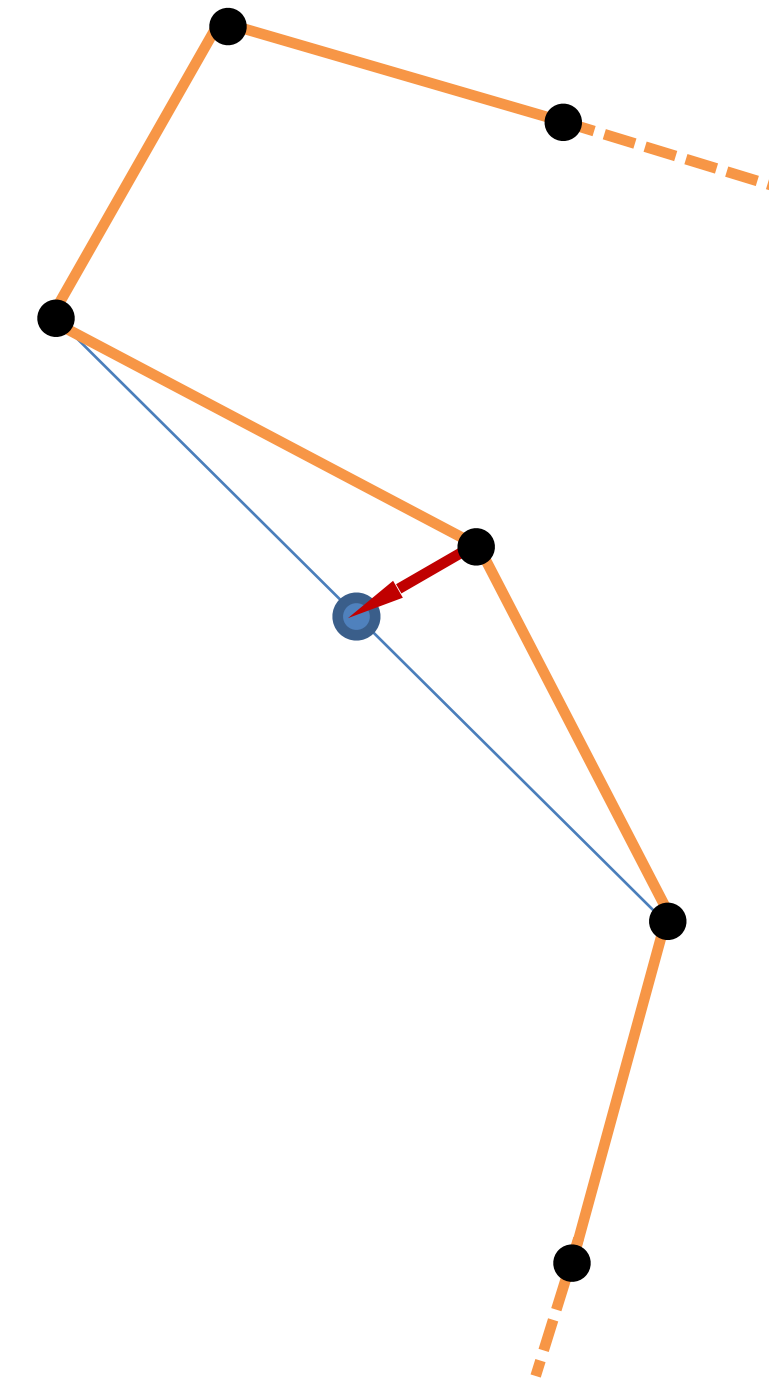
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- In matrix-vector form for the whole curve

$$L\mathbf{p}$$

$$\mathbf{p} = [\mathbf{x} \ \mathbf{y}] \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times 2}$$



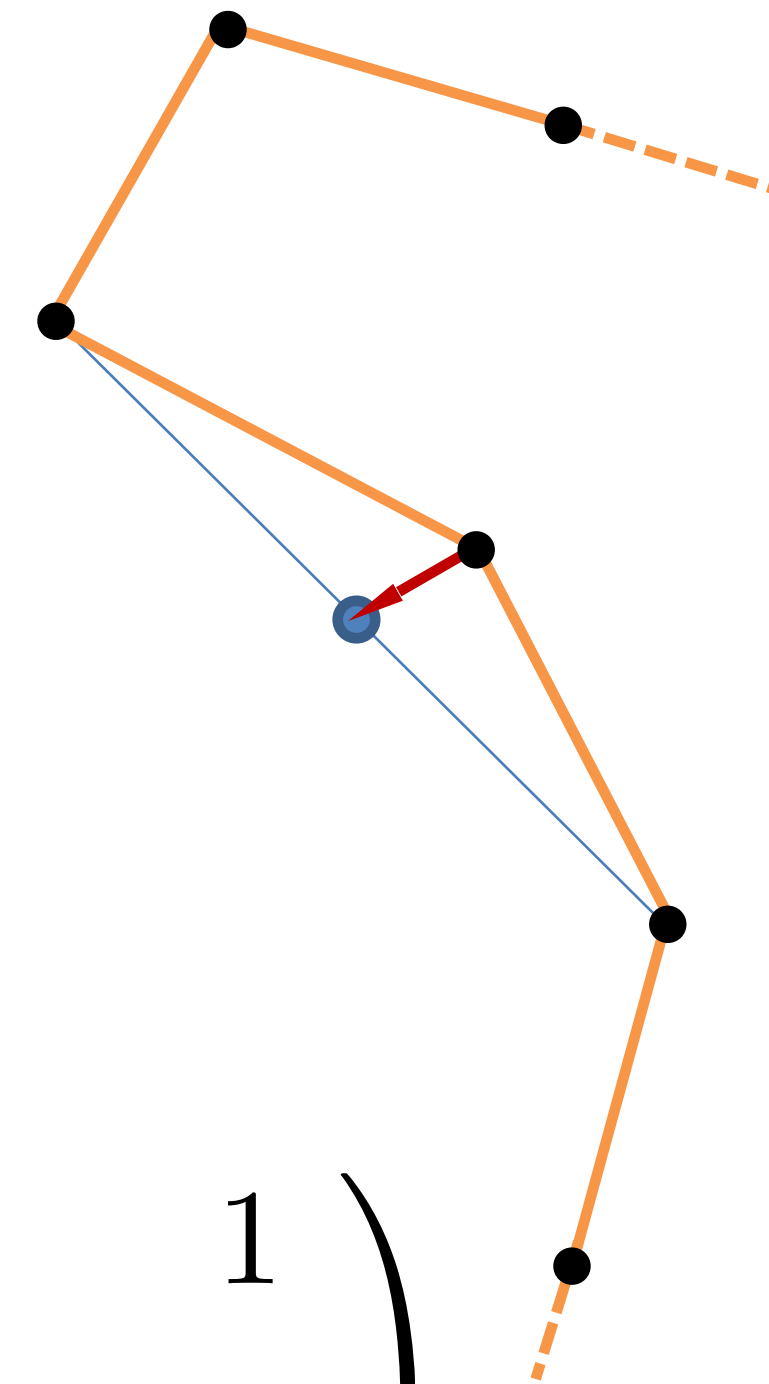
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- In matrix-vector form for the whole curve

$$L\mathbf{p} \quad \mathbf{p} = [\mathbf{x} \ \mathbf{y}] \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times 2} \quad L = \frac{1}{2} \begin{pmatrix} -2 & 1 & & & 1 \\ 1 & -2 & 1 & & \\ & \ddots & \ddots & \ddots & \\ & & 1 & -2 & 1 \\ 1 & & & 1 & -2 \end{pmatrix}$$



Example – smoothing curves

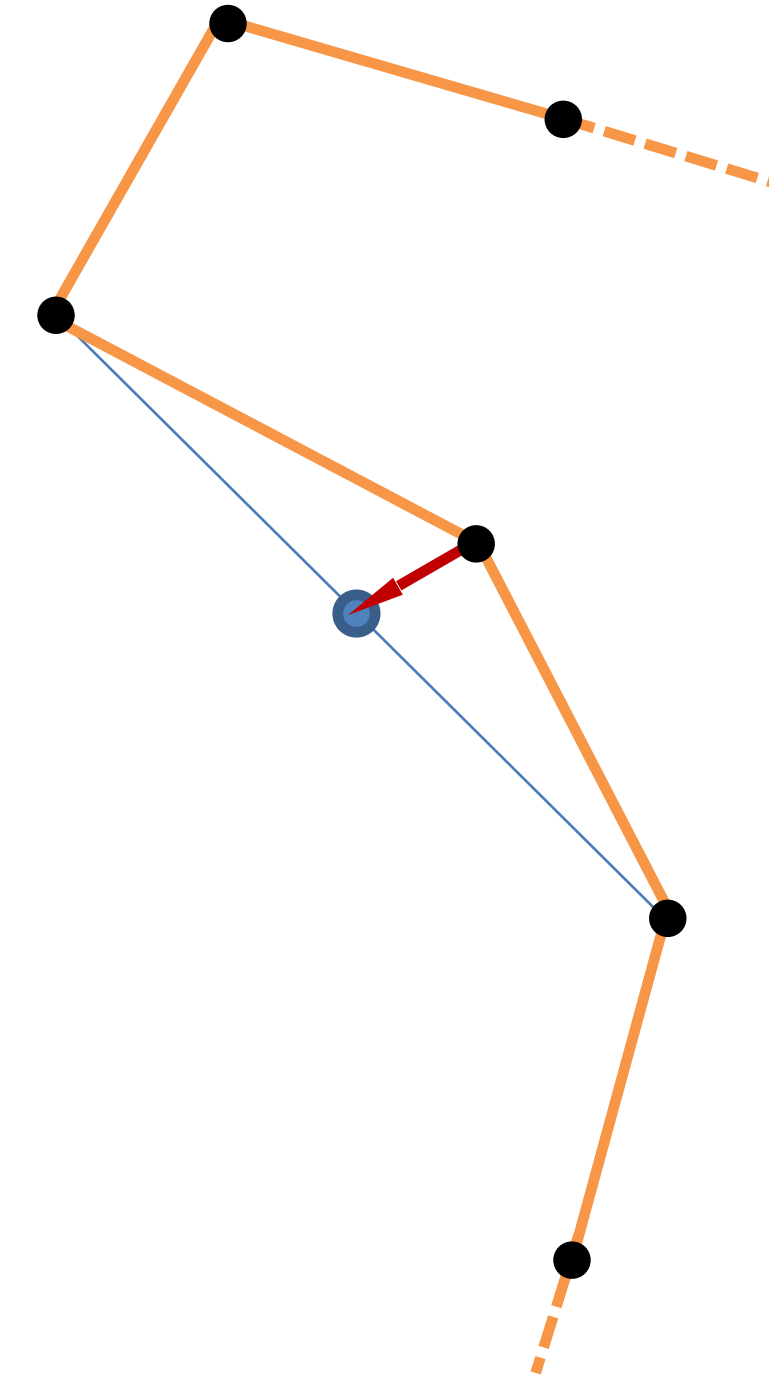
- Flow to reduce curvature:

$$\tilde{\mathbf{p}}_i = \mathbf{p}_i + \lambda \frac{d^2}{ds^2}(\mathbf{p}_i)$$

- Scale factor $0 < \lambda < 1$
- Matrix-vector form:

$$\tilde{\mathbf{p}} = \mathbf{p} + \lambda L \mathbf{p}, \quad \mathbf{p} \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times 2}$$

- Drawbacks?



Example – smoothing curves

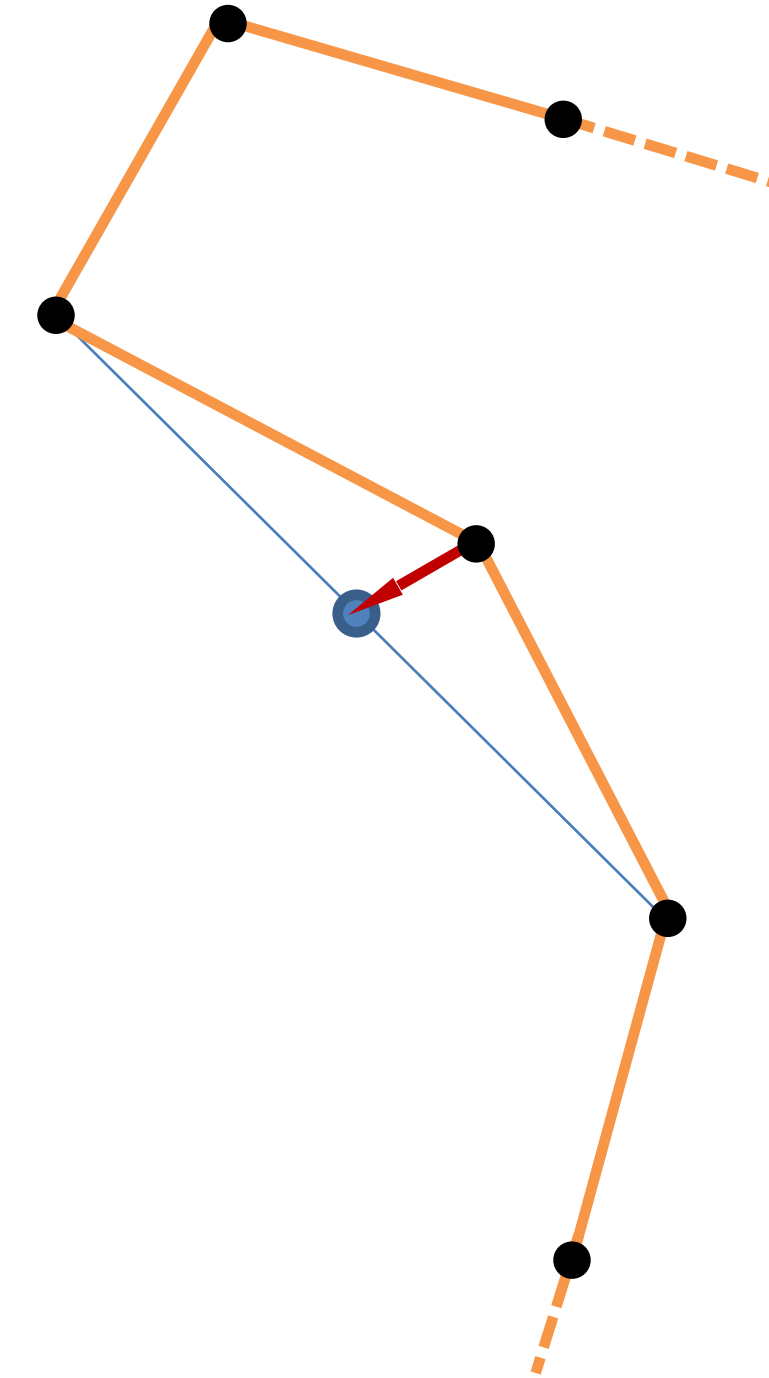
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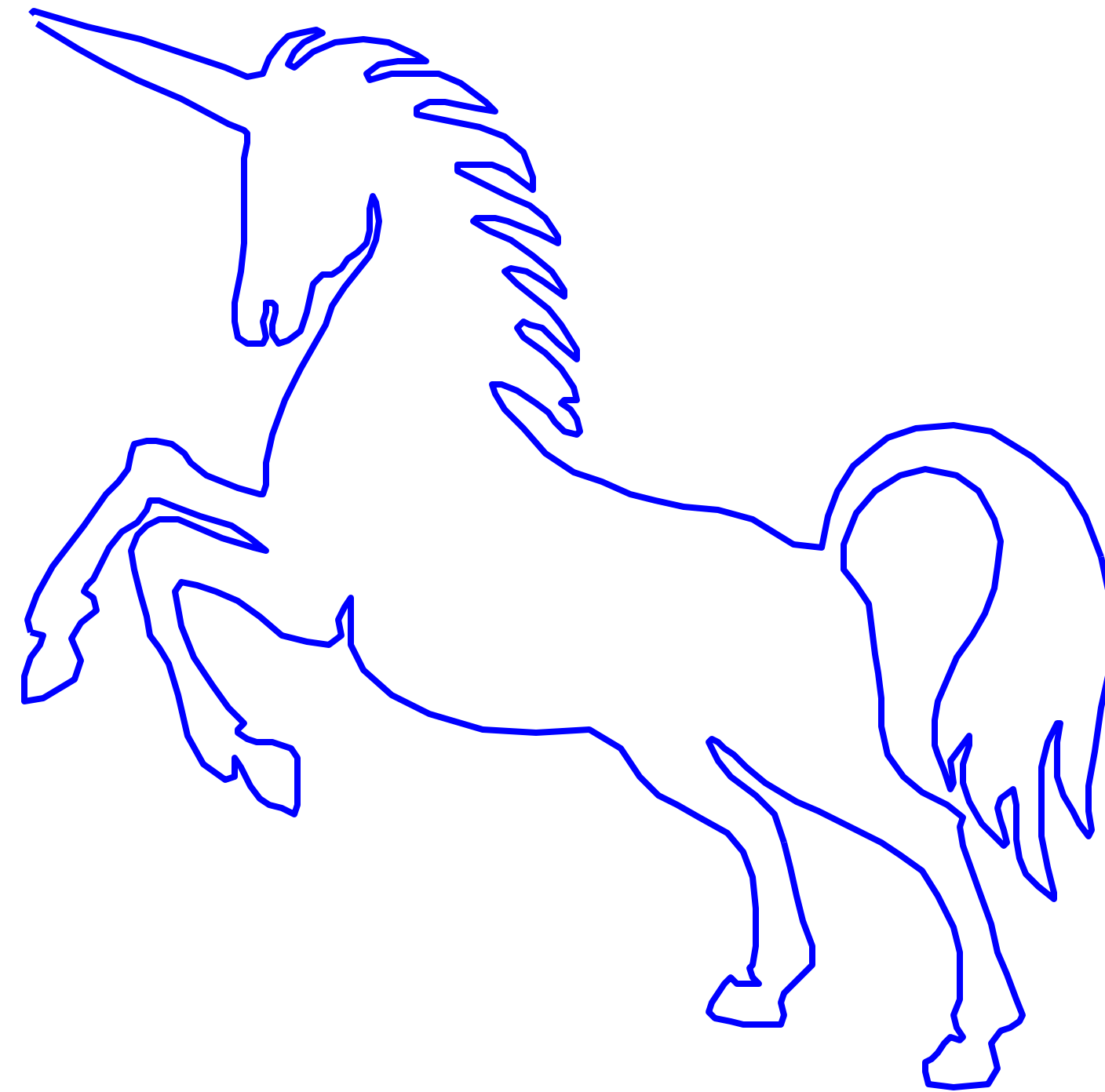
- Scale factor $0 < \lambda < 1$
- Matrix-vector form:

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- May shrink the shape; can be slow

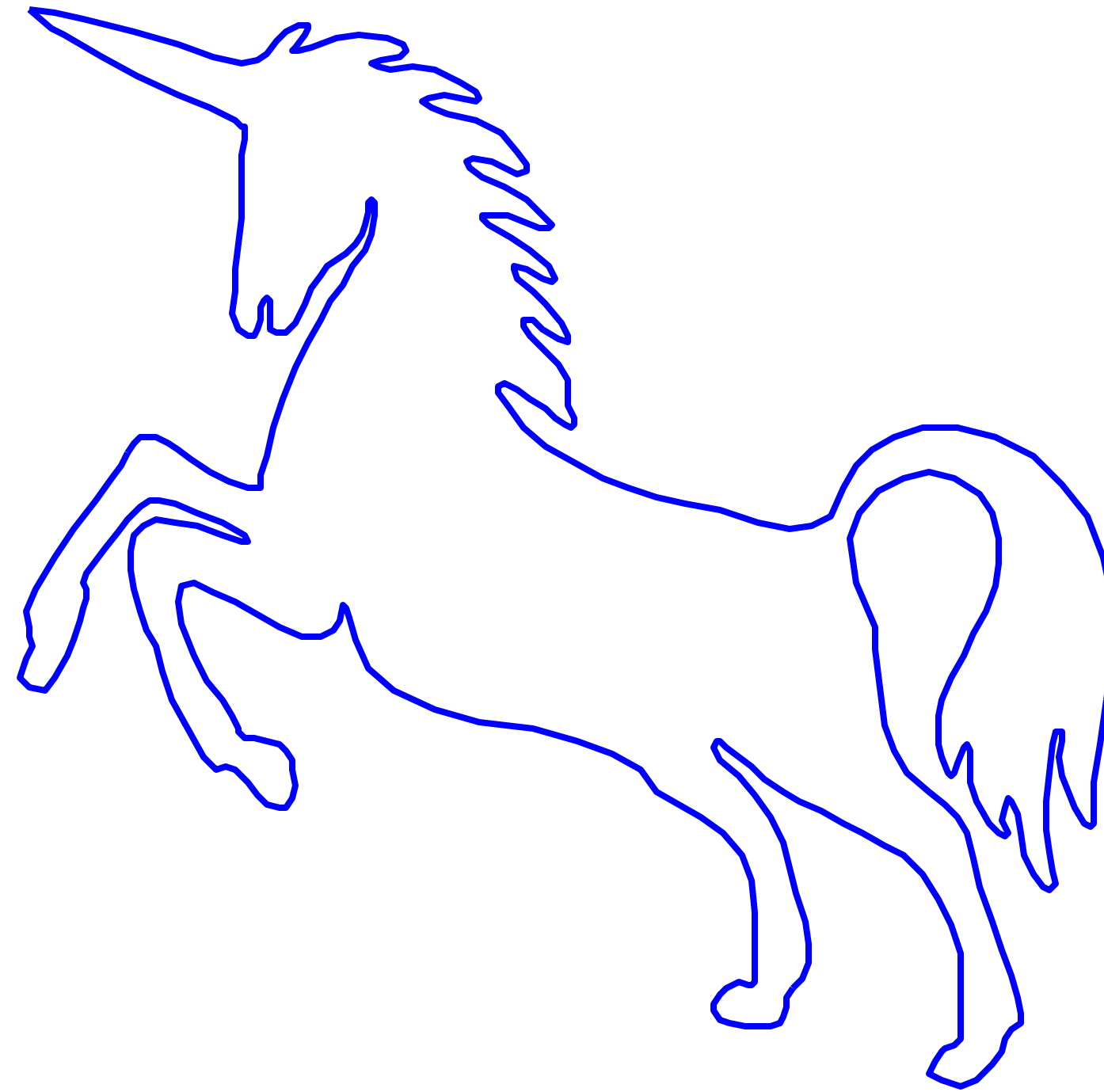


Filtering Curves



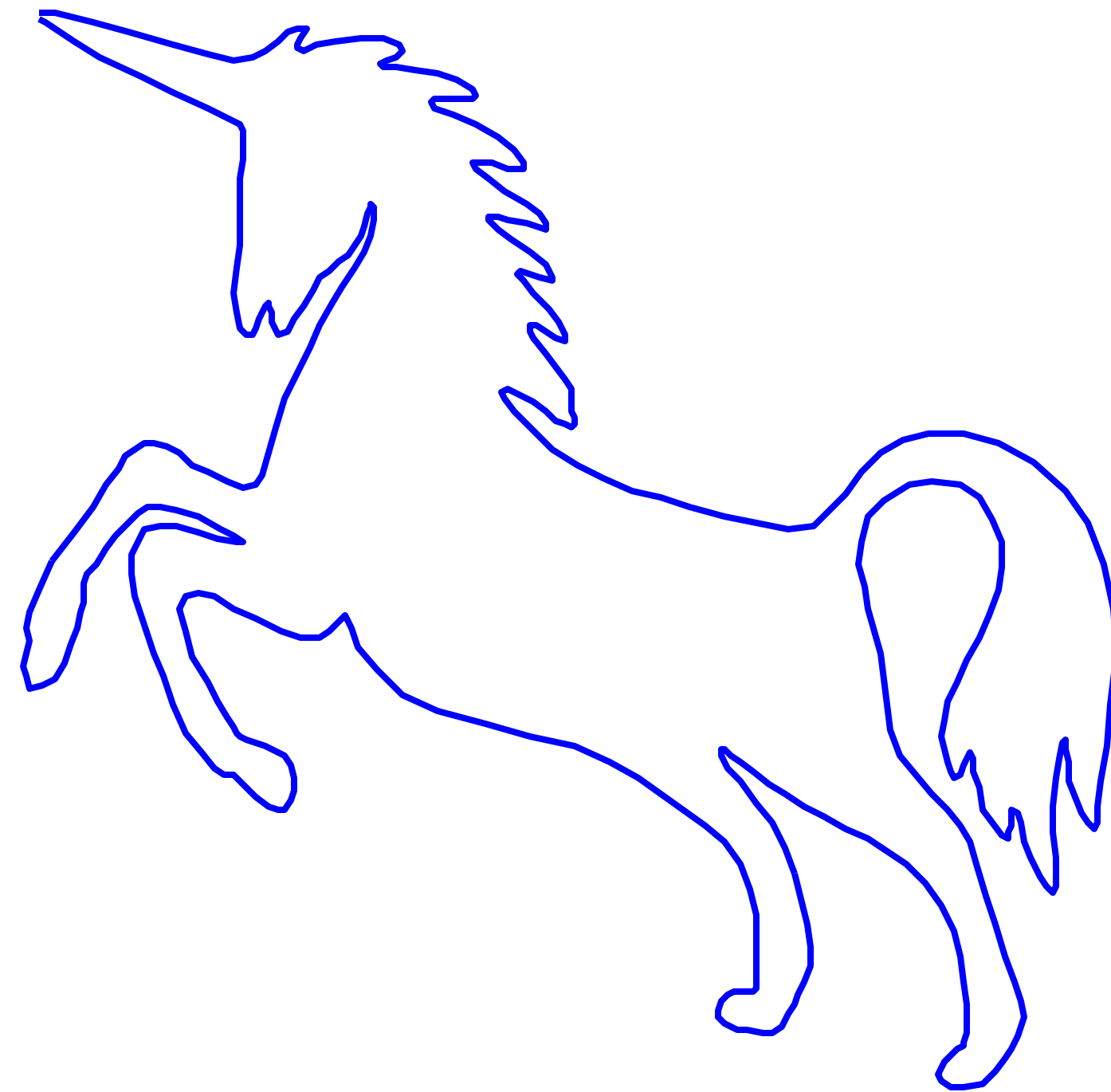
Original curve

Filtering Curves



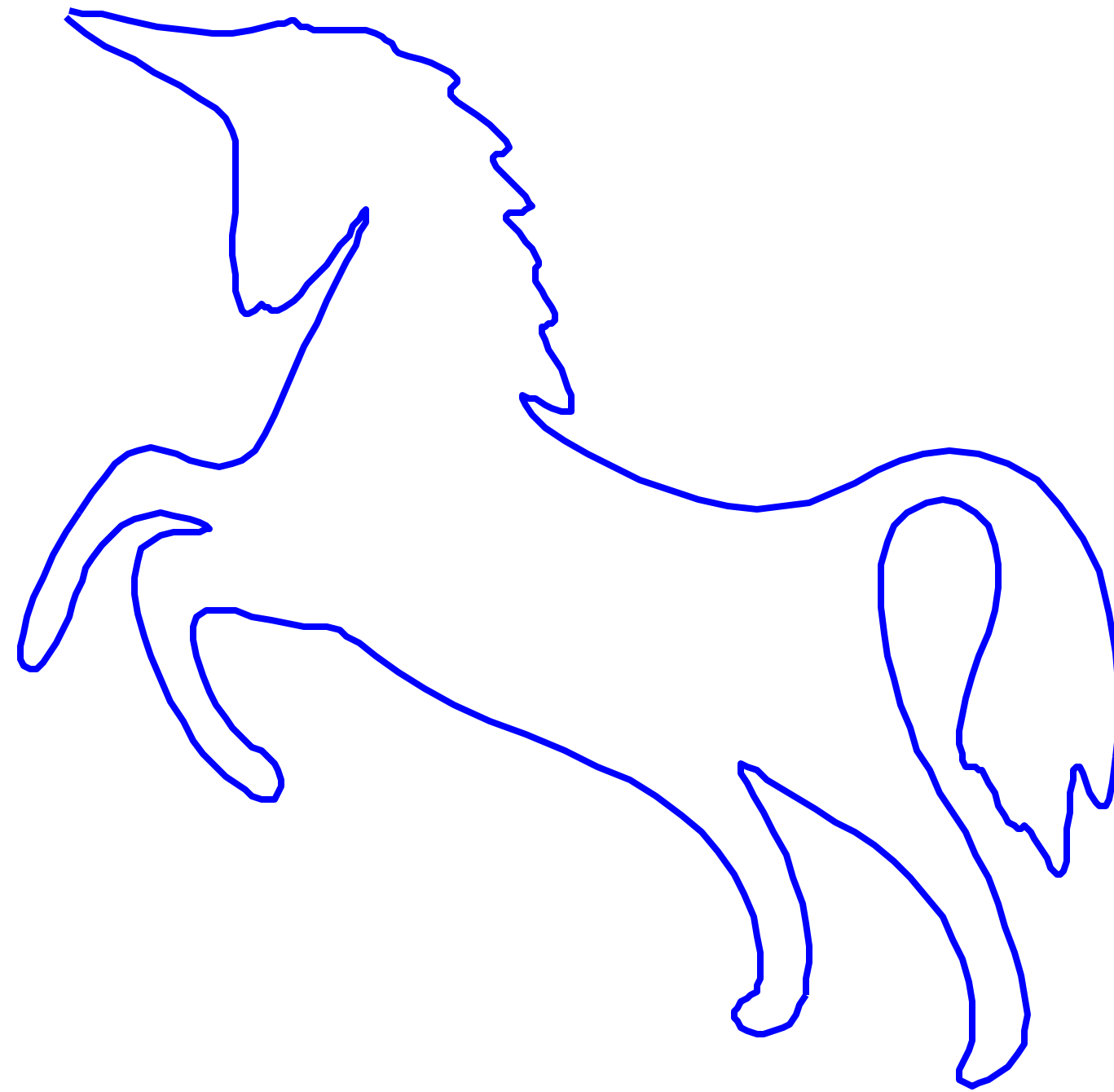
1st iteration; $\lambda=0.5$

Filtering Curves



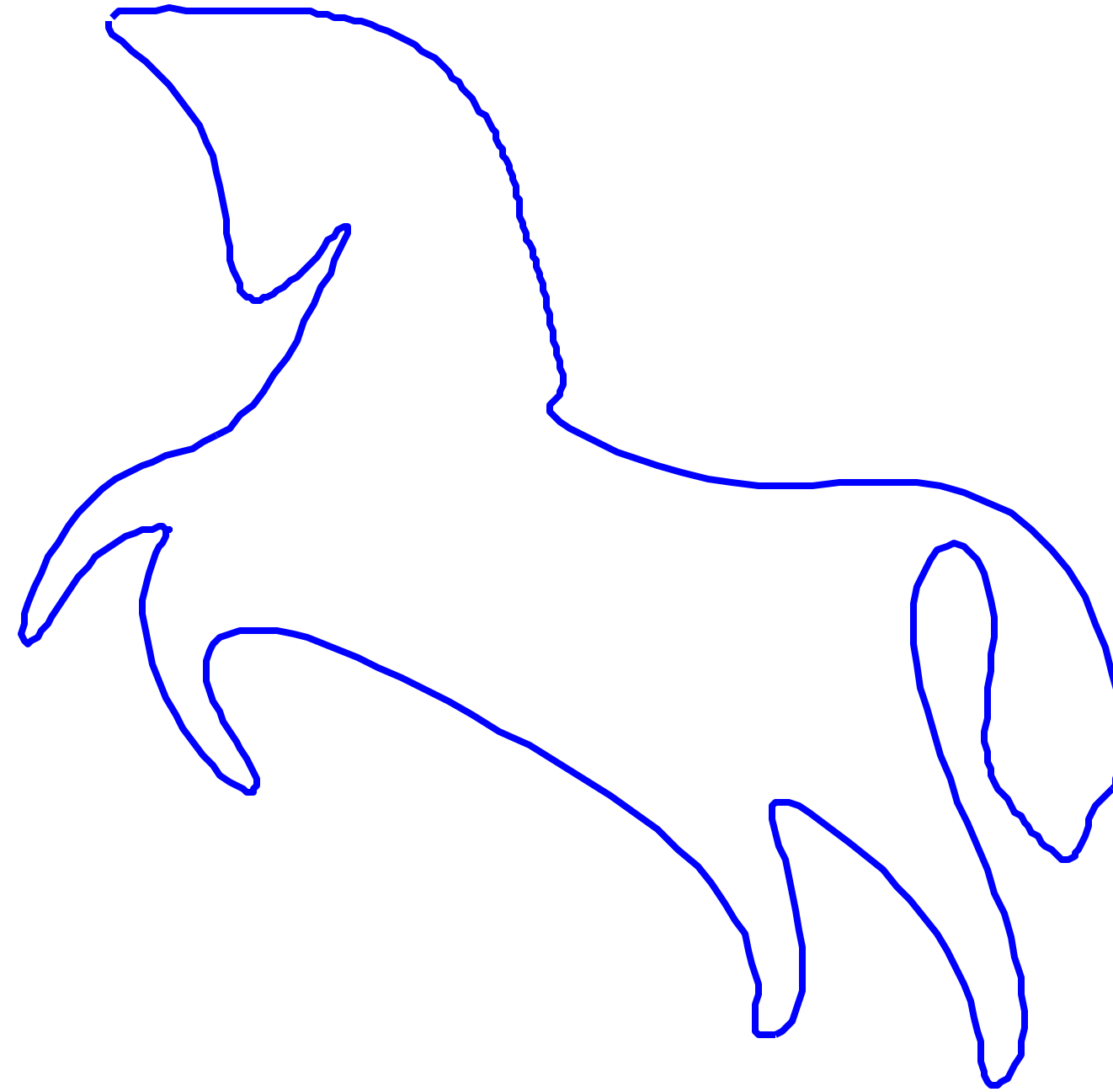
2nd iteration; $\lambda=0.5$

Filtering Curves



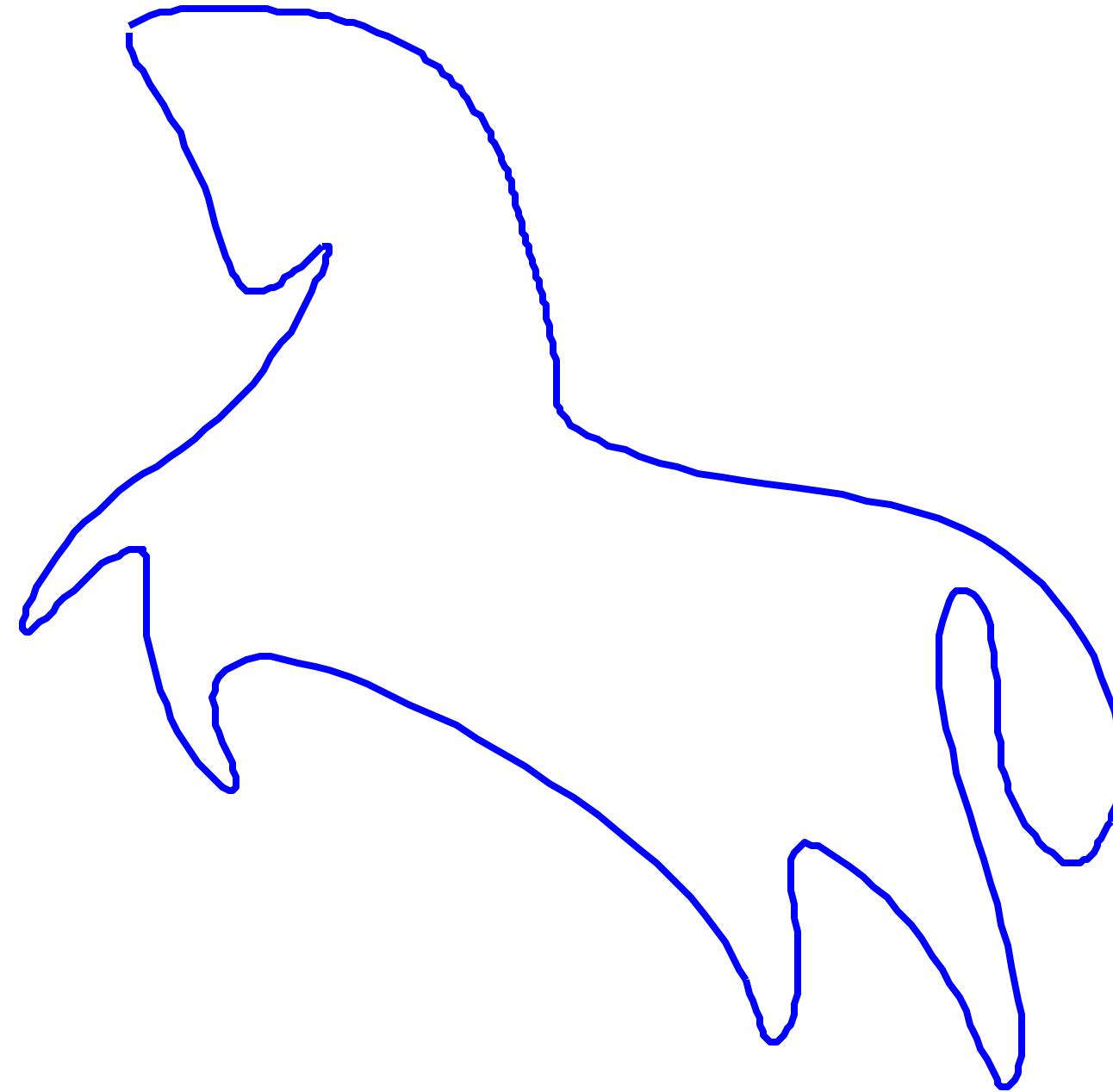
8th iteration; $\lambda=0.5$

Filtering Curves



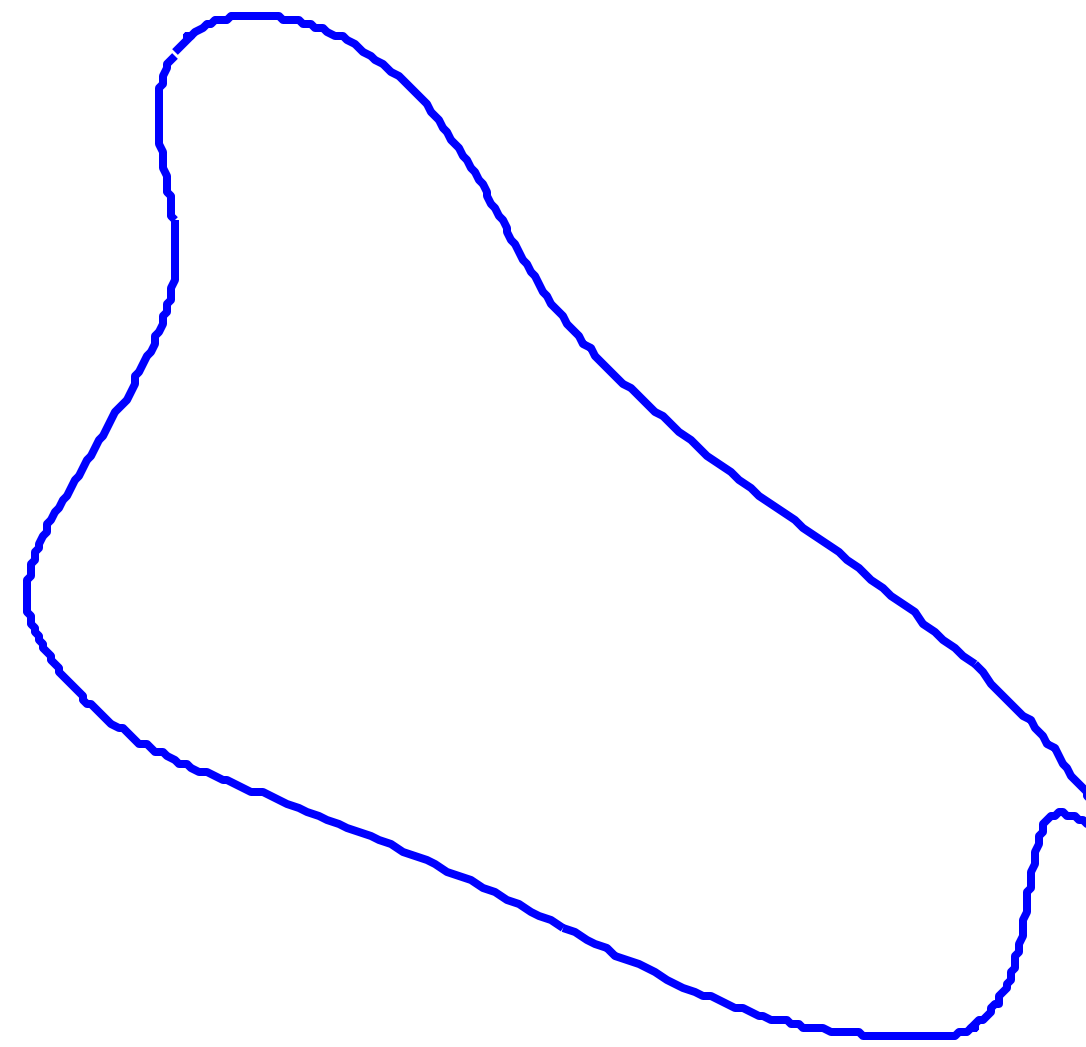
27th iteration; $\lambda=0.5$

Filtering Curves



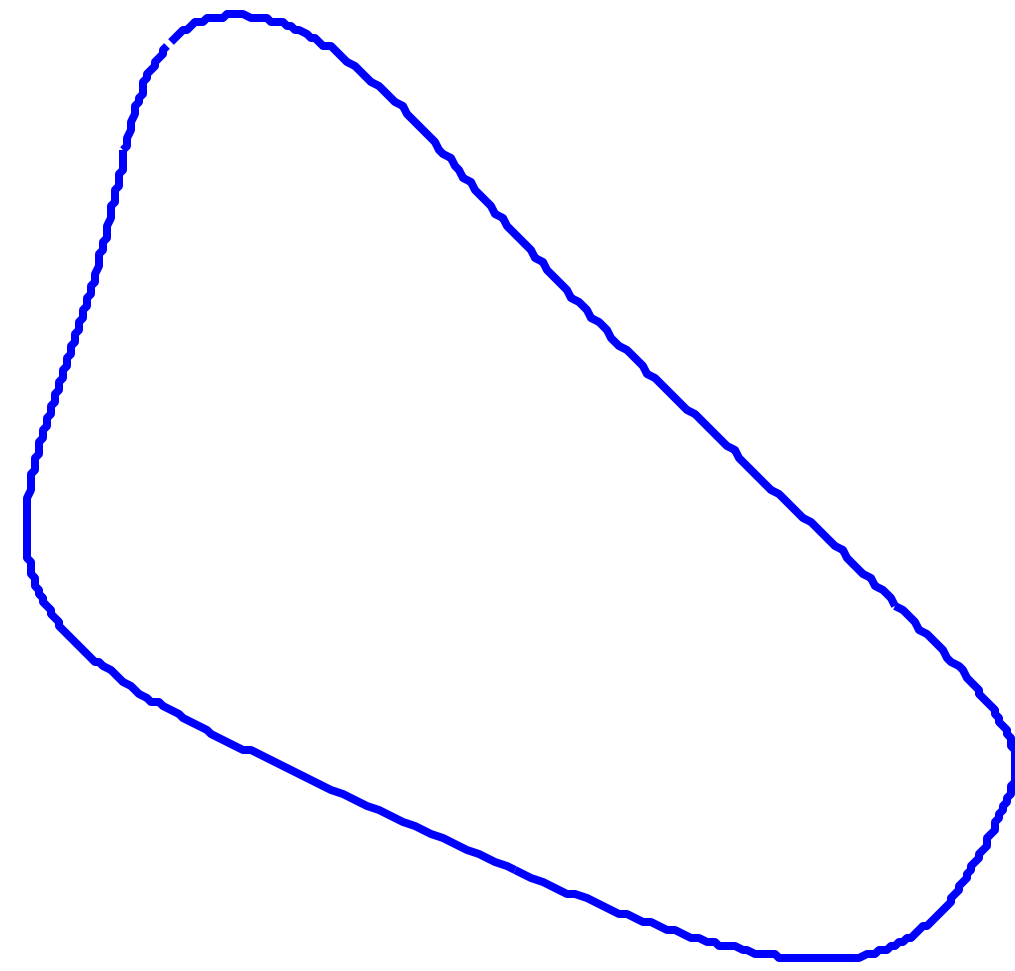
50th iteration; $\lambda=0.5$

Filtering Curves



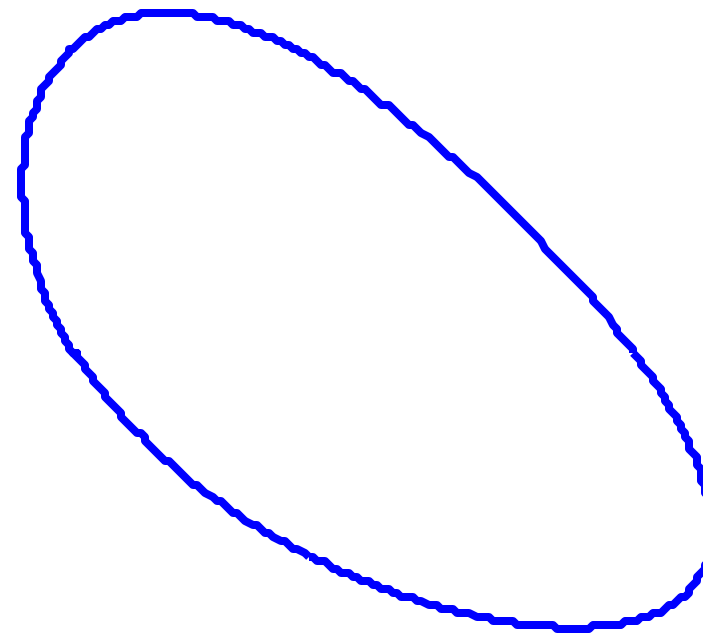
500th iteration; $\lambda=0.5$

Filtering Curves



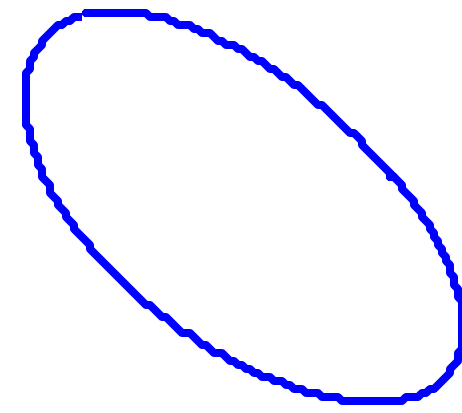
1000th iteration; $\lambda=0.5$

Filtering Curves



5000th iteration; $\lambda=0.5$

Filtering Curves



10000th iteration; $\lambda=0.5$

Filtering Curves

.

50000th iteration; $\lambda=0.5$

Smoothing as Mean Curvature Flow

- Model smoothing as a diffusion process

$$\boxed{\frac{\partial \mathbf{p}}{\partial t} = \lambda \Delta \mathbf{p}} = -2\lambda H \mathbf{n}$$

Smoothing as Mean Curvature Flow

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$$\boxed{\frac{\partial \mathbf{p}}{\partial t} = \lambda \Delta \mathbf{p}} = -2\lambda H \mathbf{n}$$

- Discretize in time, forward differences:

$$\frac{\mathbf{p}^{(n+1)} - \mathbf{p}^{(n)}}{dt} = \lambda L \mathbf{p}^{(n)}$$

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Smoothing as Mean Curvature Flow

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- Discretize in time, forward differences:

$$\frac{\mathbf{p}^{(n+1)} - \mathbf{p}^{(n)}}{dt} = \lambda L \mathbf{p}^{(n)}$$

$$\mathbf{p}^{(n+1)} - \mathbf{p}^{(n)} = dt \lambda L \mathbf{p}^{(n)}$$

$$\mathbf{p}^{(n+1)} = (I + dt \lambda L) \mathbf{p}^{(n)}$$

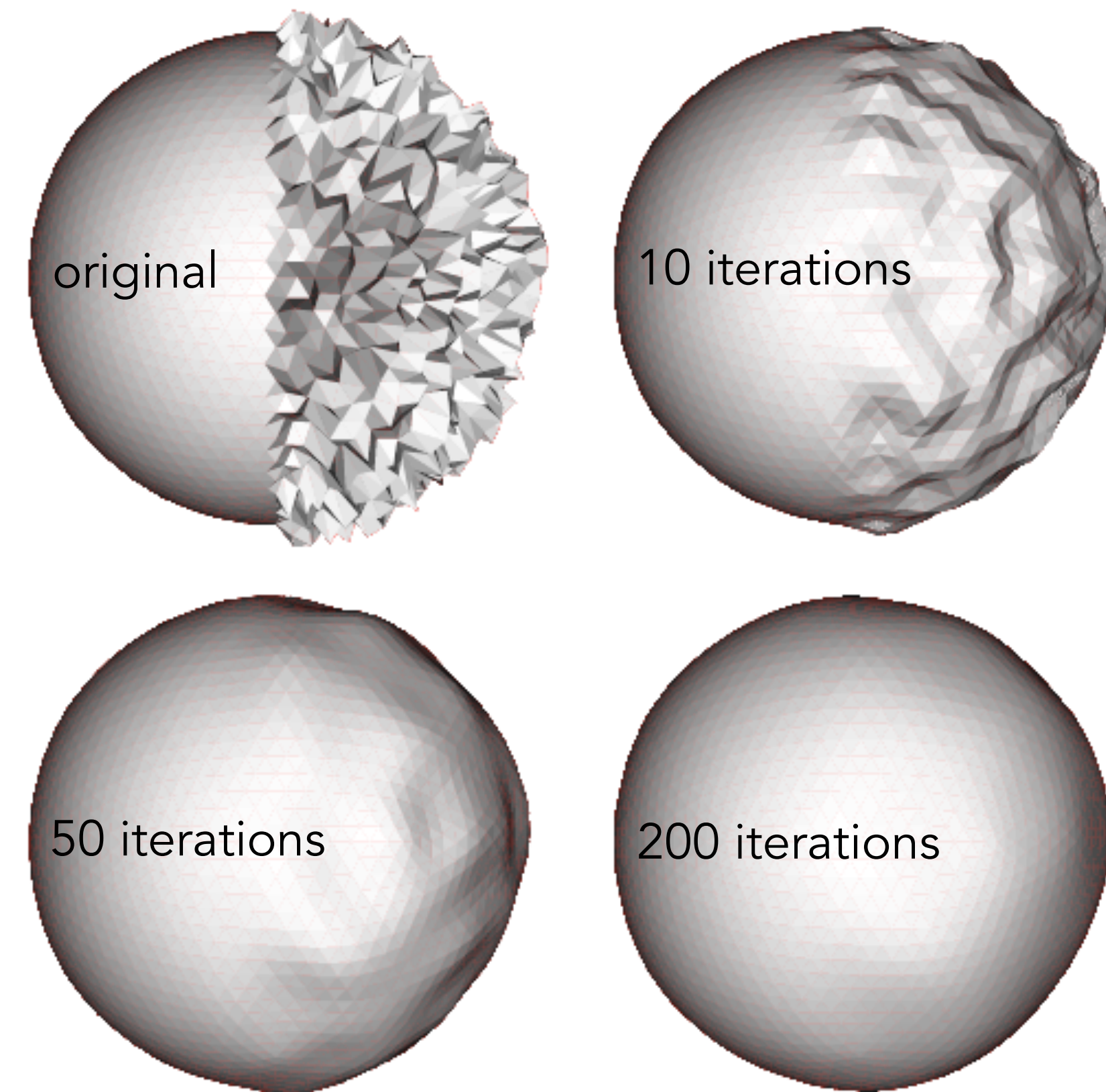
Explicit
integration!
Unstable
unless time
step dt is
small

Taubin Smoothing: Explicit Steps

- Iterate:

$$\tilde{\mathbf{p}} = \mathbf{p} + \lambda L\mathbf{p} = (I + \lambda L)\mathbf{p}$$

- $\lambda > 0$ to smooth
- $\lambda < 0$ to inflate
- Originally proposed with uniform Laplacian weights



A Signal Processing Approach to Fair Surface Design
Gabriel Taubin, ACM SIGGRAPH 95



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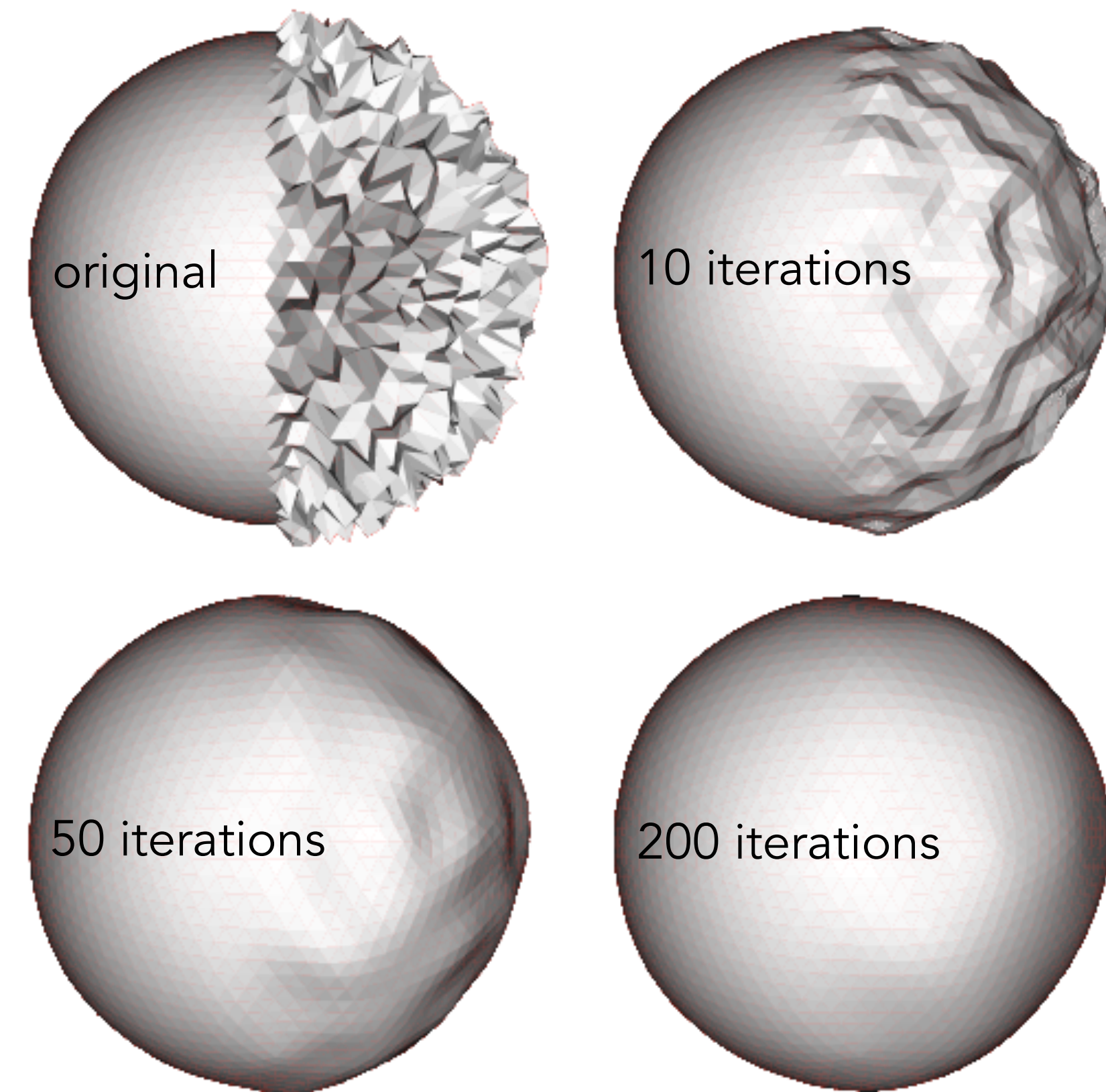
Taubin Smoothing: Explicit Steps

- Iterate:

$$\tilde{\mathbf{p}} = \mathbf{p} + \lambda L\mathbf{p} = (I + \lambda L)\mathbf{p}$$

$$\tilde{\mathbf{p}} = \mathbf{p} + \mu L\mathbf{p} = (I + \mu L)\mathbf{p}$$

- $\lambda > 0$ to smooth
- $u < 0$ to inflate
- Originally proposed with uniform Laplacian weights



A Signal Processing Approach to Fair Surface Design
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Taubin Smoothing: Explicit Steps

- Per-vertex iterations

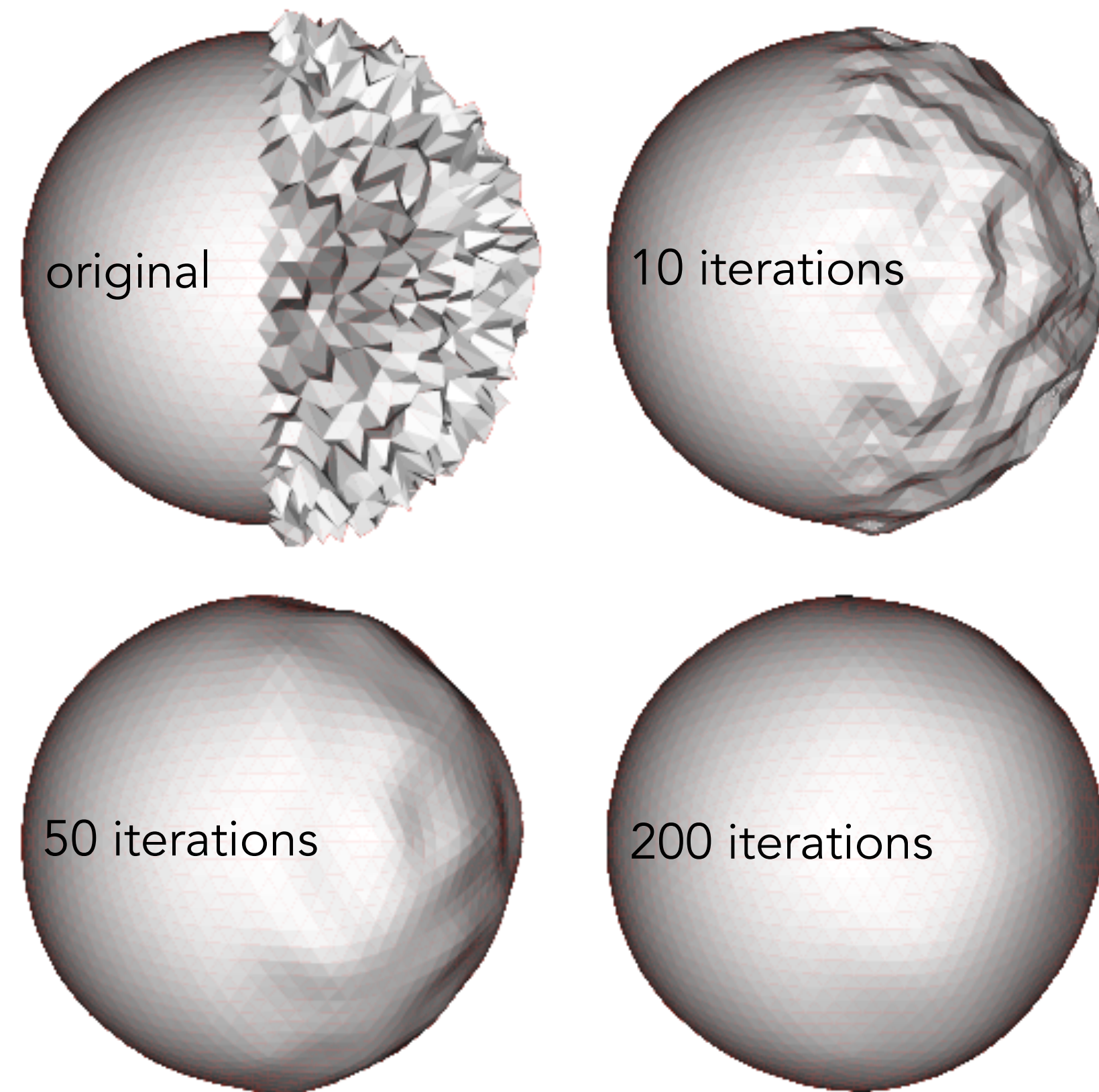
$$\tilde{\mathbf{p}}_i = \mathbf{p}_i + \lambda L(\mathbf{p}_i)$$

$$\tilde{\mathbf{p}}_i = \mathbf{p}_i + \mu L(\mathbf{p}_i)$$

- Simple to implement

- Requires many iterations

- Need to tweak λ , μ



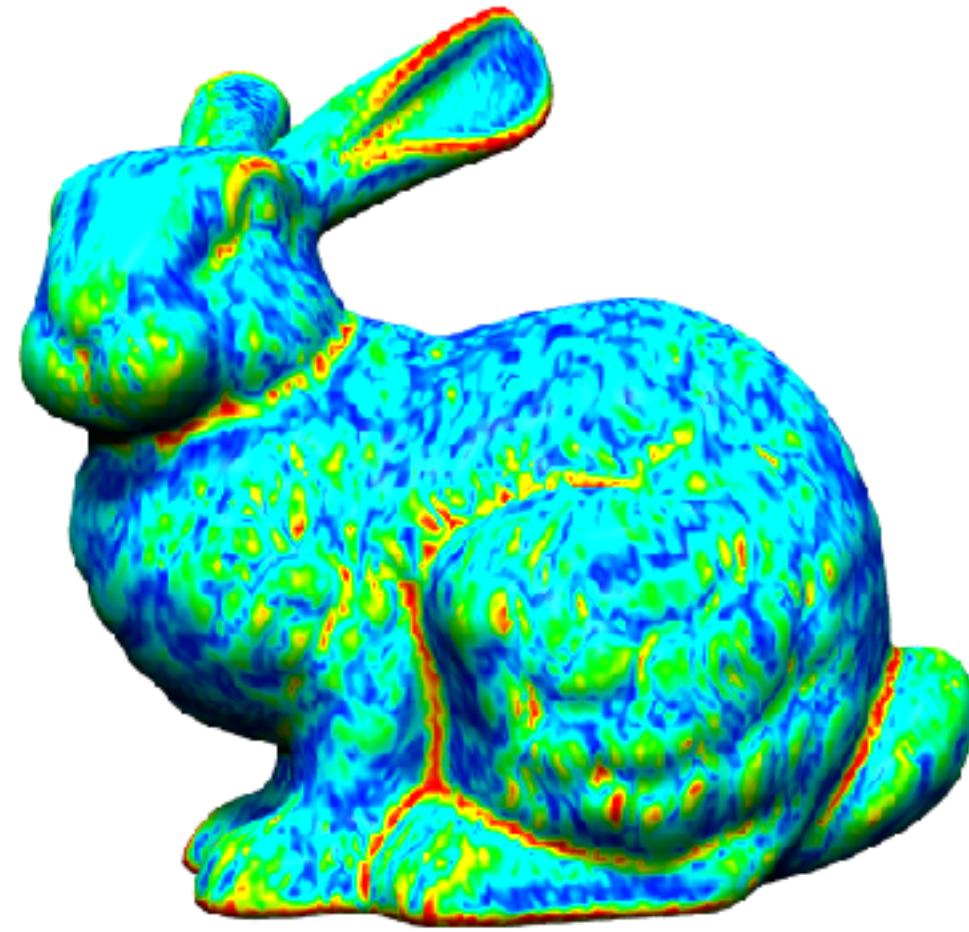
A Signal Processing Approach to Fair Surface Design
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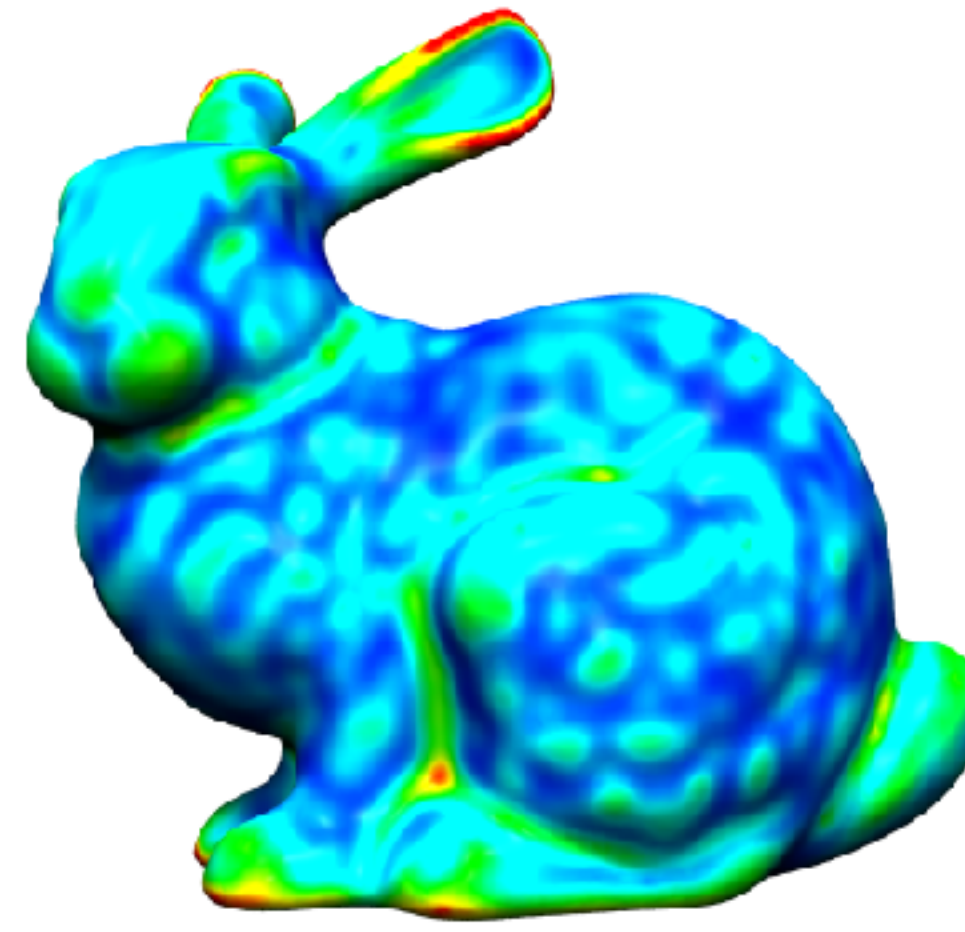
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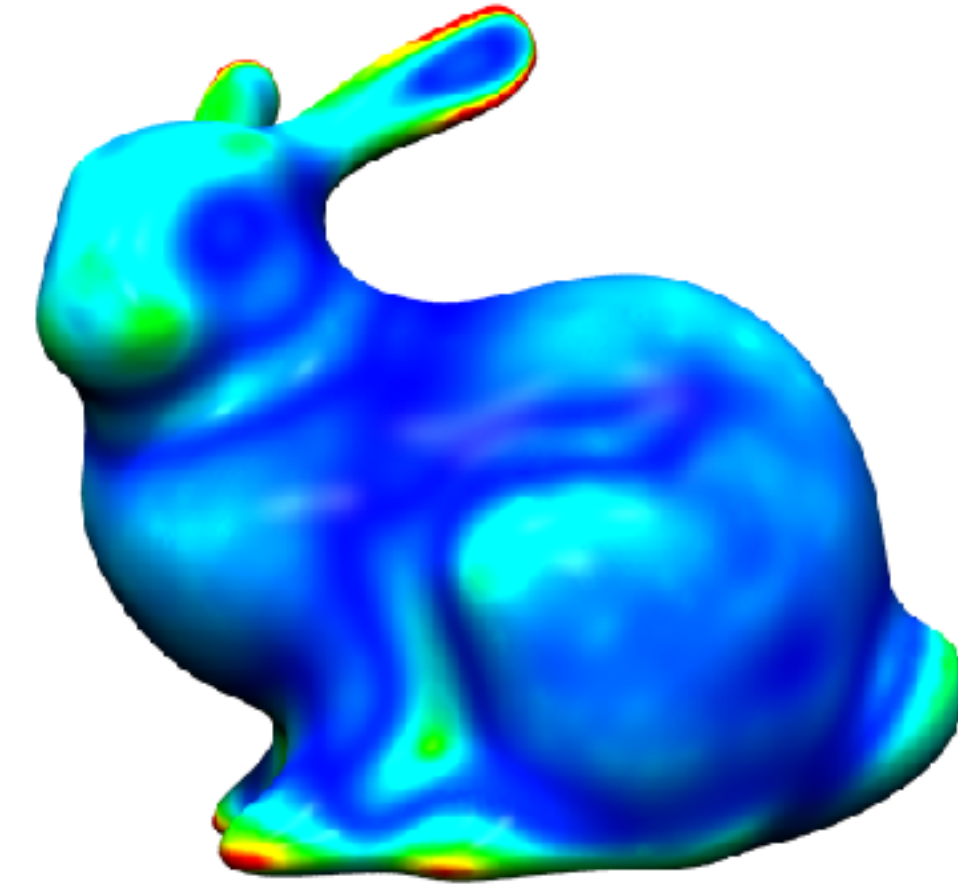
Example



0 iterations



10 iterations



100 iterations

Smoothing as (mean curvature) Flow

- Model smoothing as a diffusion process

$$\frac{\partial \mathbf{p}}{\partial t} = \lambda \Delta \mathbf{p} = -2\lambda H \mathbf{n}$$

- Backward Euler for unconditional stability

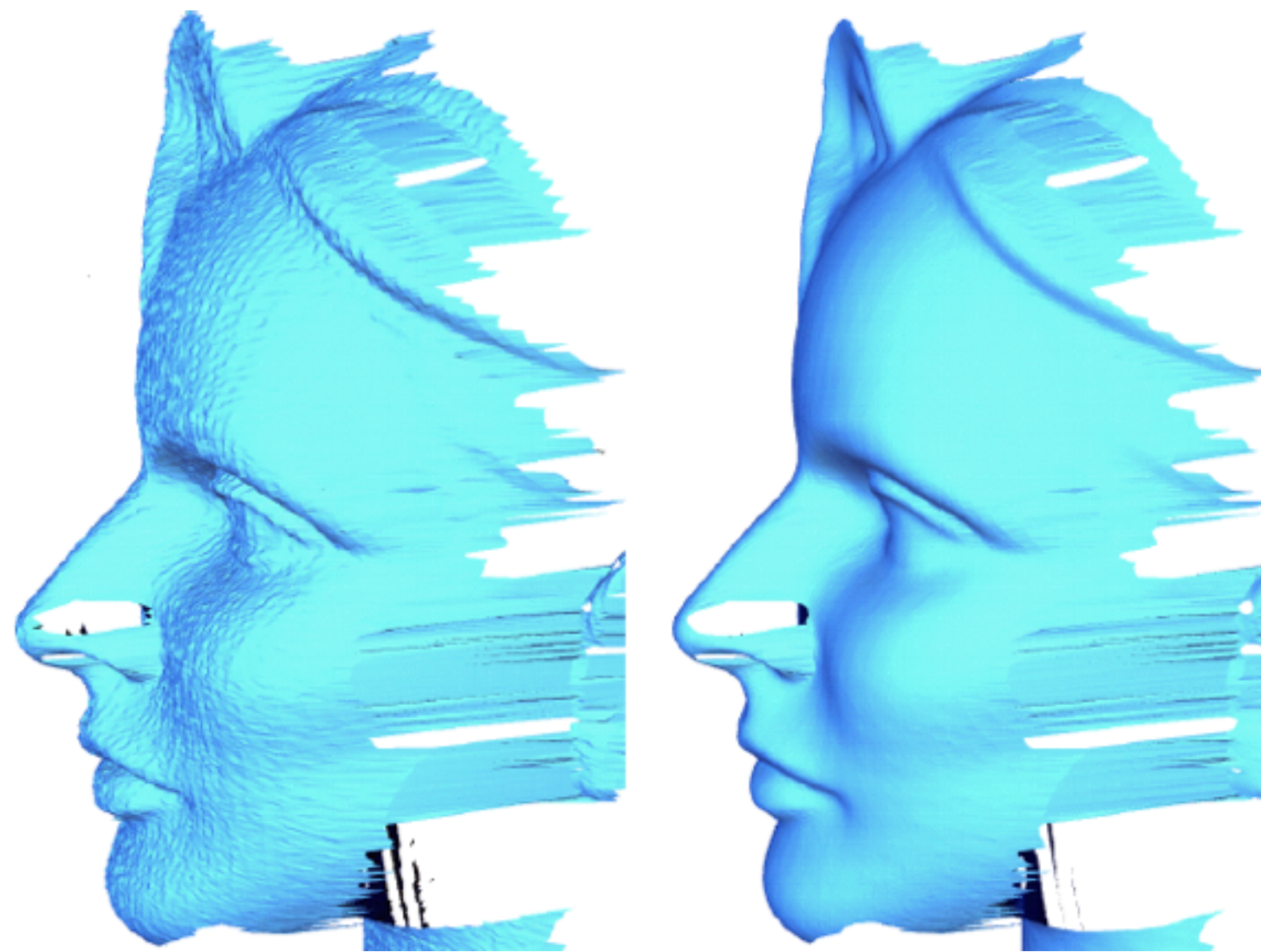
$$\frac{\mathbf{p}^{(n+1)} - \mathbf{p}^{(n)}}{dt} = \lambda L \mathbf{p}^{(n+1)}$$

$$\mathbf{p}^{(n+1)} - \mathbf{p}^{(n)} = dt \lambda L \mathbf{p}^{(n+1)}$$

$$(I - dt \lambda L) \mathbf{p}^{(n+1)} = \mathbf{p}^{(n)}$$

Implicit Fairing: Implicit Euler Steps

- In each iteration, solve for the smoothed $\tilde{\mathbf{p}}$:
$$(I - \lambda L)\tilde{\mathbf{p}} = \mathbf{p}$$

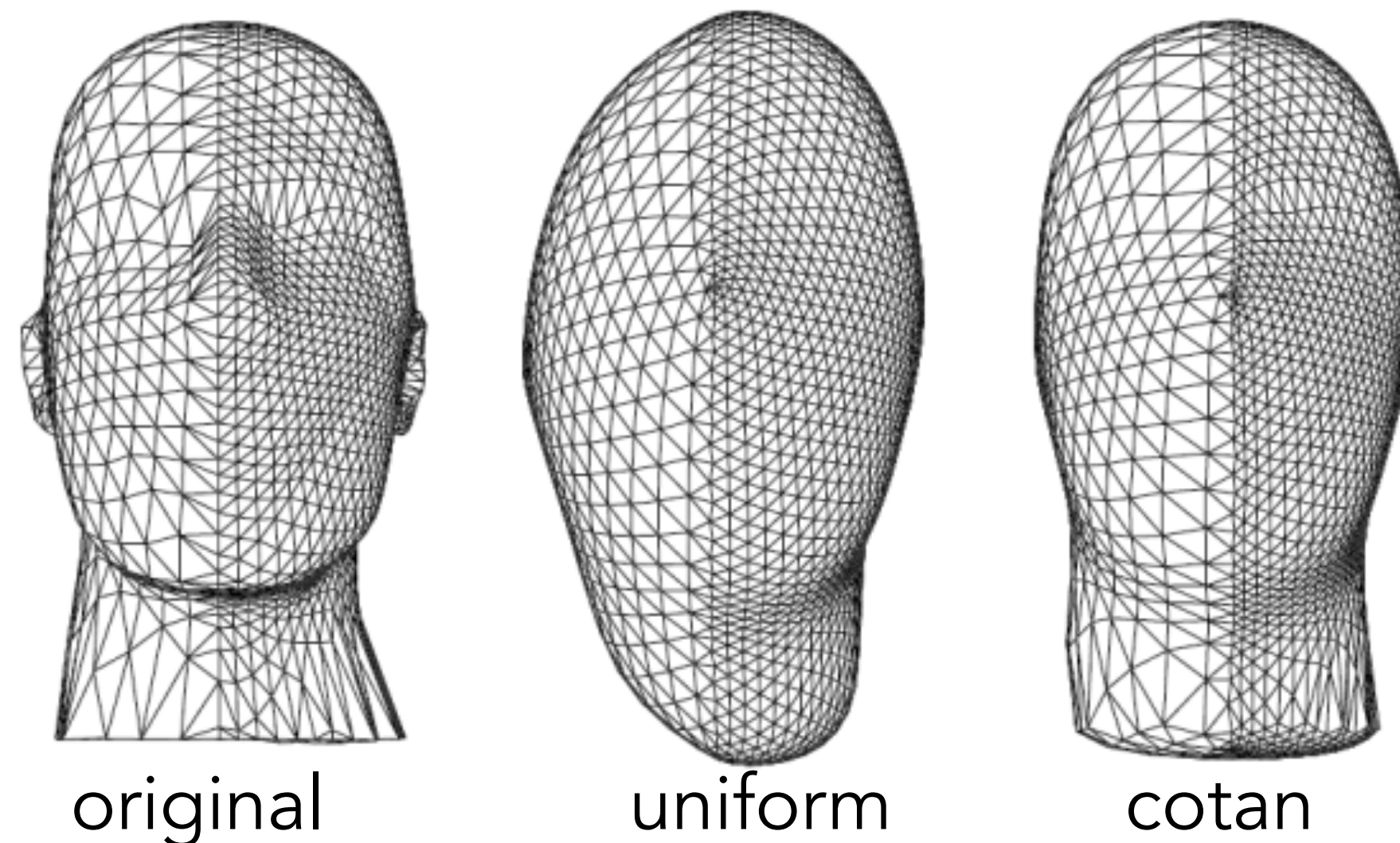


Implicit fairing of irregular meshes using diffusion and curvature flow

M. Desbrun, M. Meyer, P. Schroeder, A. Barr, **ACM SIGGRAPH 99**

Mesh Independence

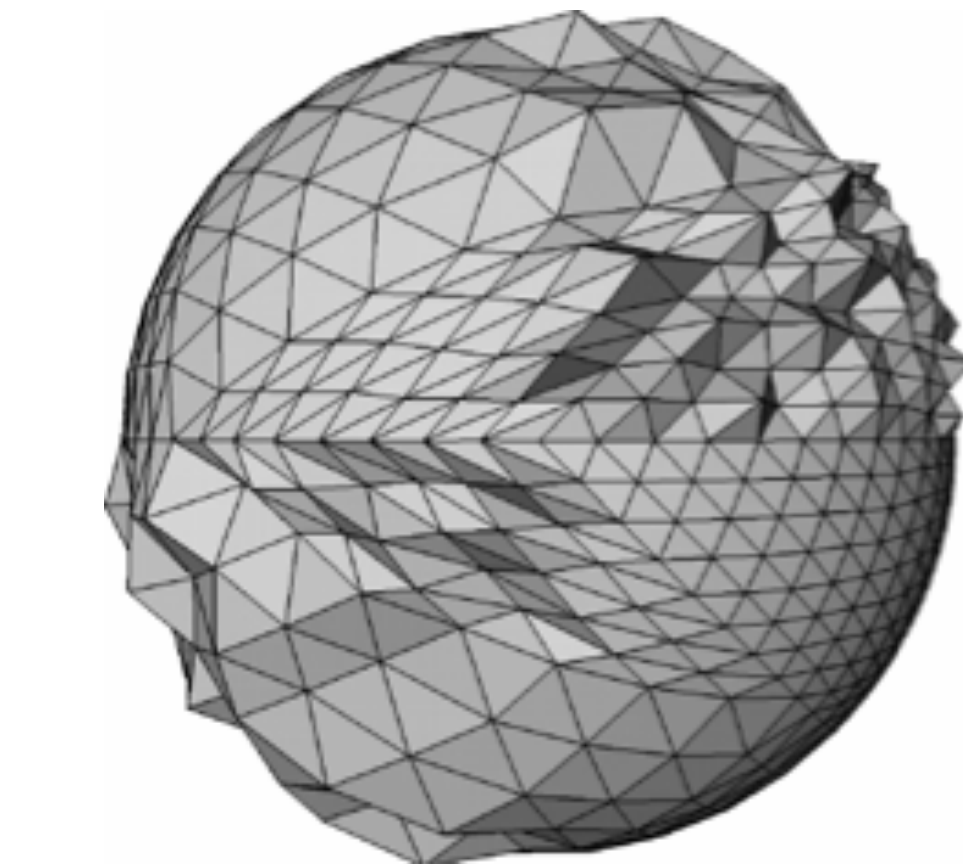
- Result of smoothing with uniform Laplacian depends on triangle density and shape
 - Why?
- Asymmetric results although underlying geometry is symmetric



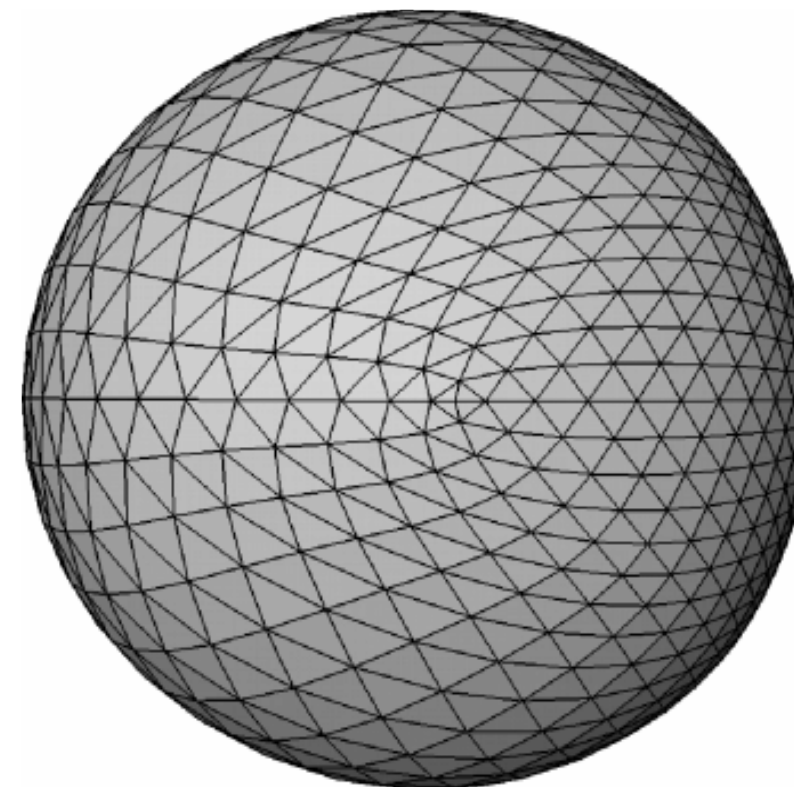
Comparison of the weights

- Explicit flow with different weights:

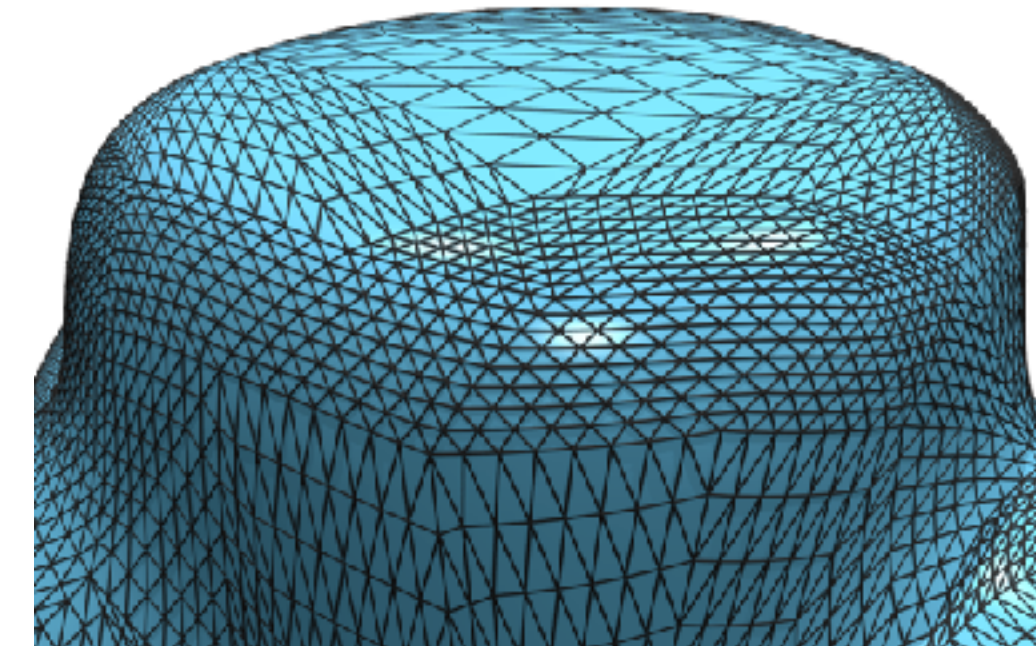
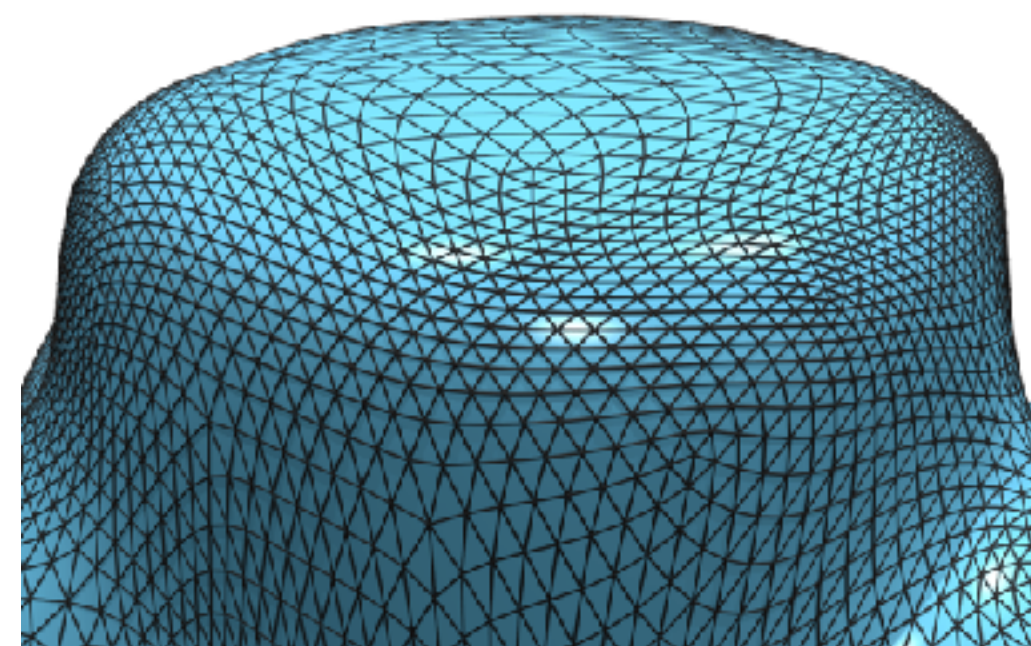
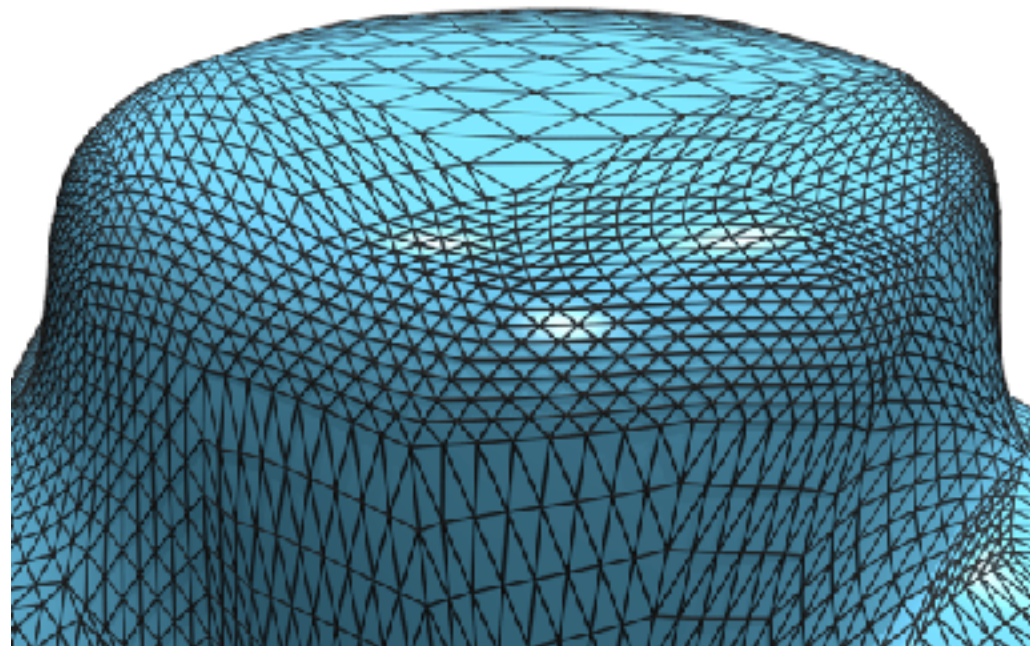
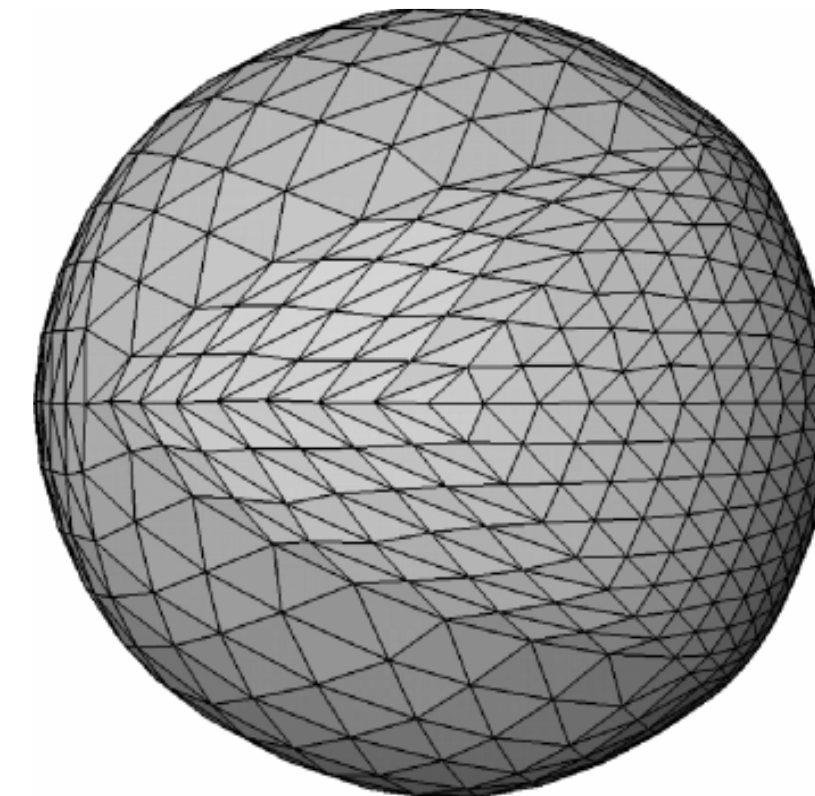
original



uniform

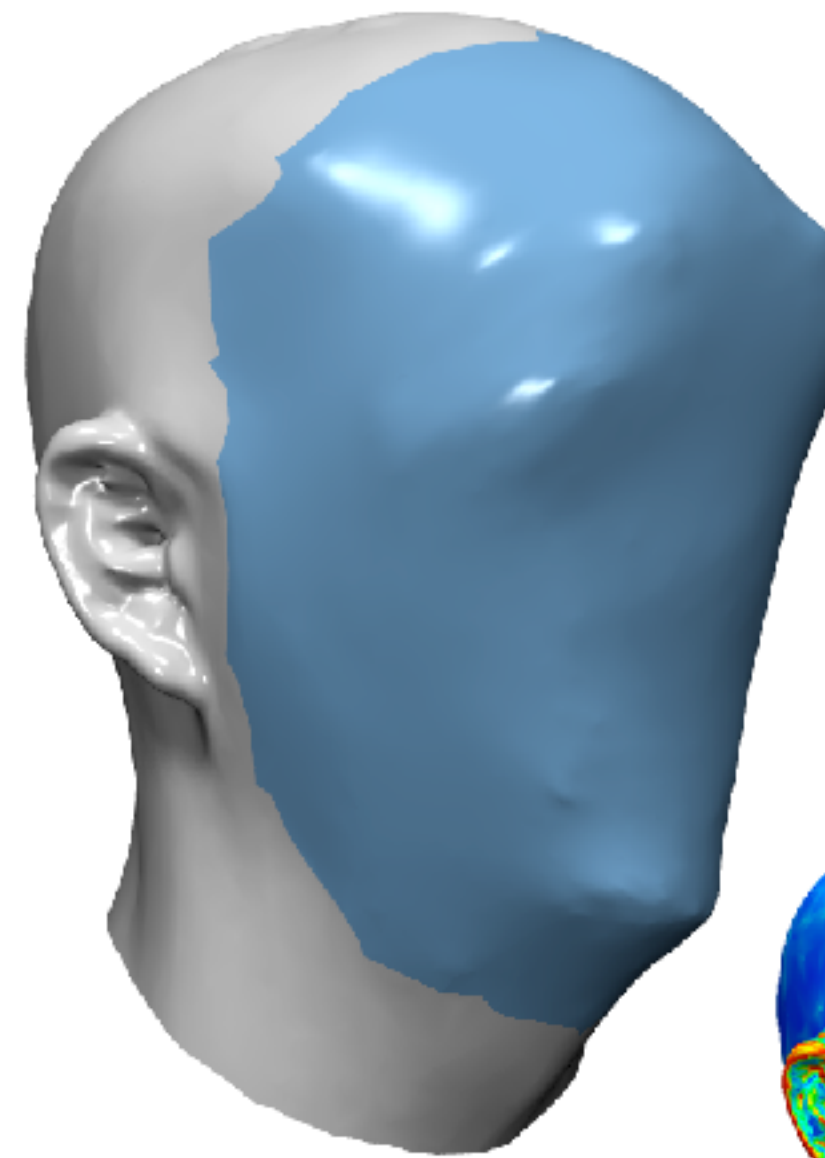
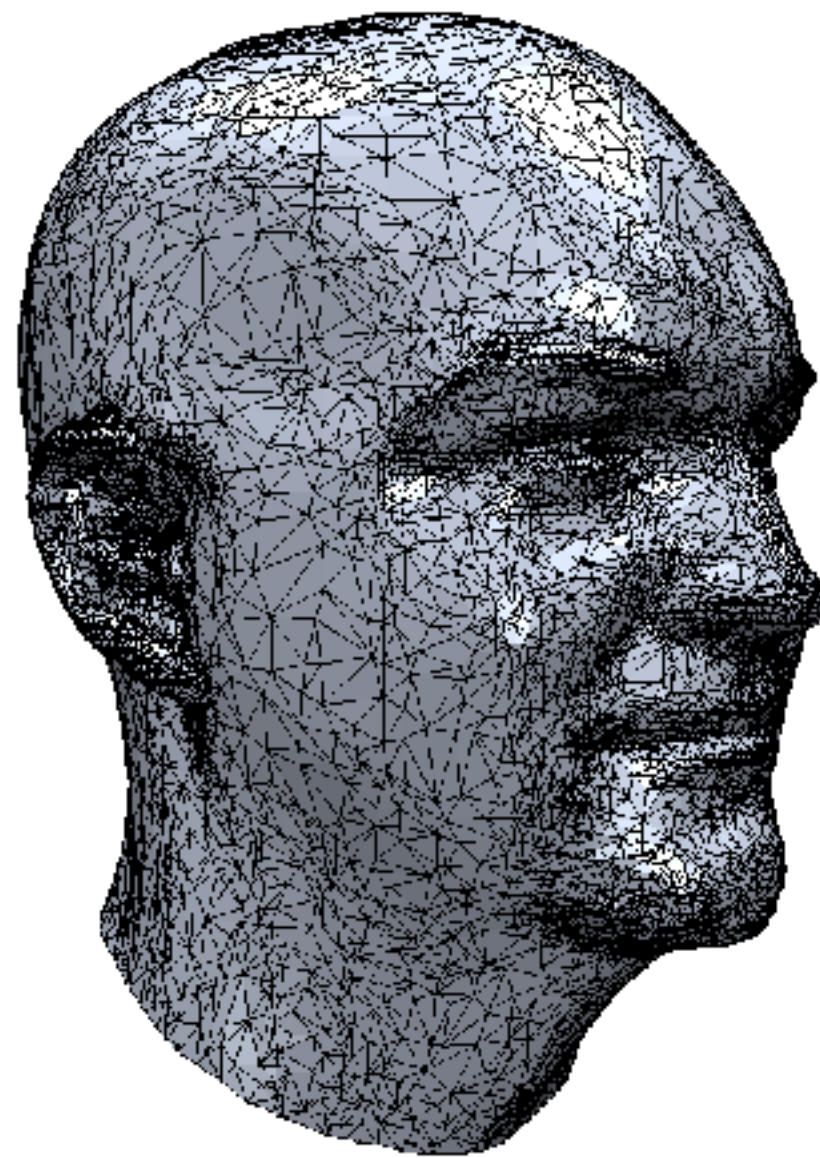


cotan



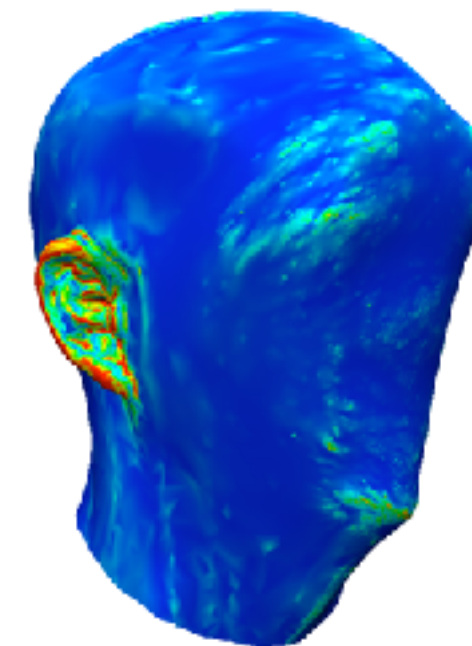
Implicit Fairing

- The importance of using the right weights



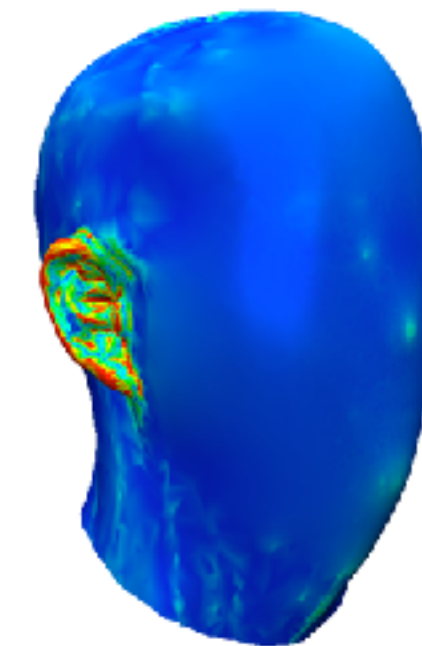
uniform

Mean
curvature



cotan

Mean
curvature



Method 2: Smoothing as Optimization

Minimizing a smoothness energy

- Let's go for $H = 0$ $\Delta_{\mathcal{M}} \mathbf{p} = -2H \mathbf{n}$
goal: $H = 0$ or $H = \text{const}$
- only trivial solution, no connection to initial surface p

$$\Delta_{\mathcal{M}} \tilde{\mathbf{p}} = 0$$

Minimizing a smoothness energy

- Let's go for $H = 0$ $\Delta_{\mathcal{M}} \mathbf{p} = -2H \mathbf{n}$
goal: $H = 0$ or $H = \text{const}$
- only trivial solution, no connection to initial surface $\mathbf{p}$
- Let's regularize!

$$\Delta_{\mathcal{M}} \tilde{\mathbf{p}} = 0$$

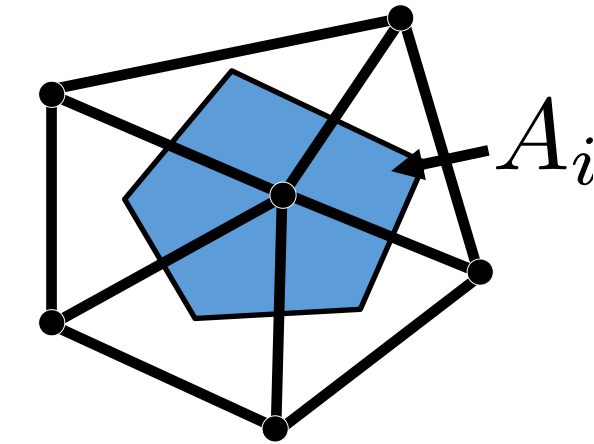
$$\min_{\tilde{\mathbf{p}}} \int_{\mathcal{M}} \underbrace{\|\Delta_{\mathcal{M}} \tilde{\mathbf{p}}\|^2}_{\text{small } H} + \underbrace{w \|\tilde{\mathbf{p}} - \mathbf{p}\|^2}_{\text{stay close to original surface}}$$

weighting factor

Minimizing a smoothness energy

- Discretize:
$$\min_{\tilde{\mathbf{p}}} \int_{\mathcal{M}} \|\Delta_{\mathcal{M}} \tilde{\mathbf{p}}\|^2 + w \|\tilde{\mathbf{p}} - \mathbf{p}\|^2$$

$$\min_{\tilde{\mathbf{p}}} \sum_{i=1}^n A_i \left(\|L \tilde{\mathbf{p}}_i\|^2 + w \|\tilde{\mathbf{p}}_i - \mathbf{p}_i\|^2 \right)$$



- Minimize!

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial \tilde{\mathbf{p}}} = 0 \quad \text{remember: } \frac{\partial}{\partial \mathbf{x}} (\mathbf{x}^T A \mathbf{x}) = (A + A^T) \mathbf{x}$$

tip: google "The Matrix Cookbook"

Minimizing a smoothness energy

$$\min_{\tilde{\mathbf{p}}} \sum_{i=1}^n A_i \left(\|L\tilde{\mathbf{p}}_i\|^2 + w\|\tilde{\mathbf{p}}_i - \mathbf{p}_i\|^2 \right)$$

$$\tilde{\mathbf{p}} = [\tilde{\mathbf{x}} \ \tilde{\mathbf{y}} \ \tilde{\mathbf{z}}] = \begin{pmatrix} \tilde{p}_{1x} & \tilde{p}_{1y} & \tilde{p}_{1z} \\ \tilde{p}_{2x} & \tilde{p}_{2y} & \tilde{p}_{2z} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \vdots \\ \tilde{p}_{nx} & \tilde{p}_{ny} & \tilde{p}_{nz} \end{pmatrix} \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times 3}$$

$$E(\tilde{\mathbf{p}}) = (L\tilde{\mathbf{p}})^T M(L\tilde{\mathbf{p}}) + w(\tilde{\mathbf{p}} - \mathbf{p})^T M(\tilde{\mathbf{p}} - \mathbf{p})$$

$$\frac{\partial E}{\partial \tilde{\mathbf{p}}} = 2L^T M L \tilde{\mathbf{p}} + 2wM(\tilde{\mathbf{p}} - \mathbf{p}) \stackrel{!}{=} 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \underline{(L^T M L + wM) \tilde{\mathbf{p}} = wM\mathbf{p}} \quad \text{compare with implicit Euler!}$$

NB :

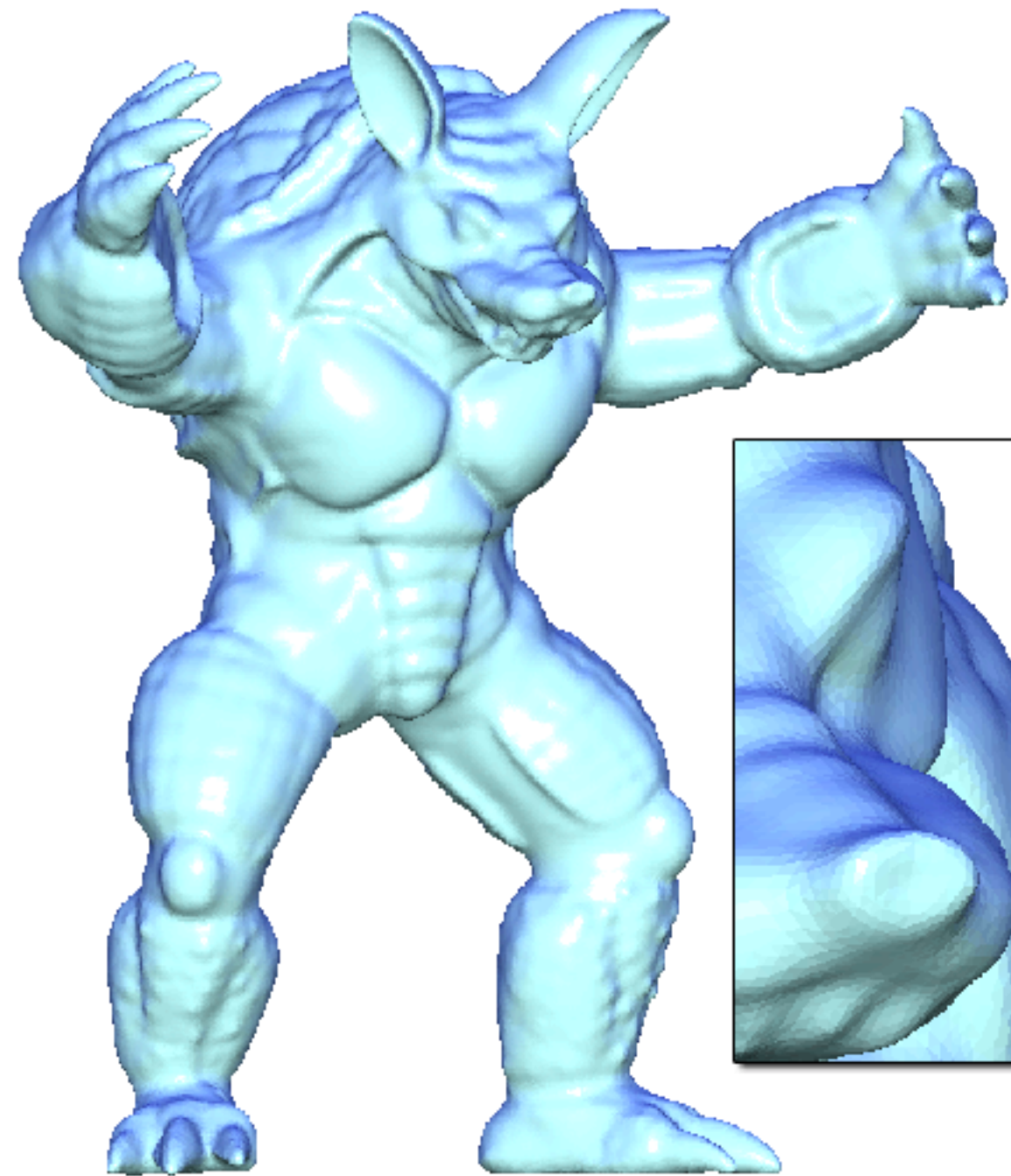
$$L = M^{-1} L_w \Rightarrow L^T M L = L_w M^{-1} L_w$$



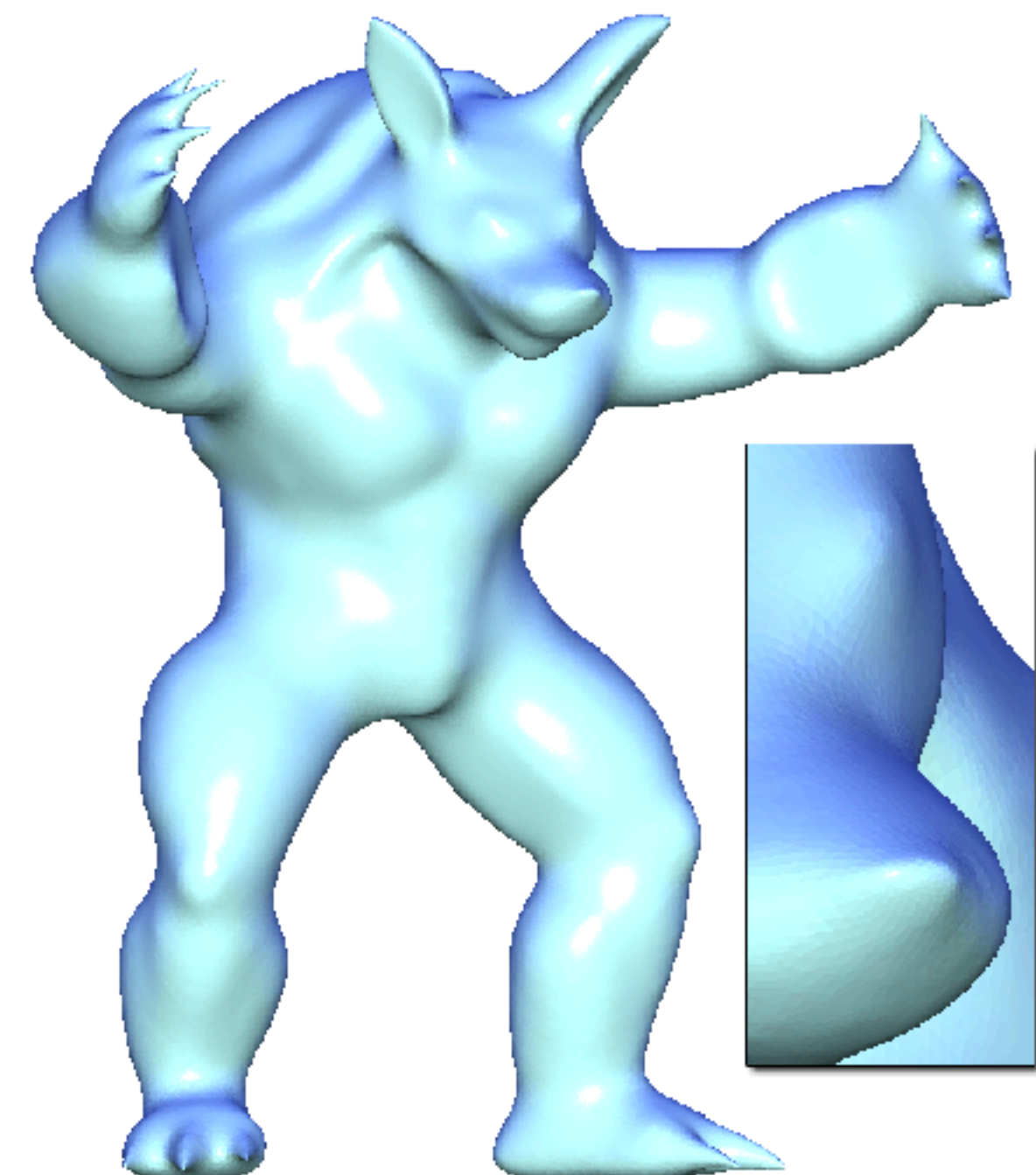
Results



original



$w = 0.2$



$w = 0.02$

Customize the energy functional

$$\min_{\tilde{\mathbf{p}}} \sum_{i=1}^n A_i \left(\|L\tilde{\mathbf{p}}_i\|^2 + w\|\tilde{\mathbf{p}}_i - \mathbf{p}_i\|^2 \right)$$

add a varying weight
here to control feature
preservation

$$E(\tilde{\mathbf{p}}) = \tilde{\mathbf{p}}^T L^T (M^{0.5} \underline{W_f} M^{0.5}) L \tilde{\mathbf{p}} + w(\tilde{\mathbf{p}} - \mathbf{p})^T M (\tilde{\mathbf{p}} - \mathbf{p})$$

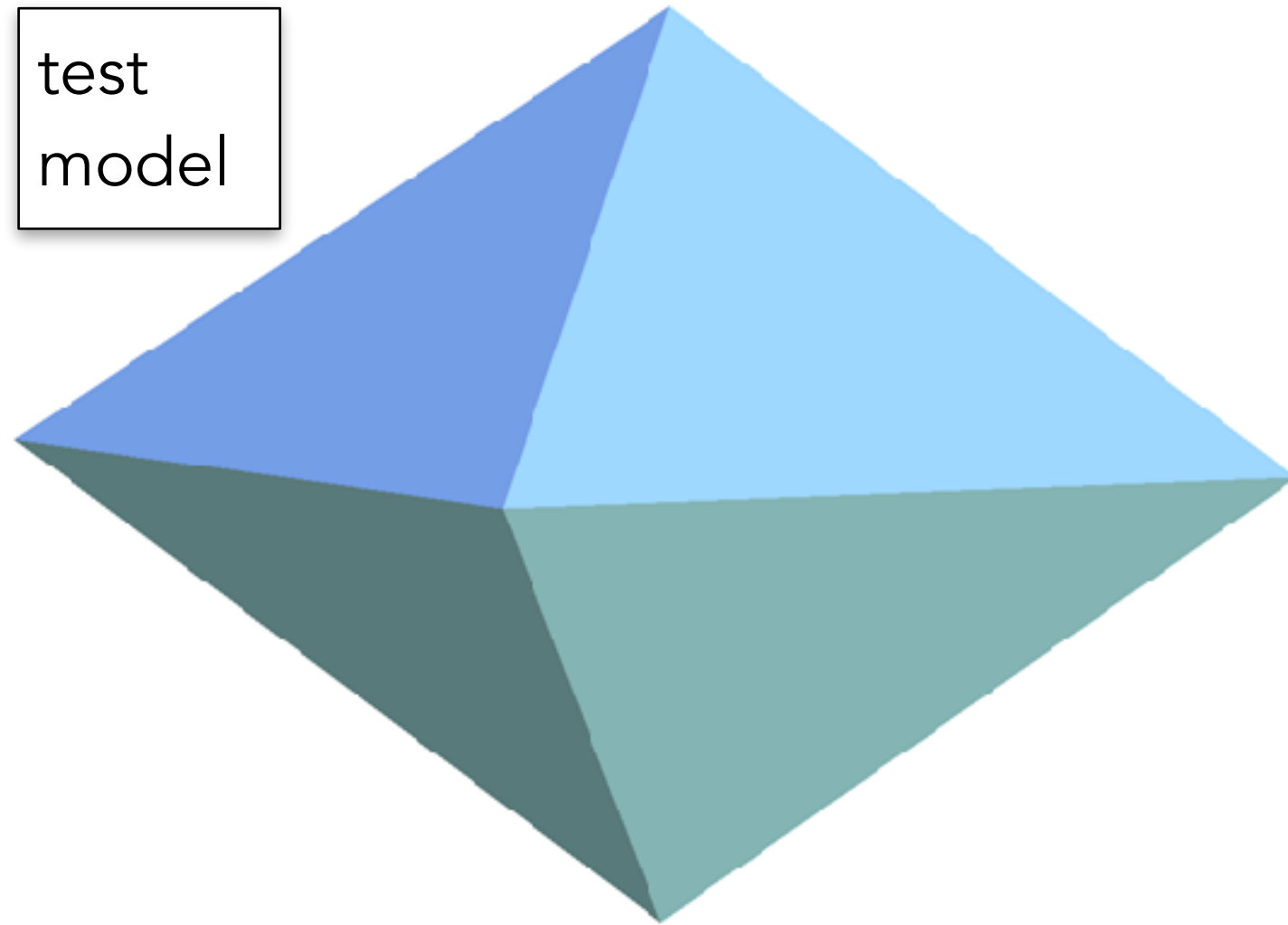
$(W_f)_{ii}$ can be inverse-proportional to e.g. curvature at vertex i

(slight abuse of notation, the energy is actually the sum of the xyz components, like on slide #62)

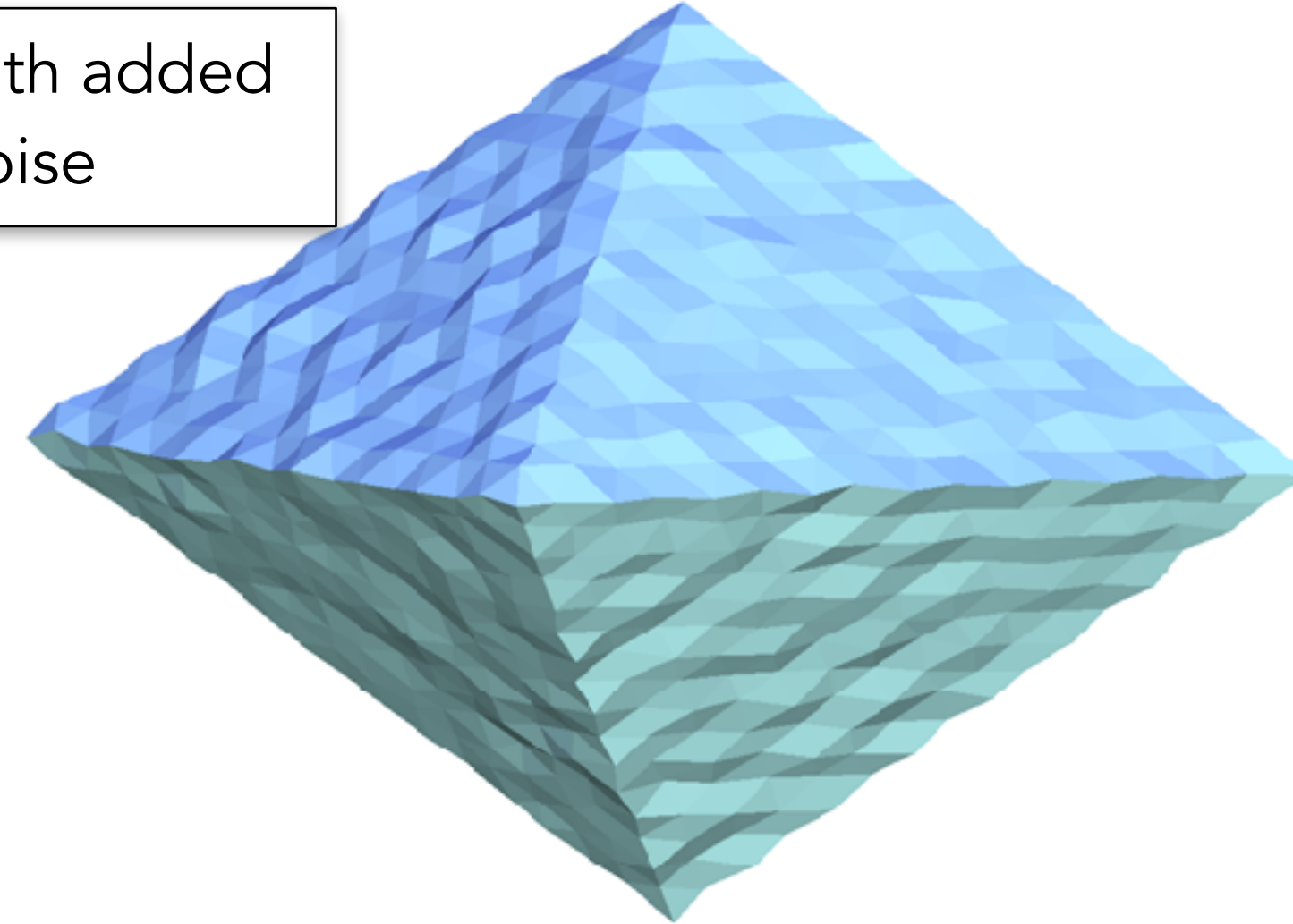
$$E(\tilde{\mathbf{p}}) = \sum_{\mathbf{v} \in \{\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{y}, \mathbf{z}\}} \tilde{\mathbf{v}}^T L^T \dots$$

Using W_f

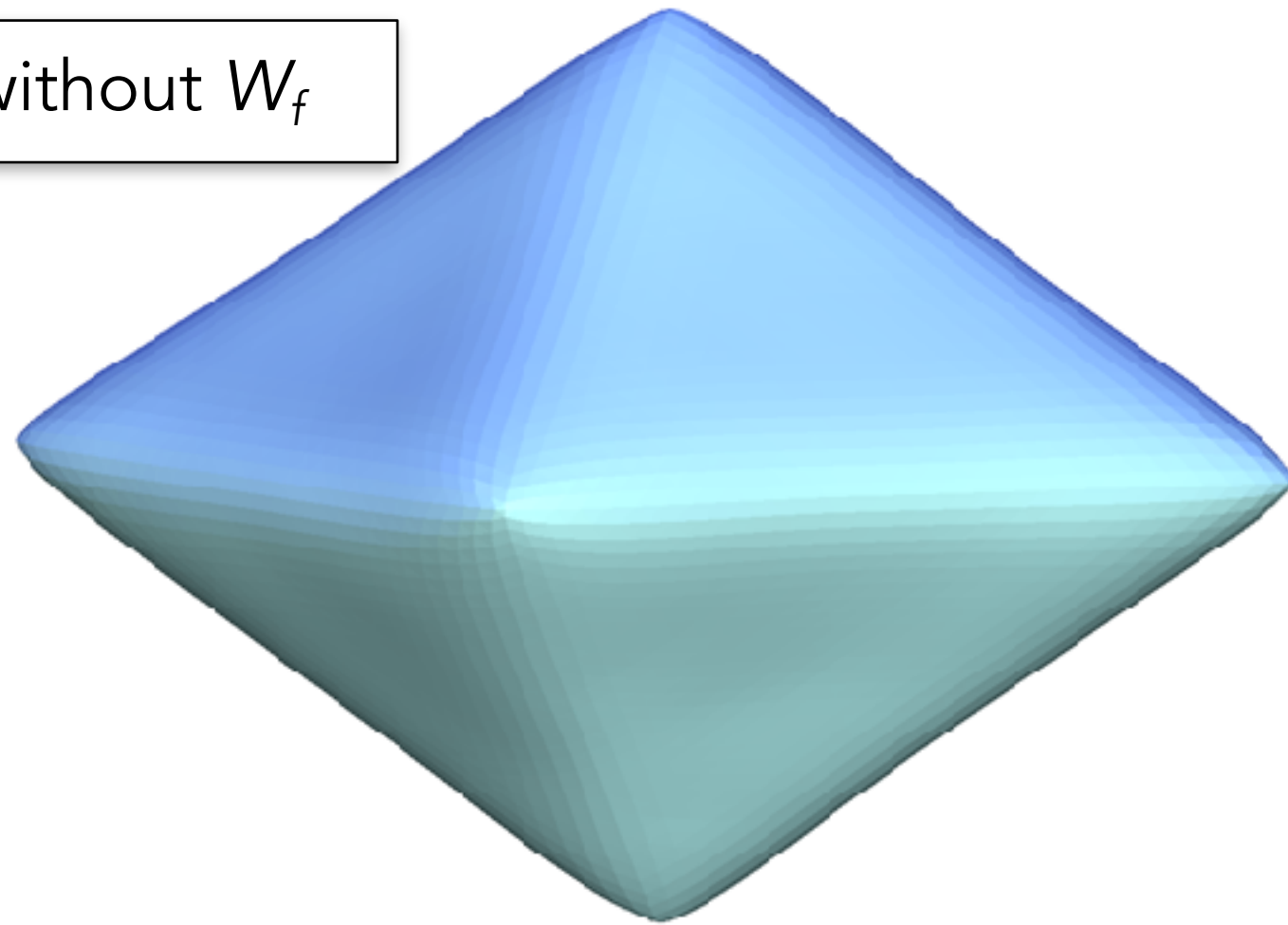
test
model



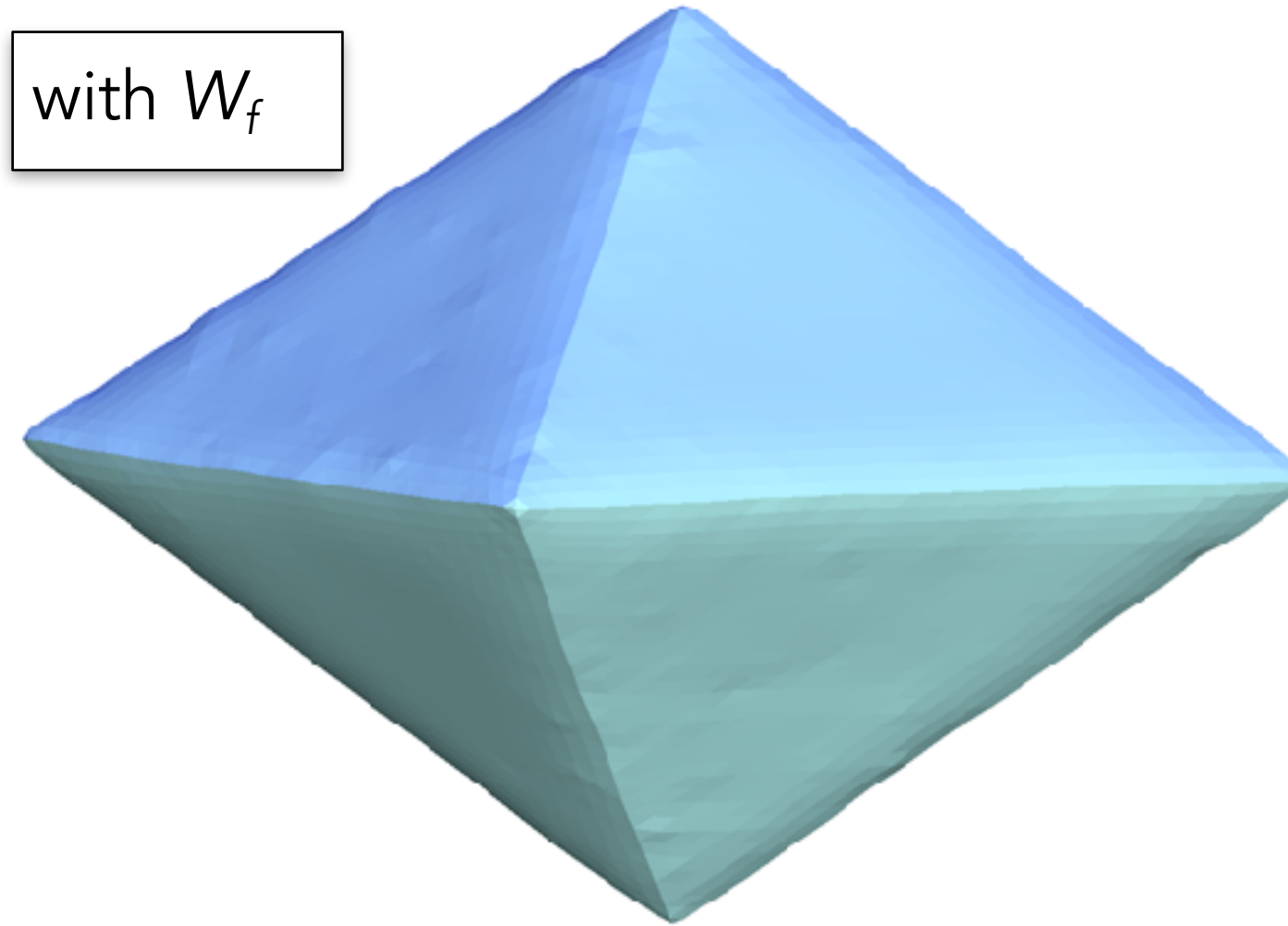
with added
noise



without W_f

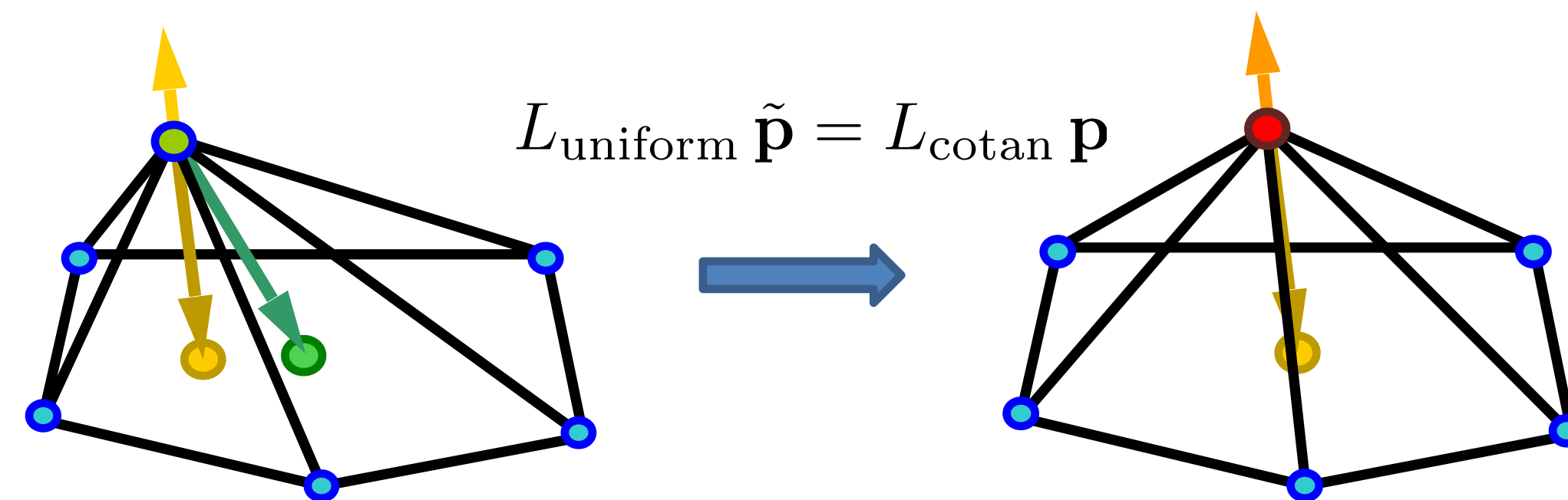


with W_f



Customize the energy functional

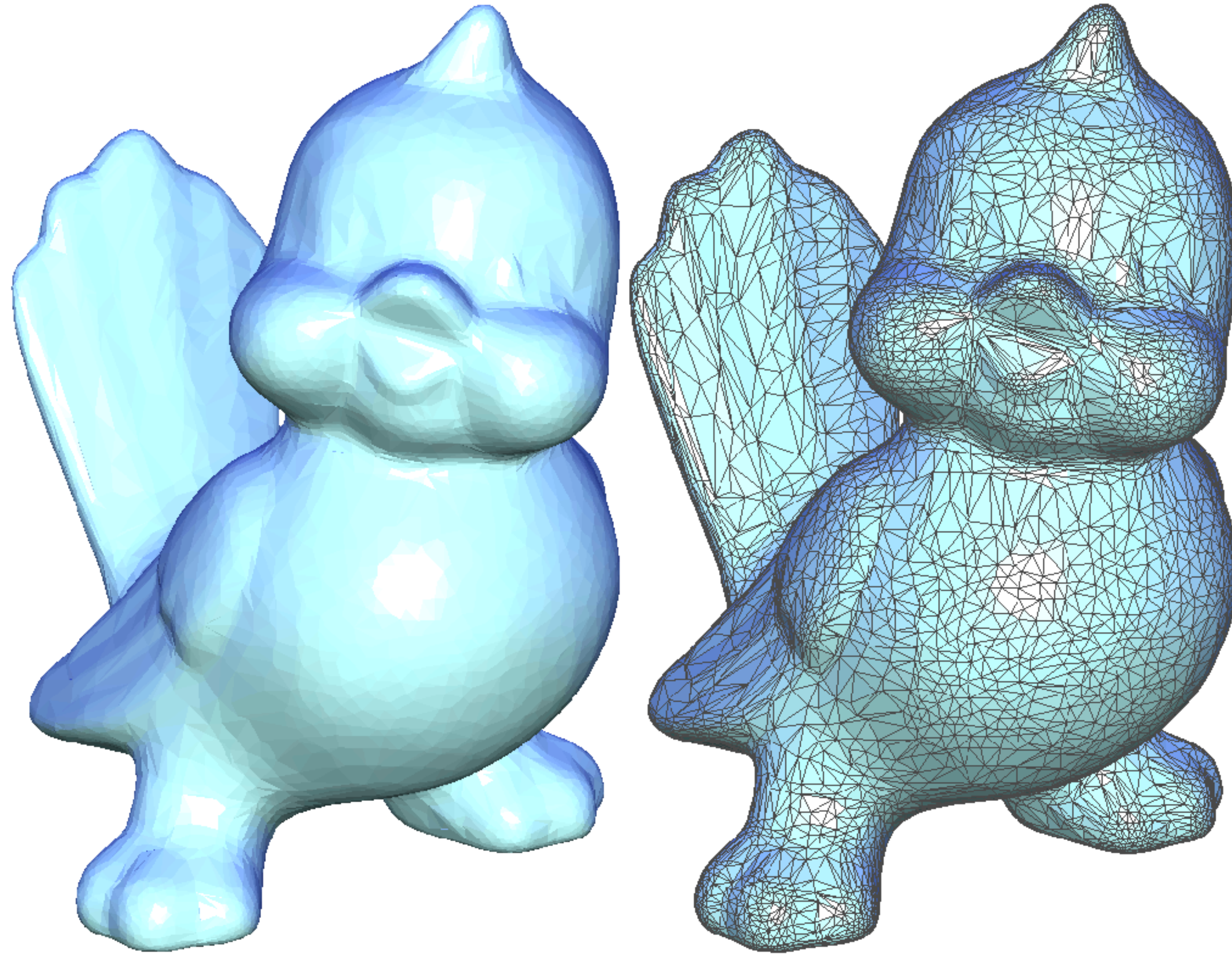
- Can do *tangential* smoothing!
 - Improve the shapes of mesh triangles without changing the surface shape



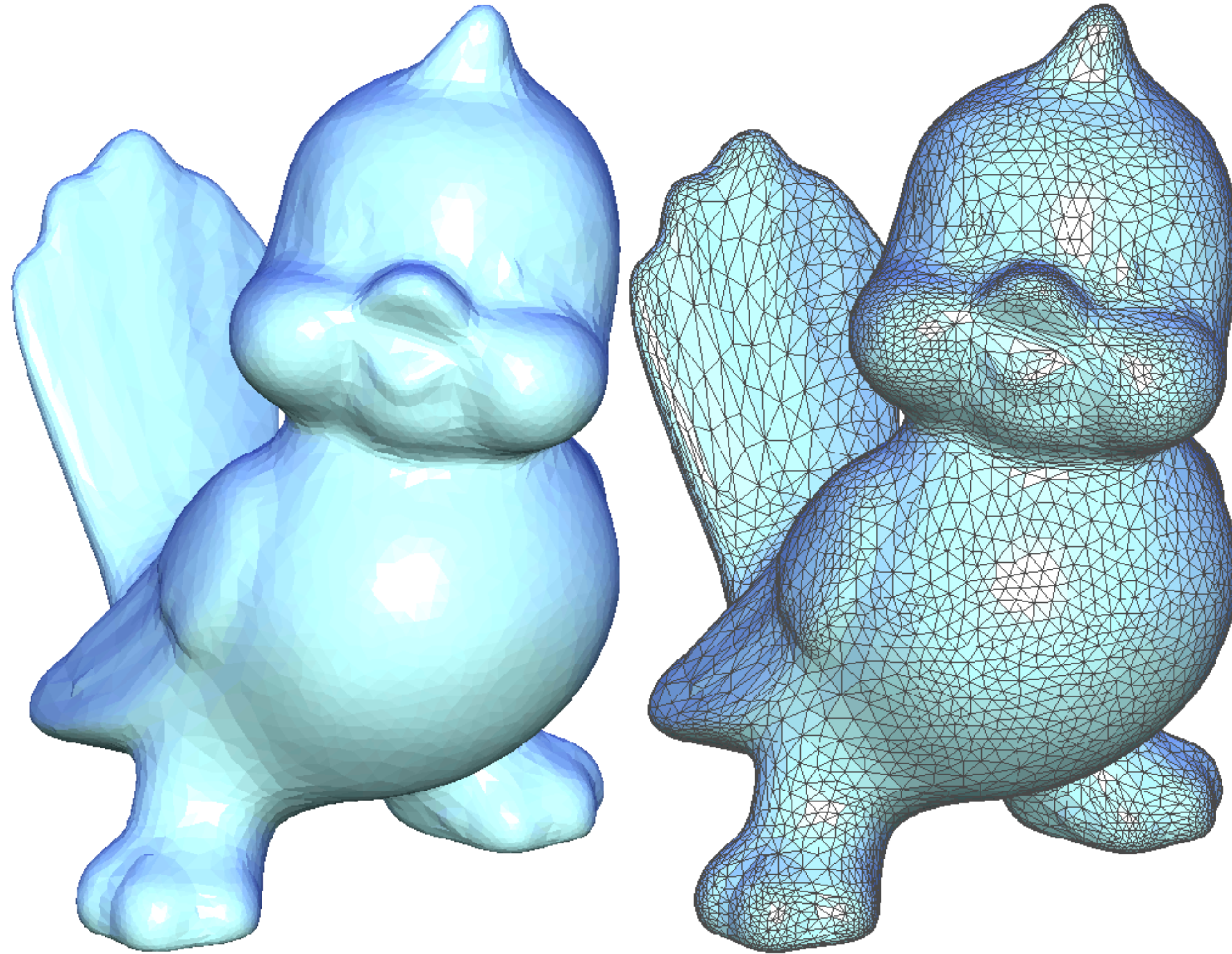
$$\min_{\tilde{\mathbf{p}}} \sum_{i=1}^n A_i \left(\|L_{\text{uniform}} \tilde{\mathbf{p}}_i - L_{\text{cotan}} \mathbf{p}_i\|^2 + w \|\tilde{\mathbf{p}}_i - \mathbf{p}_i\|^2 \right)$$

<https://graphics.uni-bielefeld.de/downloads/publications/2004/sgp04.pdf>

Original



Triangle Shape Optimization



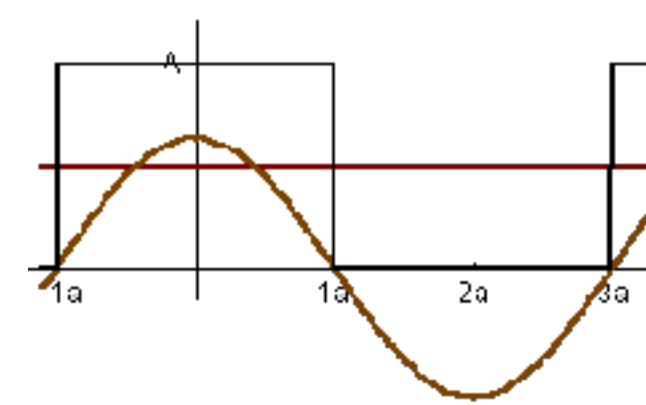
Method 3:

Smoothing as Filtering

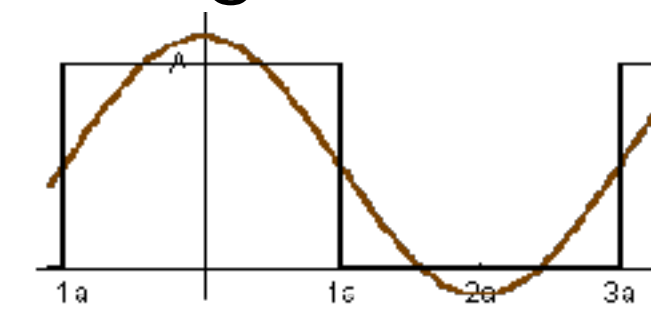
Fourier analysis

- Represent a function as a weighted sum of sines and cosines (basis functions)

basis functions



weighted sum



Joseph Fourier 1768 - 1830

$$f(x) = a_0 + a_1 \cos(x)$$

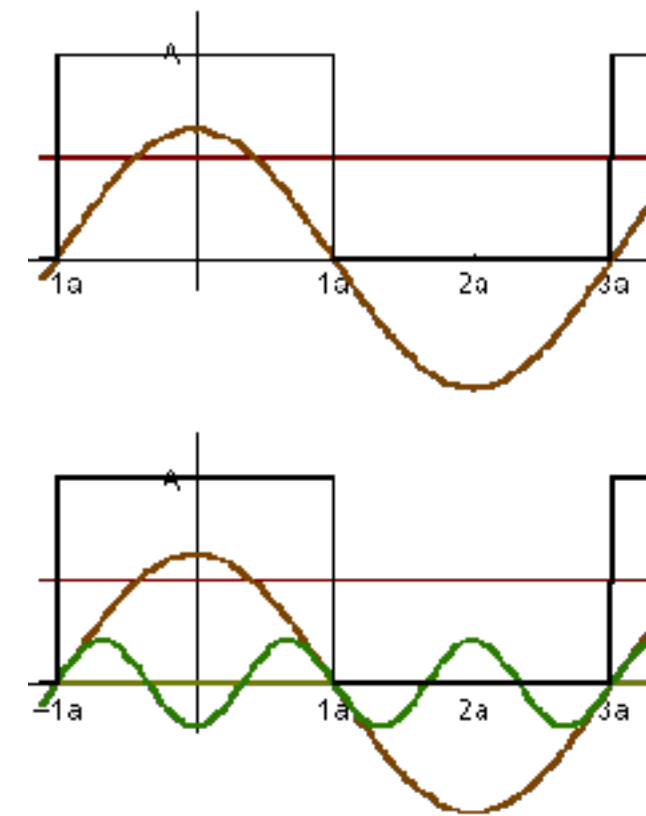
Fourier analysis

- Represent a function as a weighted sum of sines and cosines (basis functions)

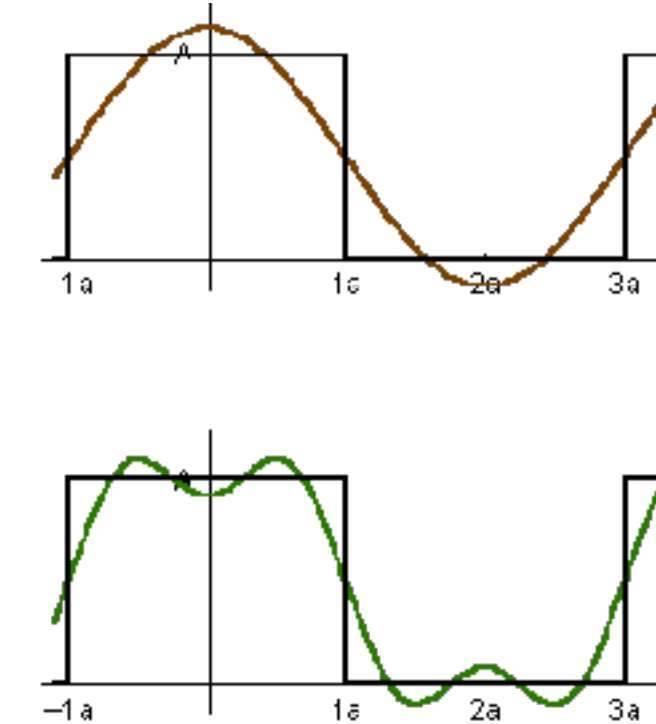


Joseph Fourier 1768 - 1830

basis functions



weighted sum



$$f(x) = a_0 + a_1 \cos(x) + a_2 \cos(3x)$$

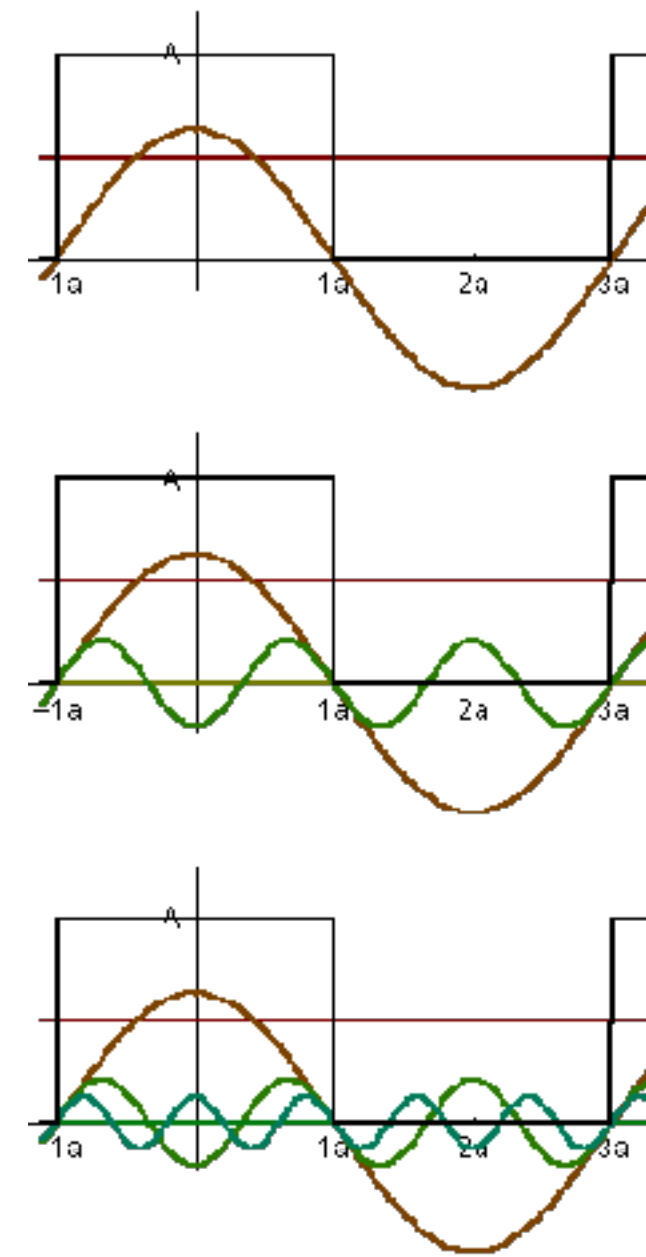
Fourier analysis

- Represent a function as a weighted sum of sines and cosines (basis functions)

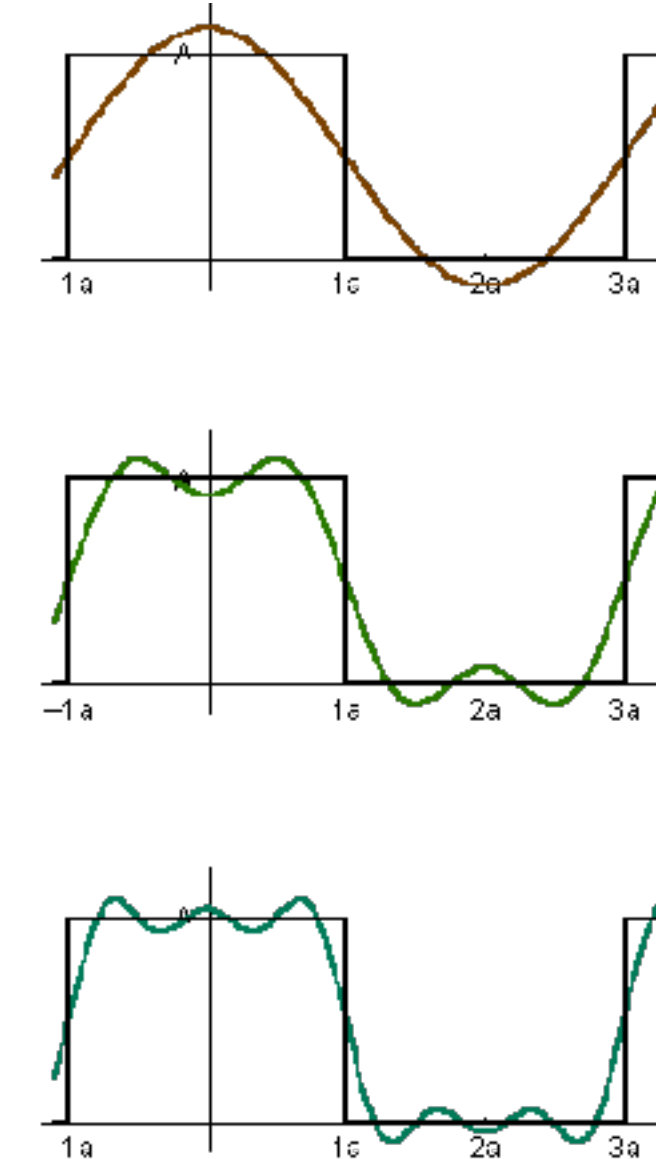


Joseph Fourier 1768 - 1830

basis functions



weighted sum



$$f(x) = a_0 + a_1 \cos(x) + a_2 \cos(3x) + a_3 \cos(5x)$$



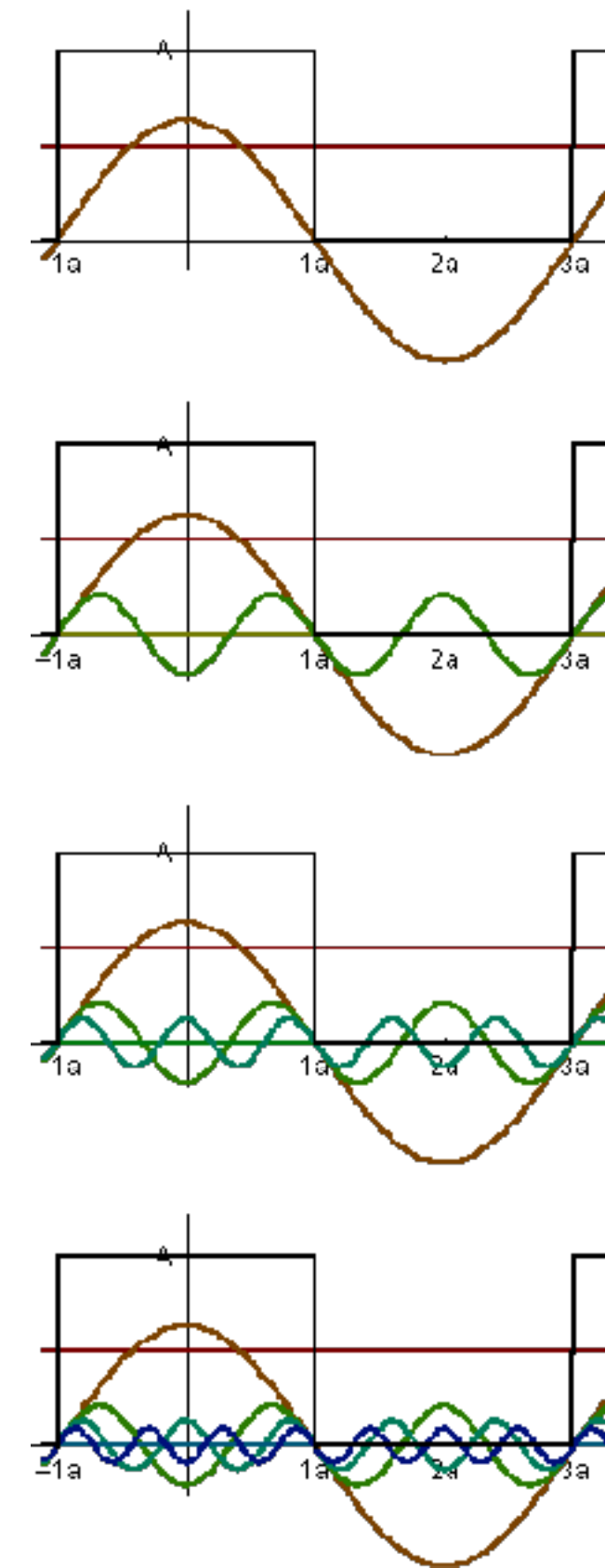
Fourier analysis

- Represent a function as a weighted sum of sines and cosines (basis functions)

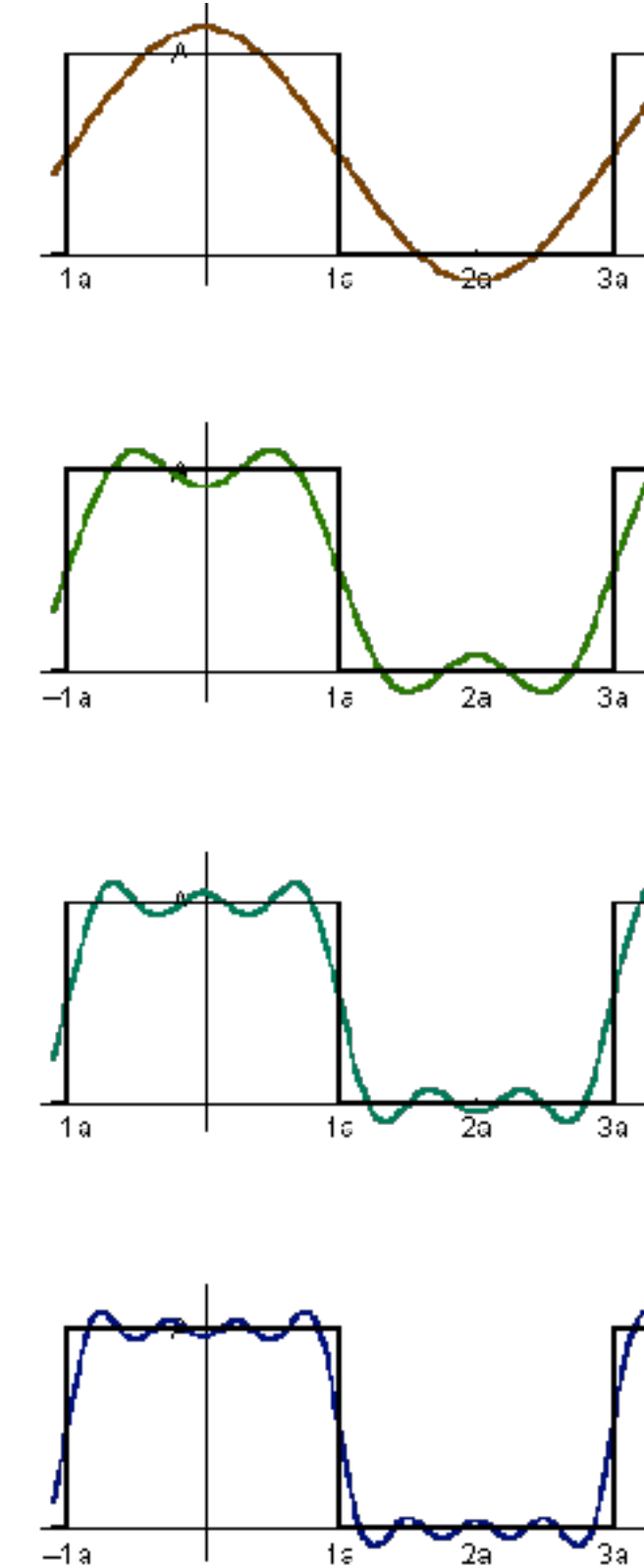


Joseph Fourier 1768 - 1830

basis functions



weighted sum

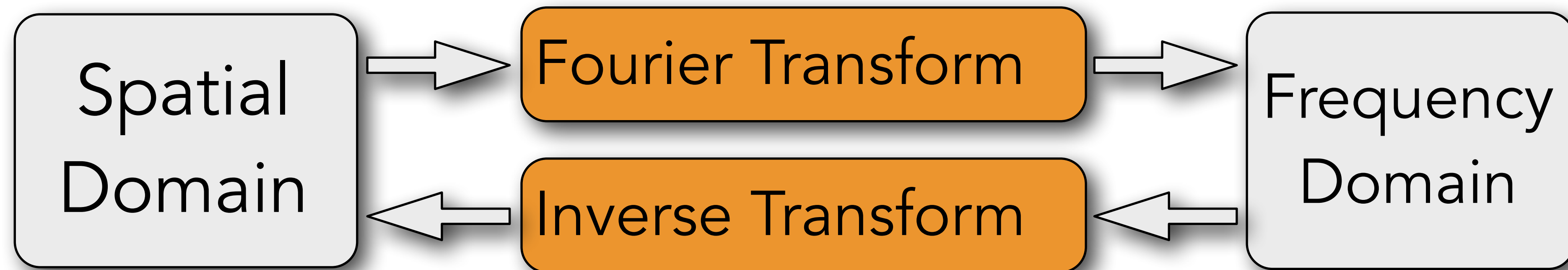


$$f(x) = a_0 + a_1 \cos(x) + a_2 \cos(3x) + a_3 \cos(5x) + a_4 \cos(7x) + \dots$$



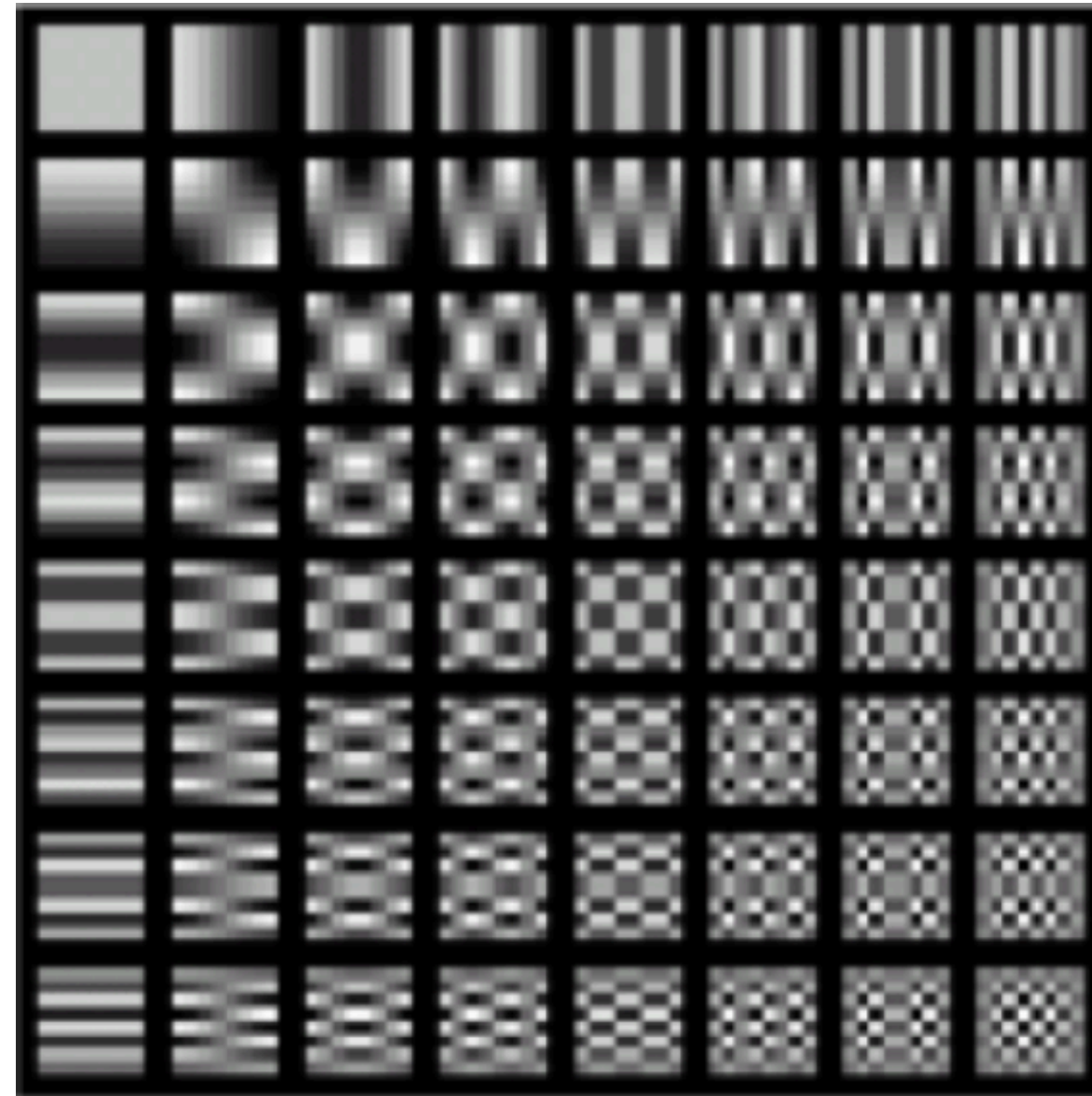
Fourier analysis

$$F(\omega) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f(x) e^{-2\pi i \omega x} dx$$



$$f(x) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} F(\omega) e^{2\pi i \omega x} d\omega$$

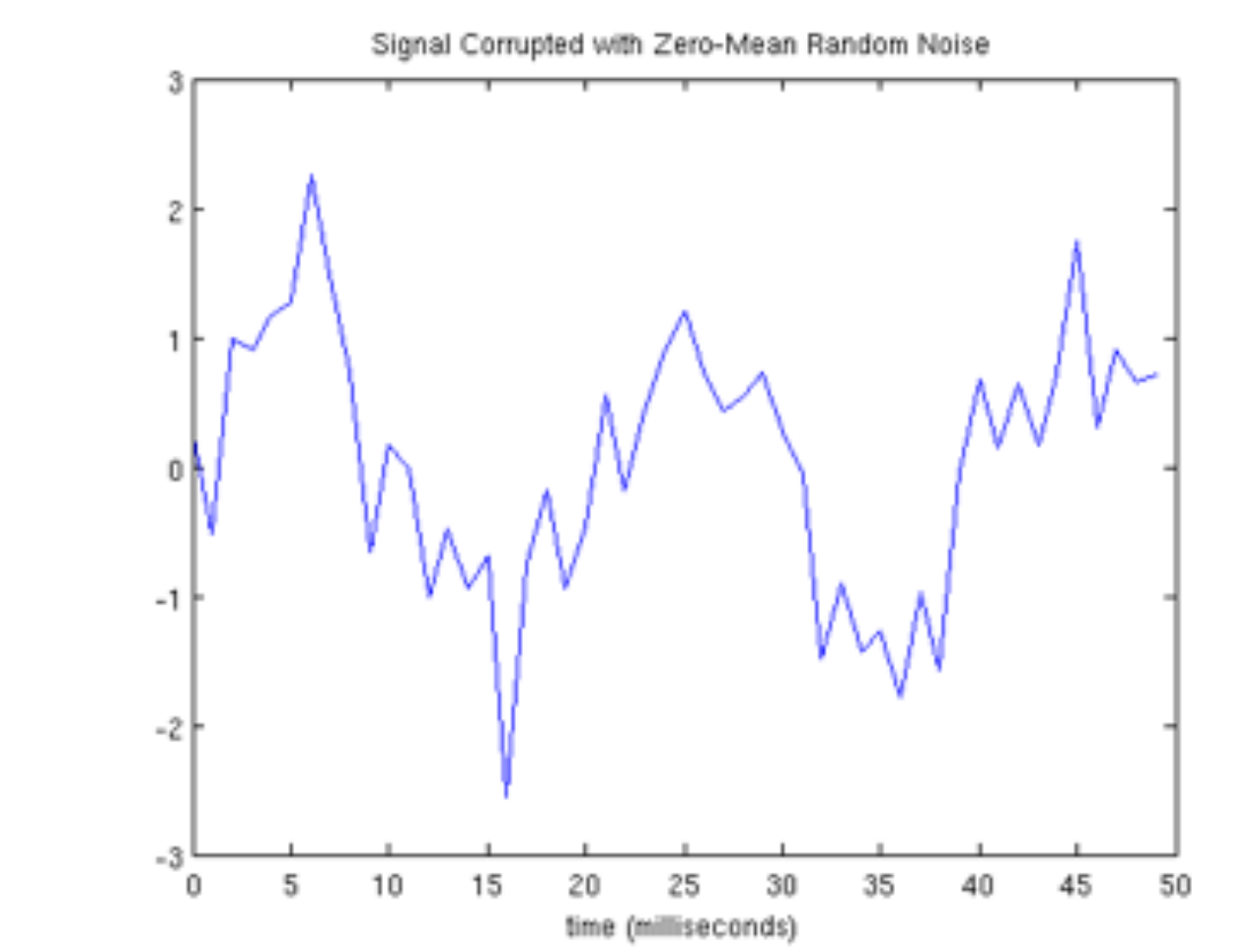
Also works on rectangular 2D domains



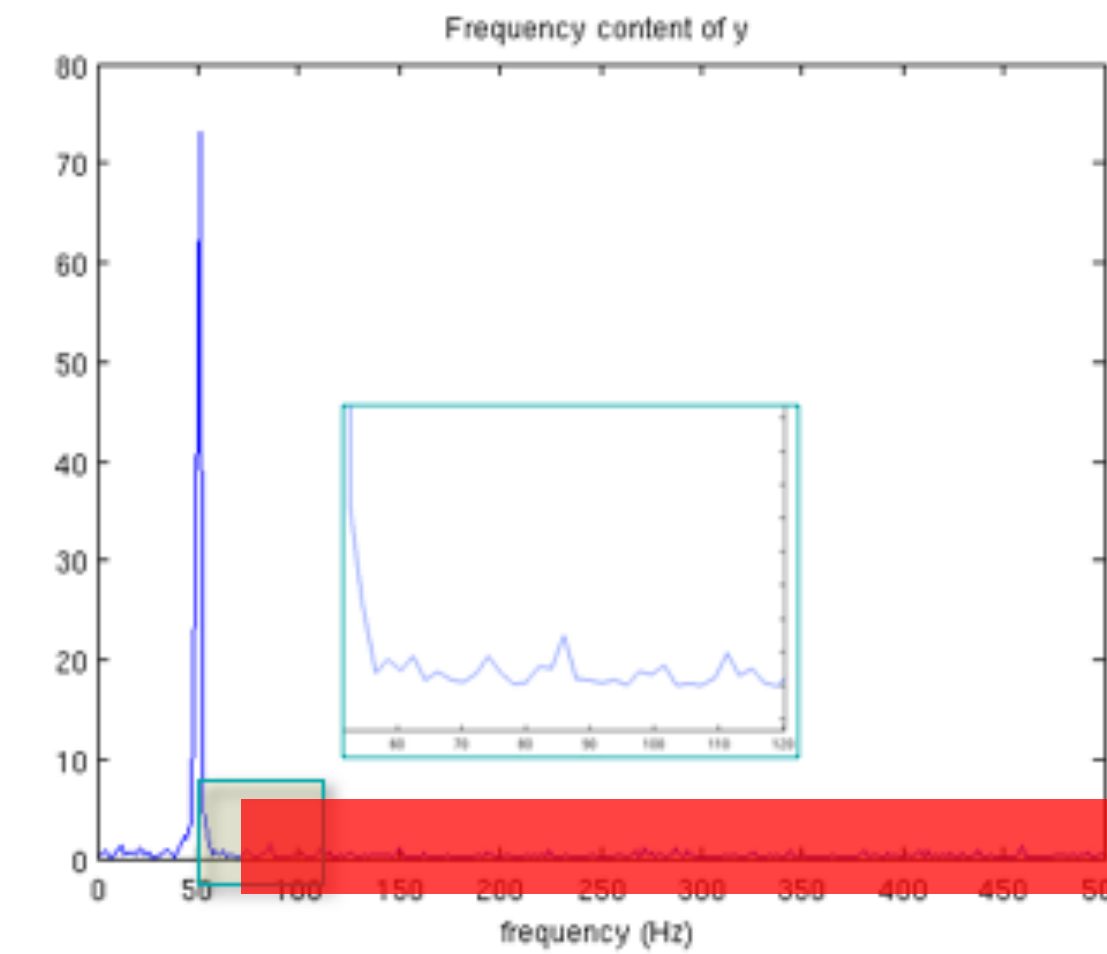
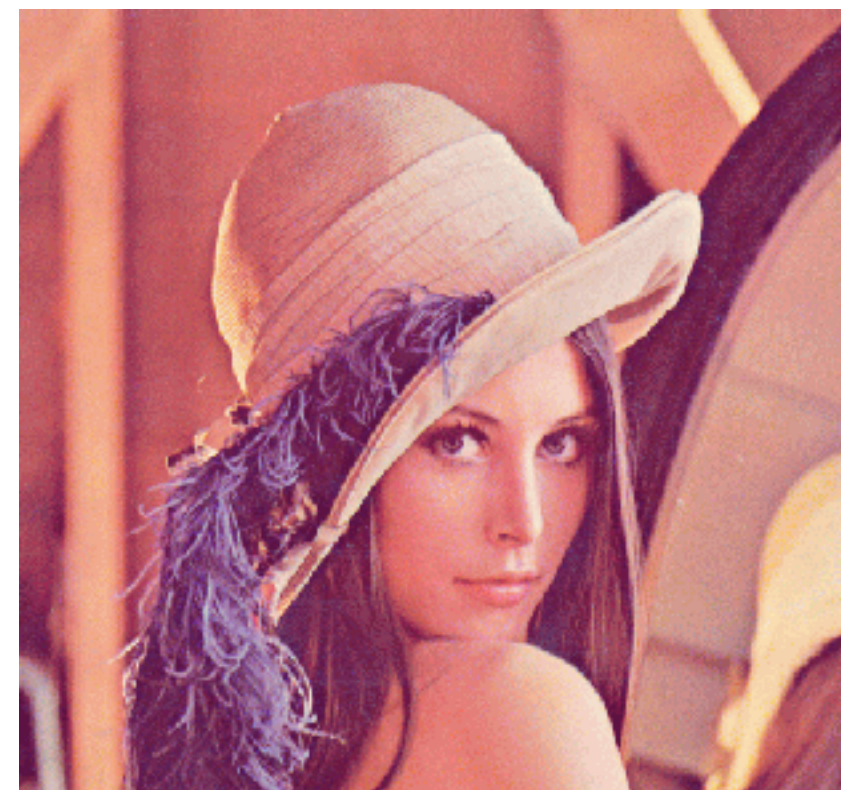
Fourier (DCT) basis functions for 8x8 grayscale images

$$\cos(2\pi\omega_h) \cos(2\pi\omega_v)$$

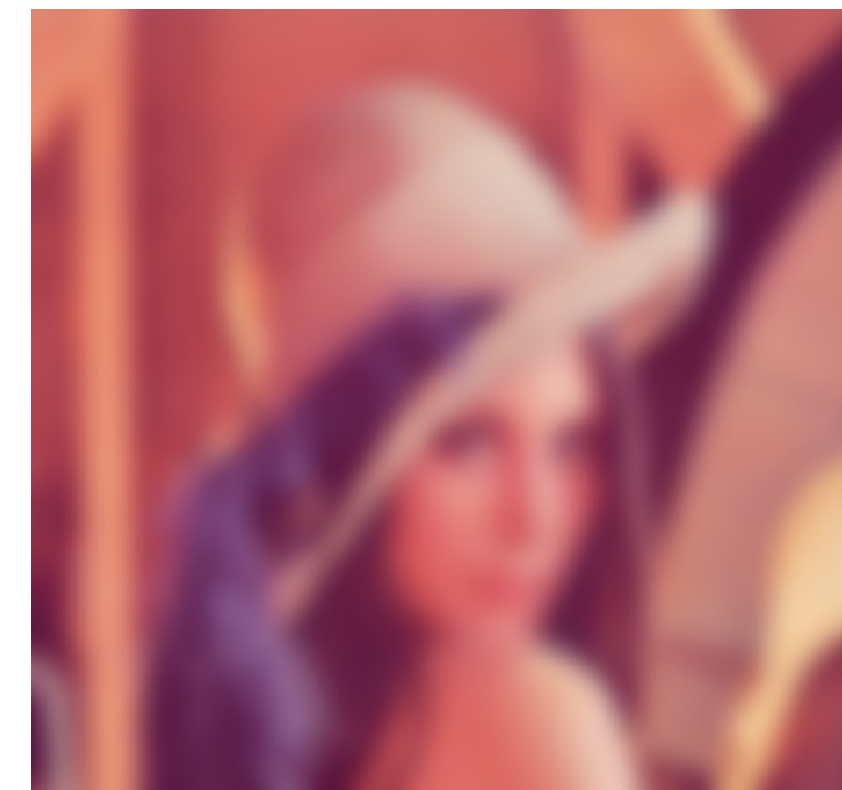
Smoothing = filtering high frequencies out



spatial domain



frequency domain



Extend Fourier to meshes?

- Basis functions??
- Fourier basis functions are eigenfunctions of the (standard) Laplace operator:

$$\Delta \left(e^{2\pi i \omega x} \right) = \frac{\partial^2}{\partial x^2} e^{2\pi i \omega x} = -(2\pi \omega)^2 e^{2\pi i \omega x}$$

- On meshes: take the eigenvectors of the Laplace-Beltrami matrix!

Spectral analysis on meshes

- Take your favorite L-B matrix L
- Compute eigenvectors $\mathbf{e}_1, \mathbf{e}_2, \dots, \mathbf{e}_k$ with the k smallest eigenvalues
- Reconstruct the mesh geometry from these eigenvectors:

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbf{x} &= [x_1, \dots, x_n]^T & \mathbf{y} &= [y_1, \dots, y_n]^T & \mathbf{z} &= [z_1, \dots, z_n]^T \\ \tilde{\mathbf{x}} &= \sum_{i=1}^k (\mathbf{x}^T \mathbf{e}_i) \mathbf{e}_i & \tilde{\mathbf{y}} &= \sum_{i=1}^k (\mathbf{y}^T \mathbf{e}_i) \mathbf{e}_i & \tilde{\mathbf{z}} &= \sum_{i=1}^k (\mathbf{z}^T \mathbf{e}_i) \mathbf{e}_i\end{aligned}$$

$$\tilde{\mathbf{p}} = [\tilde{\mathbf{x}} \ \tilde{\mathbf{y}} \ \tilde{\mathbf{z}}] \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times 3}$$

Spectral analysis on meshes

too expensive for
large meshes

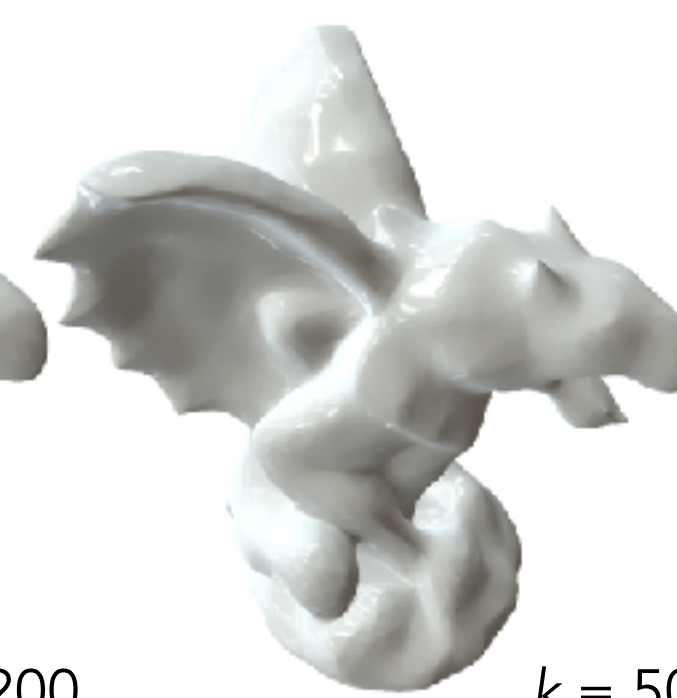
- Take your favorite L-B matrix L
- Compute eigenvectors $\mathbf{e}_1, \mathbf{e}_2, \dots, \mathbf{e}_k$ with the k smallest eigenvalues
- Reconstruct the mesh geometry from these eigenvectors:



$k = 40$



$k = 200$



$k = 500$



$k = 1000$

References

- Polygon Mesh Processing, Chapter 4